PMC

PMC MANAGERS

Master Training Manual v4

Whole-site edition · every portal, every screen, every process

Issued 04 November 2026 · replaces v3 (Sovereign Edition)

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1 · Platform overview & architecture

PMC Managers is a global e-procurement platform: buyers publish tenders, verified suppliers bid with sealed envelopes, an evaluation committee opens, checks and awards, and payments move through escrow — every step recorded in a tamper-evident audit ledger.

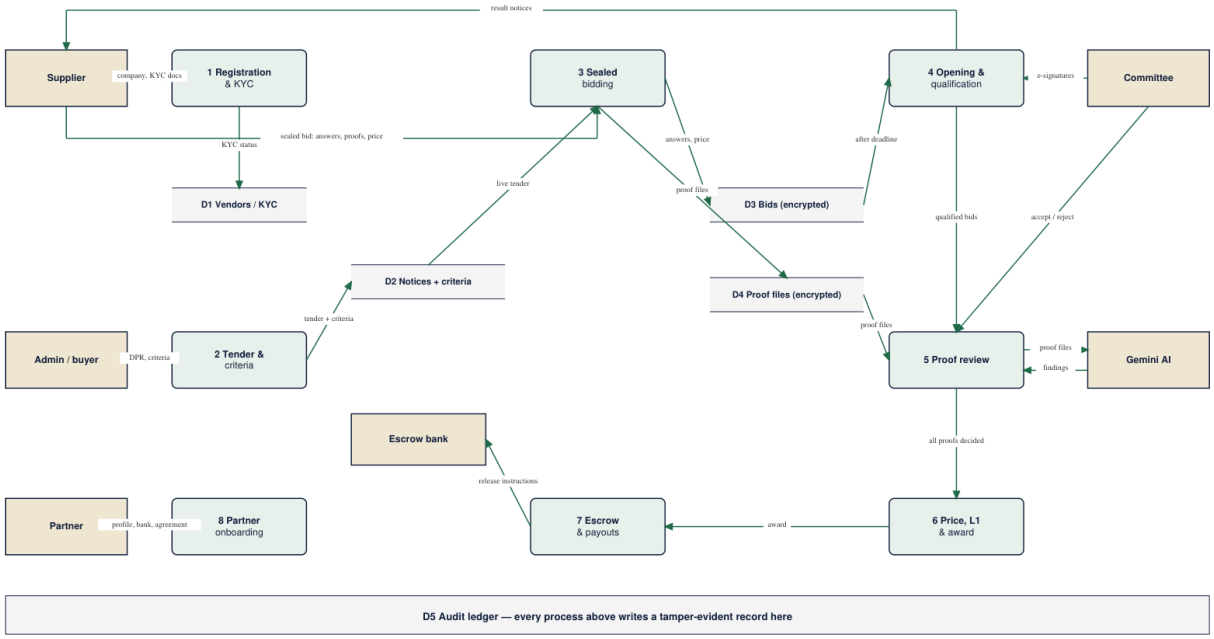
Portals

Portal	Address	Who
Public website	/ , /tenders, /notices	Anyone
Supplier portal	/vendor	Registered suppliers
Admin console	/admin/e	PMC admins and reviewers
Staff portal	/staff	Committee, escrow, legal, accounting, certifier
Partner portal	/partner/me	Partners who onboard suppliers
Escrow portal	/login?role=escrow	Escrow institutions

Architecture

React single-page app (served from S3 + CloudFront) → FastAPI backend (Docker on AWS Elastic Beanstalk, all routes under /api) → MongoDB. Bid answers, prices and uploaded bid files are encrypted at rest and only decrypted after the committee signs each opening. AI features (DPR tender drafting, criteria reading, proof reading) use Gemini through the platform's AI key. Email goes through the managed email service. Scheduled jobs (reminders, statements, digests) run from the platform scheduler.

PMC platform — data flow (level 1)



- External entities (beige), processes (green), data stores (grey). Arrows show what data moves.
- Proof files are sent to the AI only after the technical opening, for qualified bids only.
- Emails (result notices, reminders) are sent by the email service from processes 4 and 8.

2 · Roles at a glance

Role	Main jobs	Where
Supplier	Register, KYC, bid with criteria proofs, consortium, results, payouts	Supplier portal
Admin	Tenders, criteria, publishing, suppliers, partners, settings	Admin console
Reviewer	Approves supplier-prepared tenders; edits criteria master	Admin console
Committee member	Signs openings, reviews proofs (all must agree), doubts, scores, awards	Bidding ops / Staff portal
Certifier / Legal / Accounting	Sequential bid clearances before award	Staff portal
Escrow agent	EMD, dual-signed releases, payouts	Staff portal / Escrow
Partner	Onboards suppliers, earns commission	Partner portal
Auditor	Reads the audit ledger and reports	Admin console

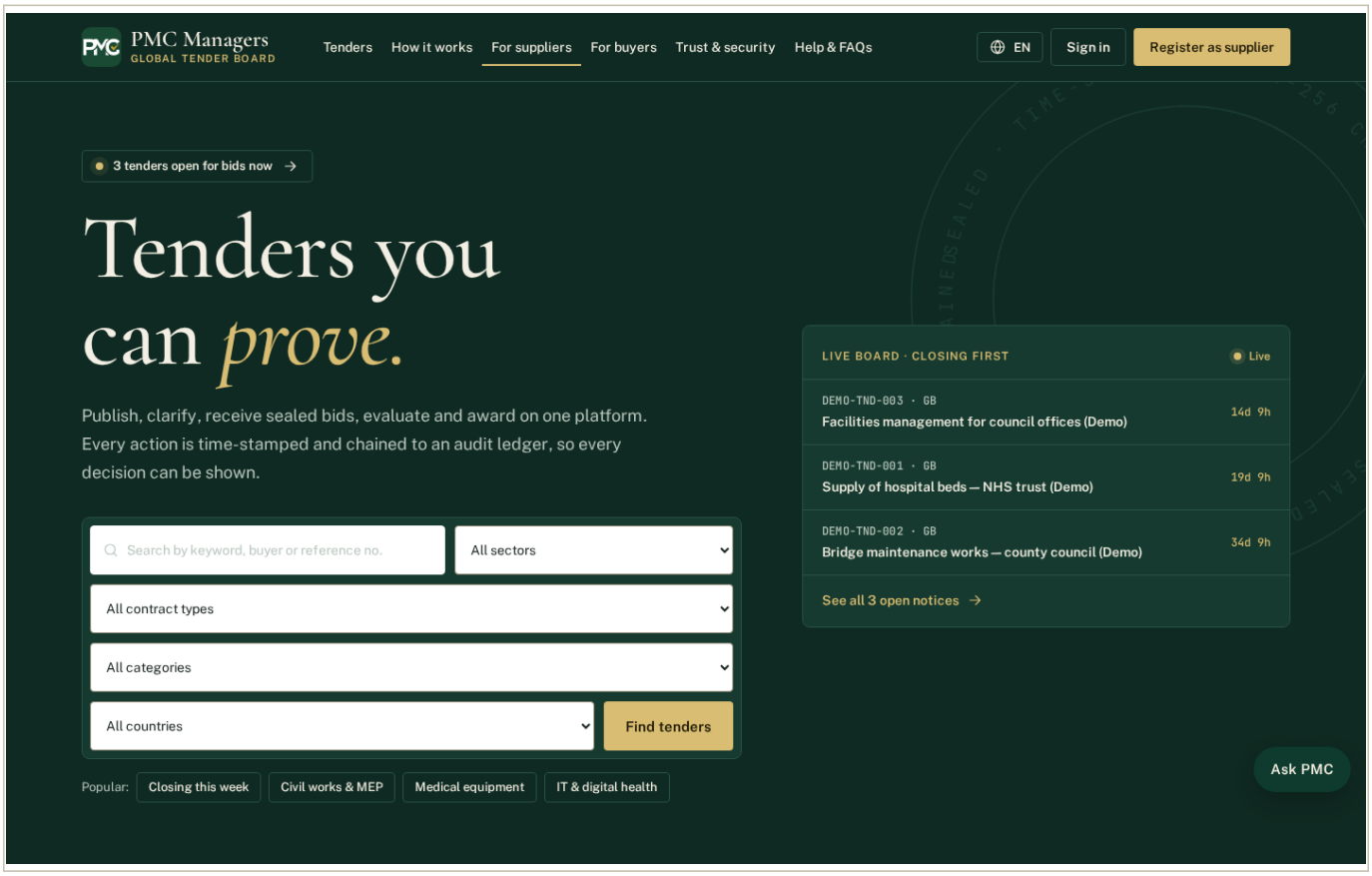
3 · Security, audit & data protection

1. Sign-in by role with email + password (session cookie + CSRF token on every change).
2. Role-based access: the admin console only admits admin and reviewer; other staff use the staff portal.
3. Sealed bidding: answers, price and bid files are encrypted; nobody (including admins) can open them before the committee signs.
4. Audit ledger: every action is chained with SHA-256; 'Verify chain' re-checks every link.
5. Soft deletion: records are archived, not erased, unless a narrowly scoped deletion is explicitly requested.
6. AI sees proof files only after technical opening and only for qualified bids; AI only flags — people decide.

4 · Public website — screen tour

Home page

Screen: /



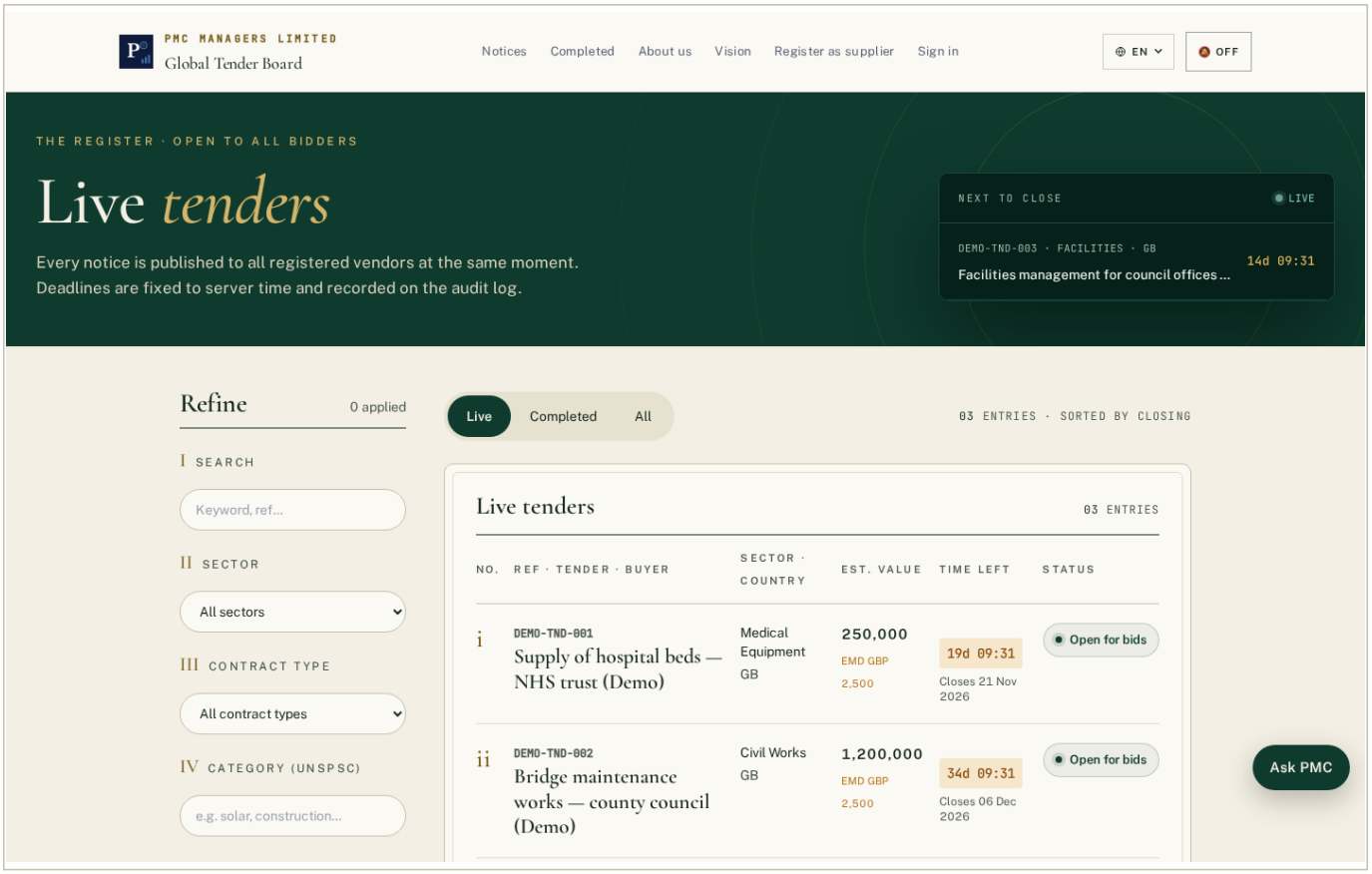
The public front door of PMC Managers. Visitors see what the platform does, the latest live tenders and the main ways in: Find tenders, Register as a supplier and Sign in.

Main actions

- Browse live tenders
- Register as a supplier
- Sign in to your portal

Public tender board

Screen: `/tenders`



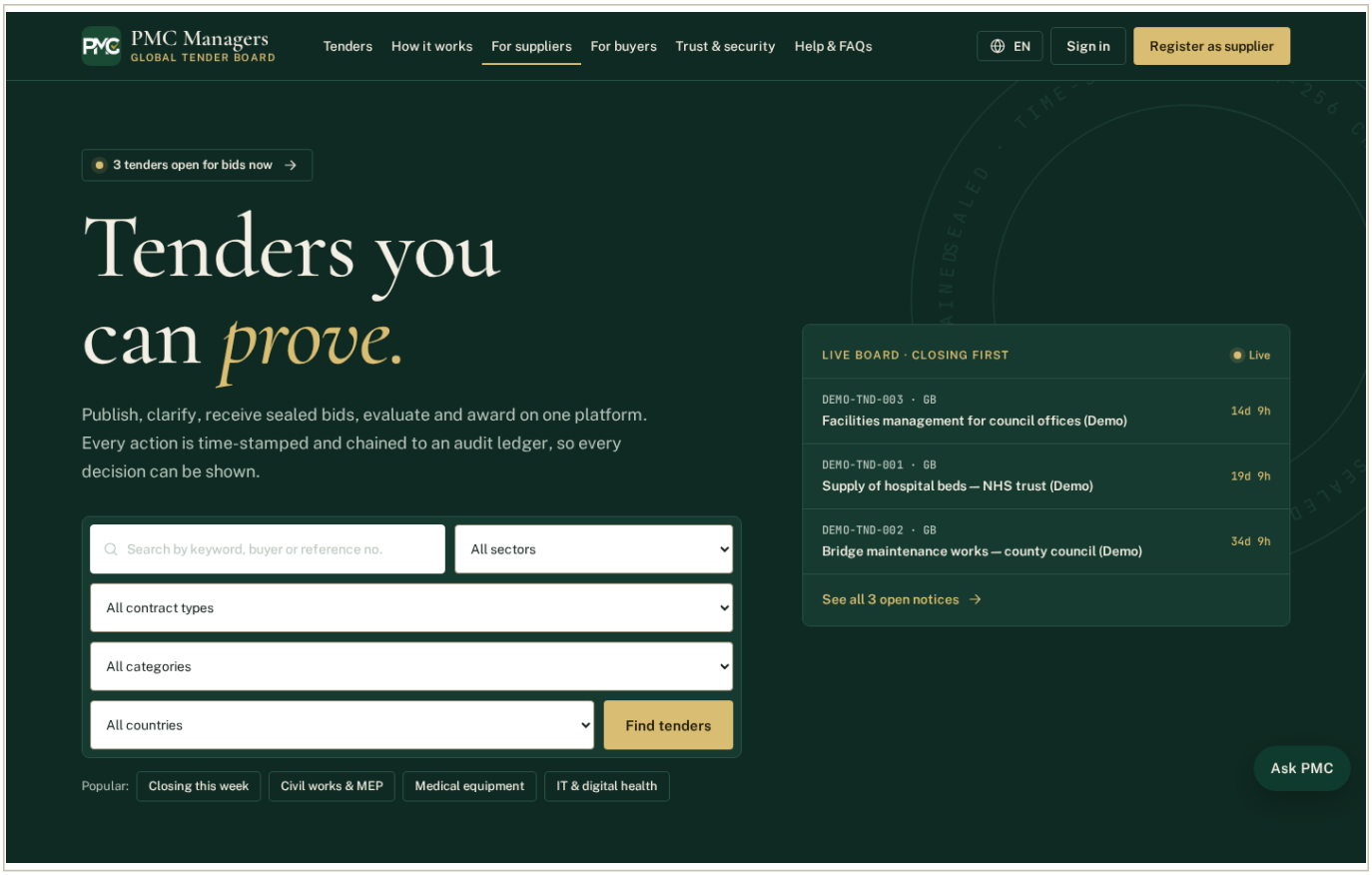
Every published tender with its reference, buyer, category, country and closing date. Anyone can search and filter; bidding needs a verified supplier account.

Main actions

- Search by keyword or reference
- Filter by category, country and closing date
- Open a tender to read the documents

Notice board

Screen: `/notices`



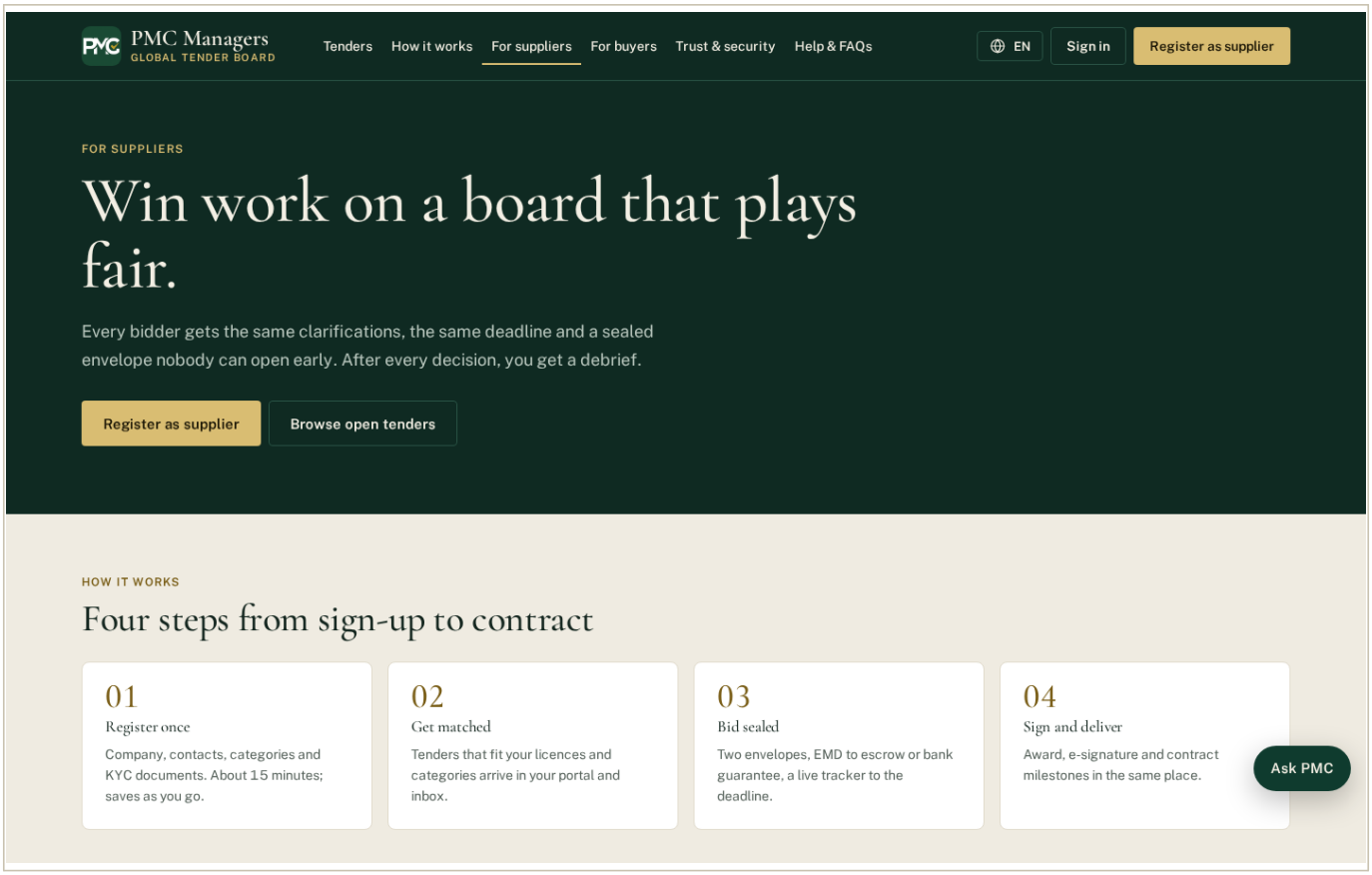
Published notices and corrigenda in date order, so suppliers can see changes to live tenders.

Main actions

- Read a notice
- See corrigenda issued against a tender

For suppliers

Screen: `/suppliers`



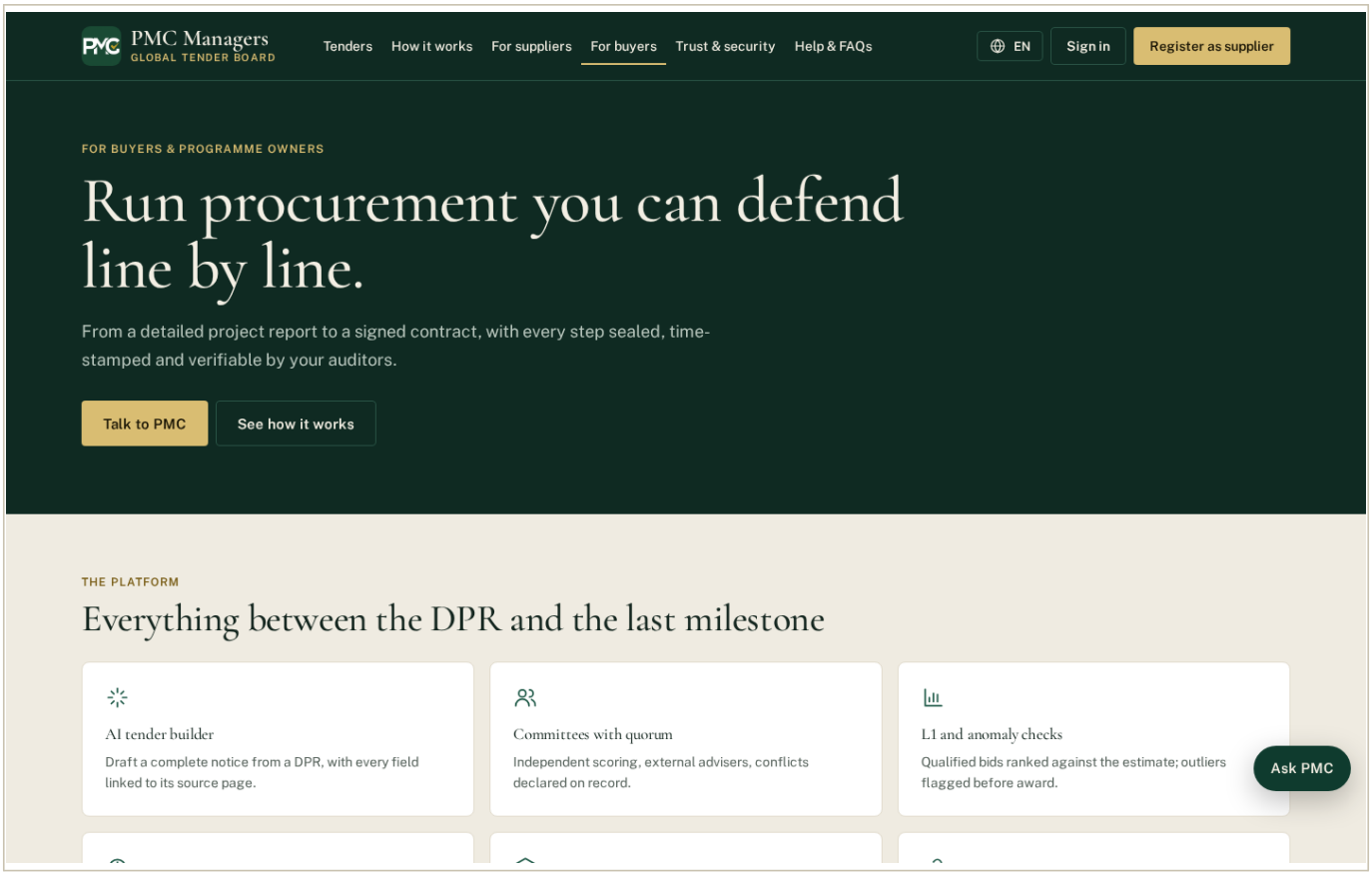
Explains how suppliers register, get verified, find tenders, bid with sealed envelopes and get paid through escrow.

Main actions

- Start supplier registration

For buyers

Screen: `/buyers`



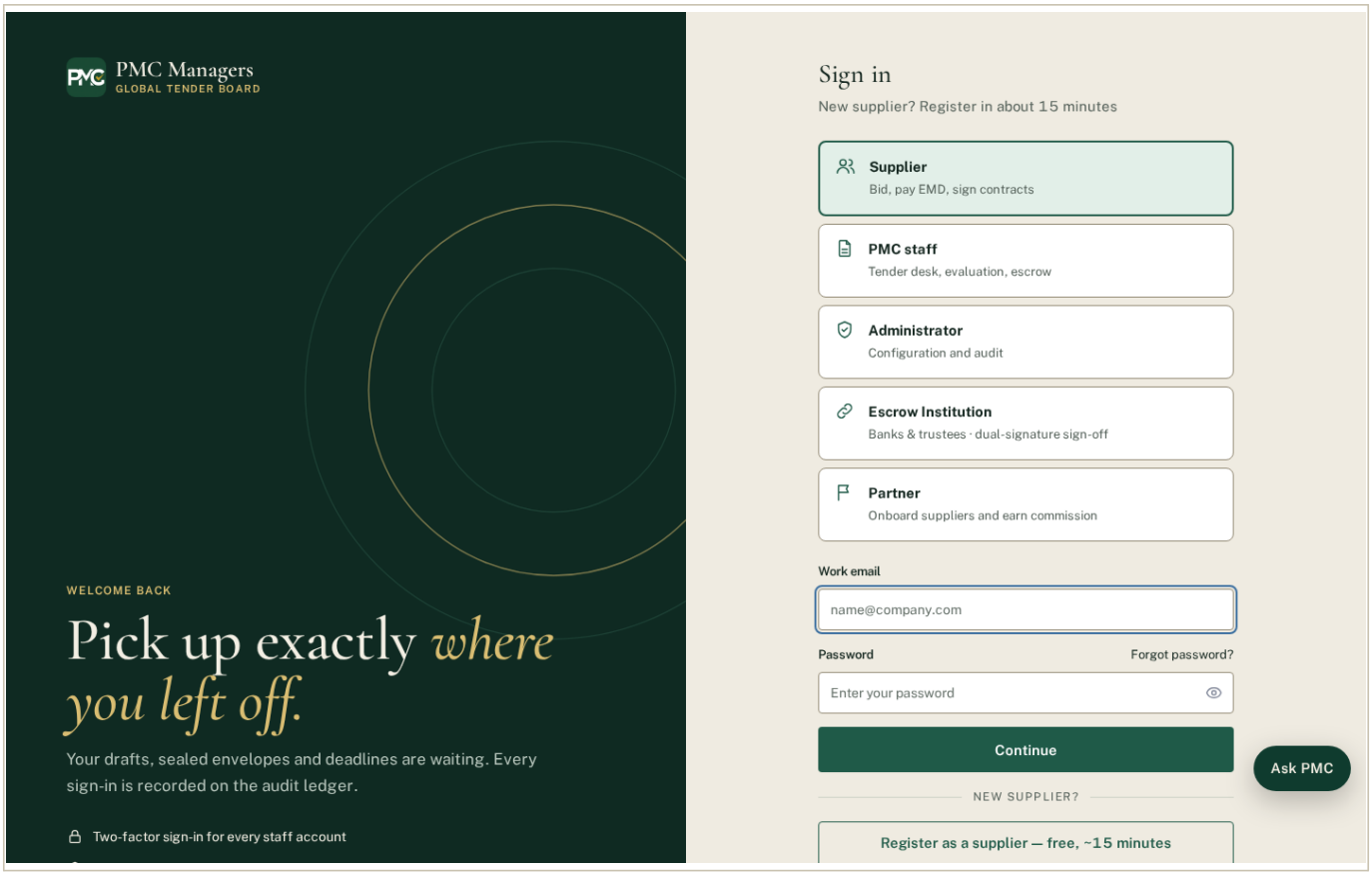
Explains how buyers publish tenders, set criteria, run sealed openings and award with a full audit trail.

Main actions

- Contact PMC to start buying

Sign in

Screen: `/login`



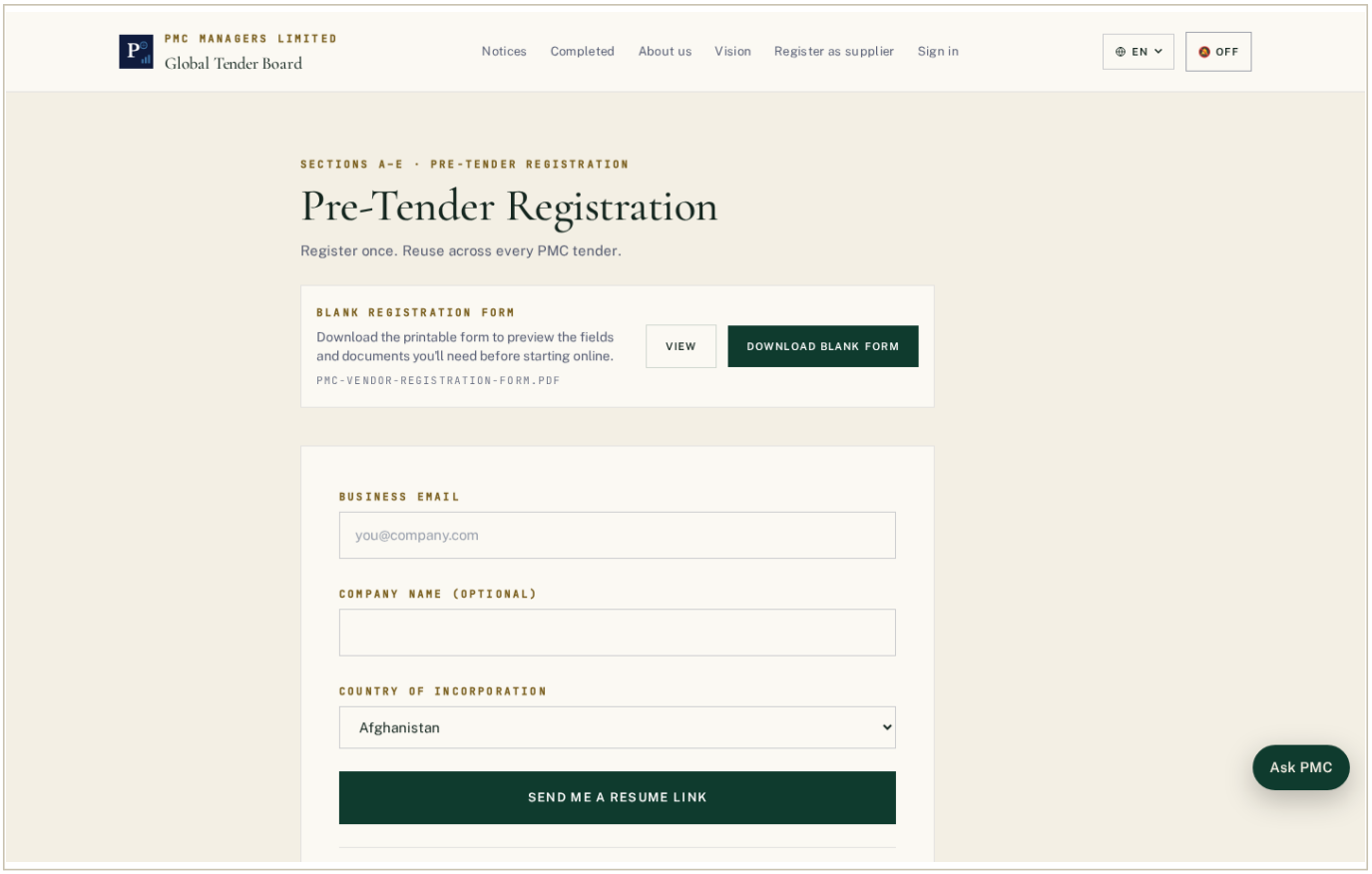
One sign-in page for every user. Choose your role first: Supplier, PMC staff, Admin, Escrow institution or Partner. Each role opens its own portal.

Main actions

- Choose your role
- Enter email and password
- Use Forgot password if needed

Supplier registration

Screen: `/register`



New suppliers create an account with company details. After email verification they complete KYC; PMC checks it before the supplier can bid.

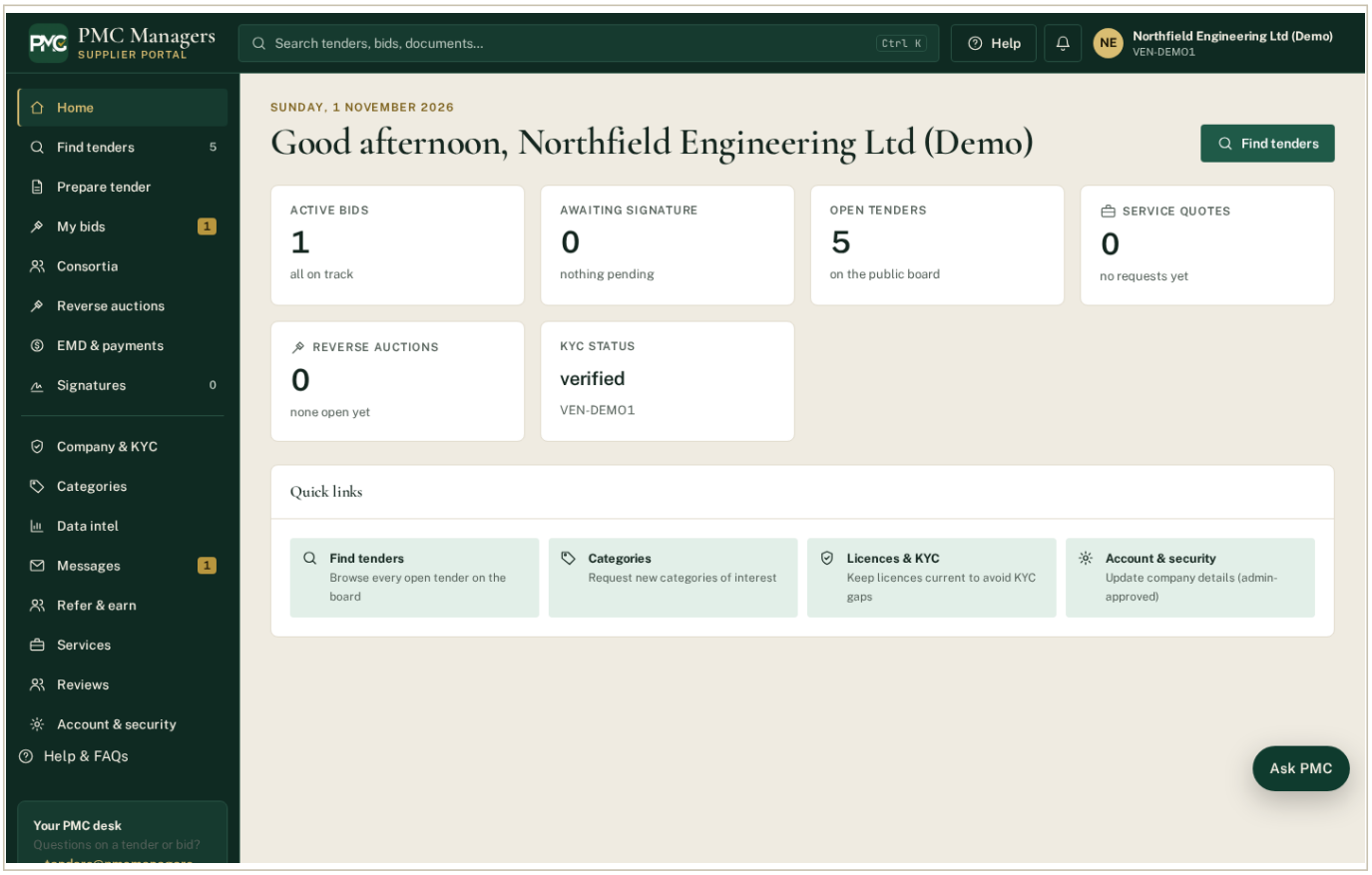
Main actions

- Enter company and contact details
- Verify email
- Complete KYC in the supplier portal

5 · Supplier portal — screen tour

Supplier dashboard

Screen: `/vendor`



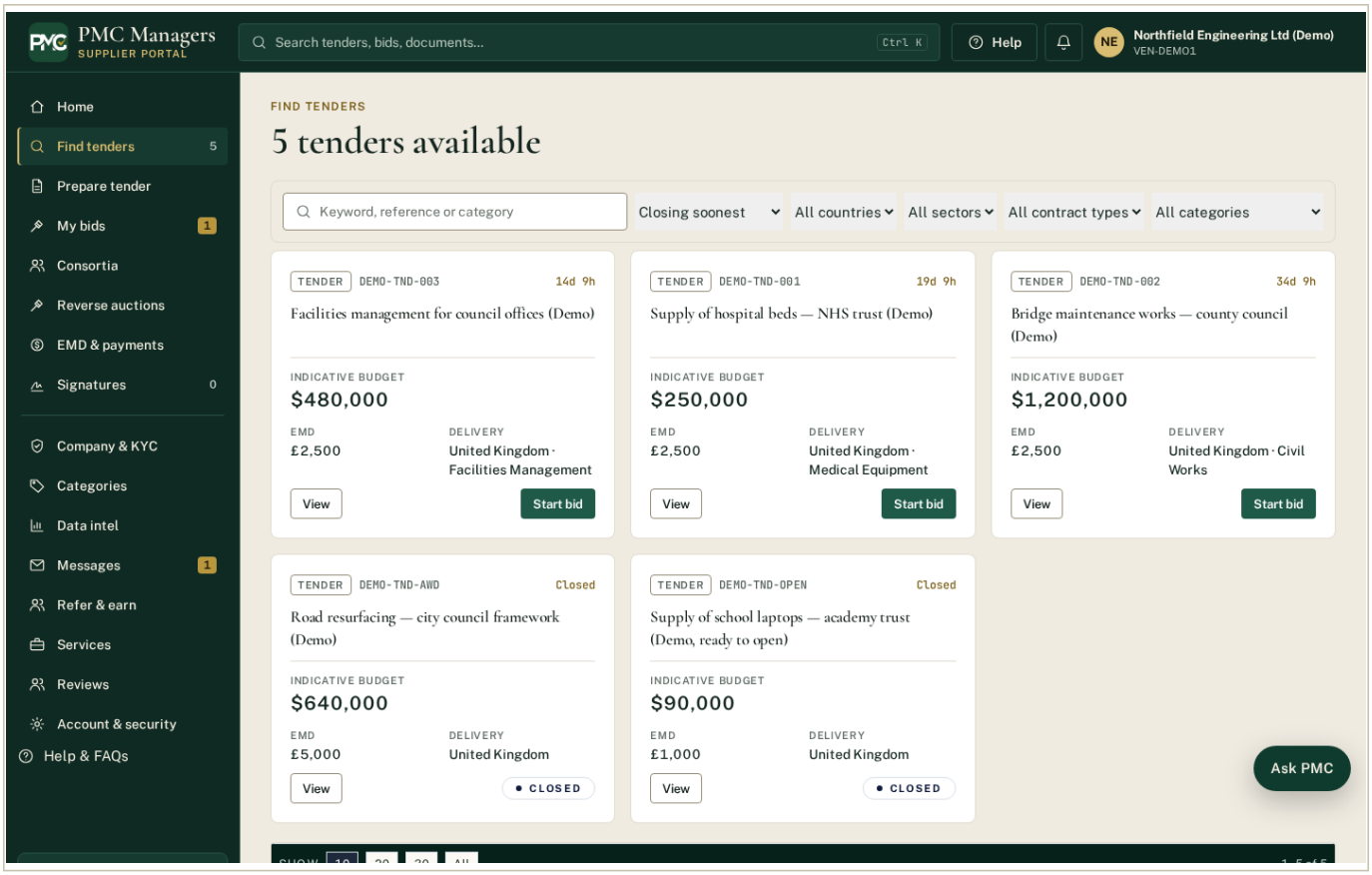
The supplier's home: matching tenders, open bids, notices and messages.

Main actions

- Find tenders
- Continue a bid

Tenders for you

Screen: `/vendor/tenders`



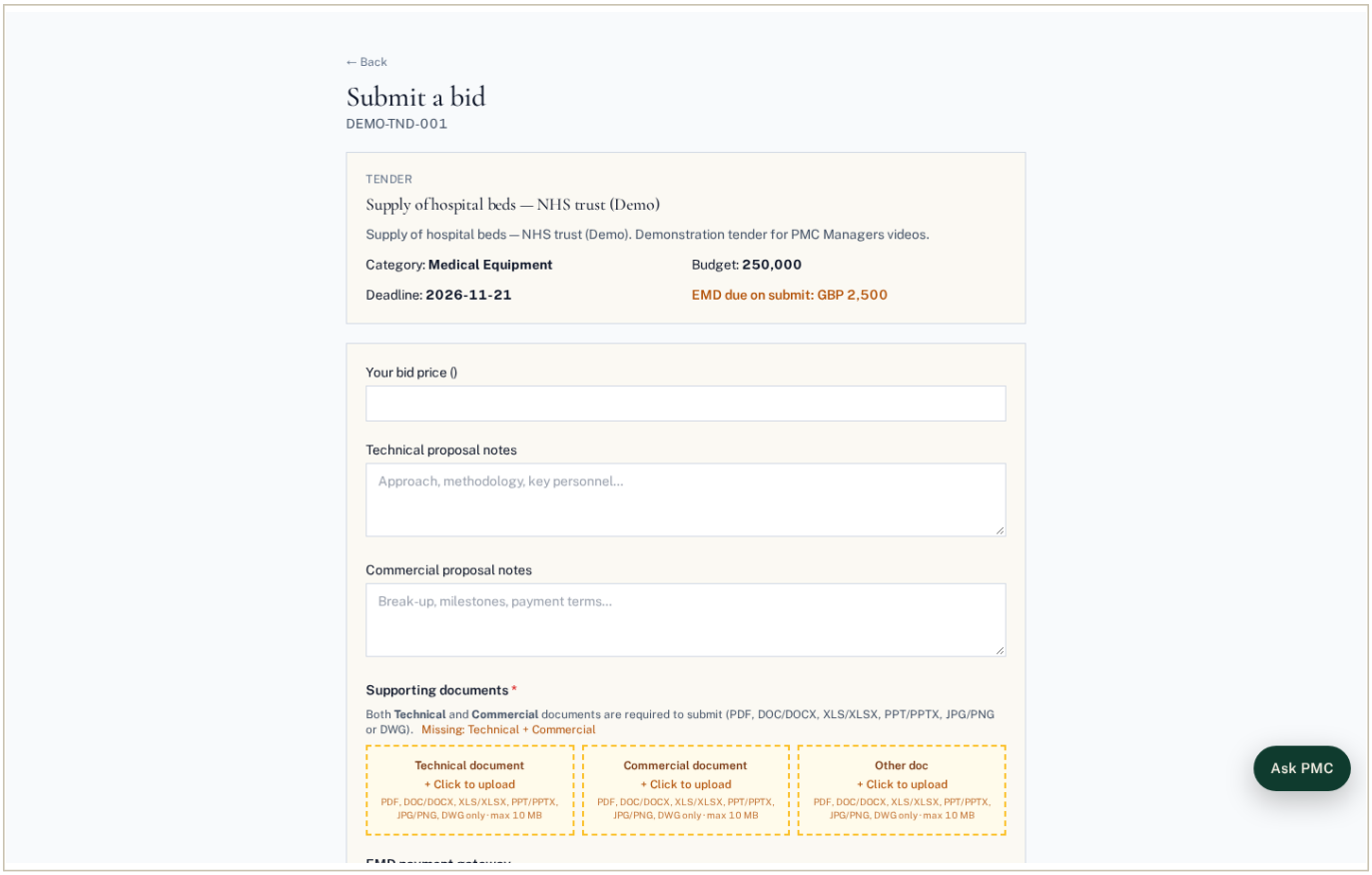
Tenders matching the supplier's categories, with closing dates.

Main actions

- Open a tender
- Start a bid

Prepare a bid

Screen: `/vendor/bid/new/DEMO-TND-001`



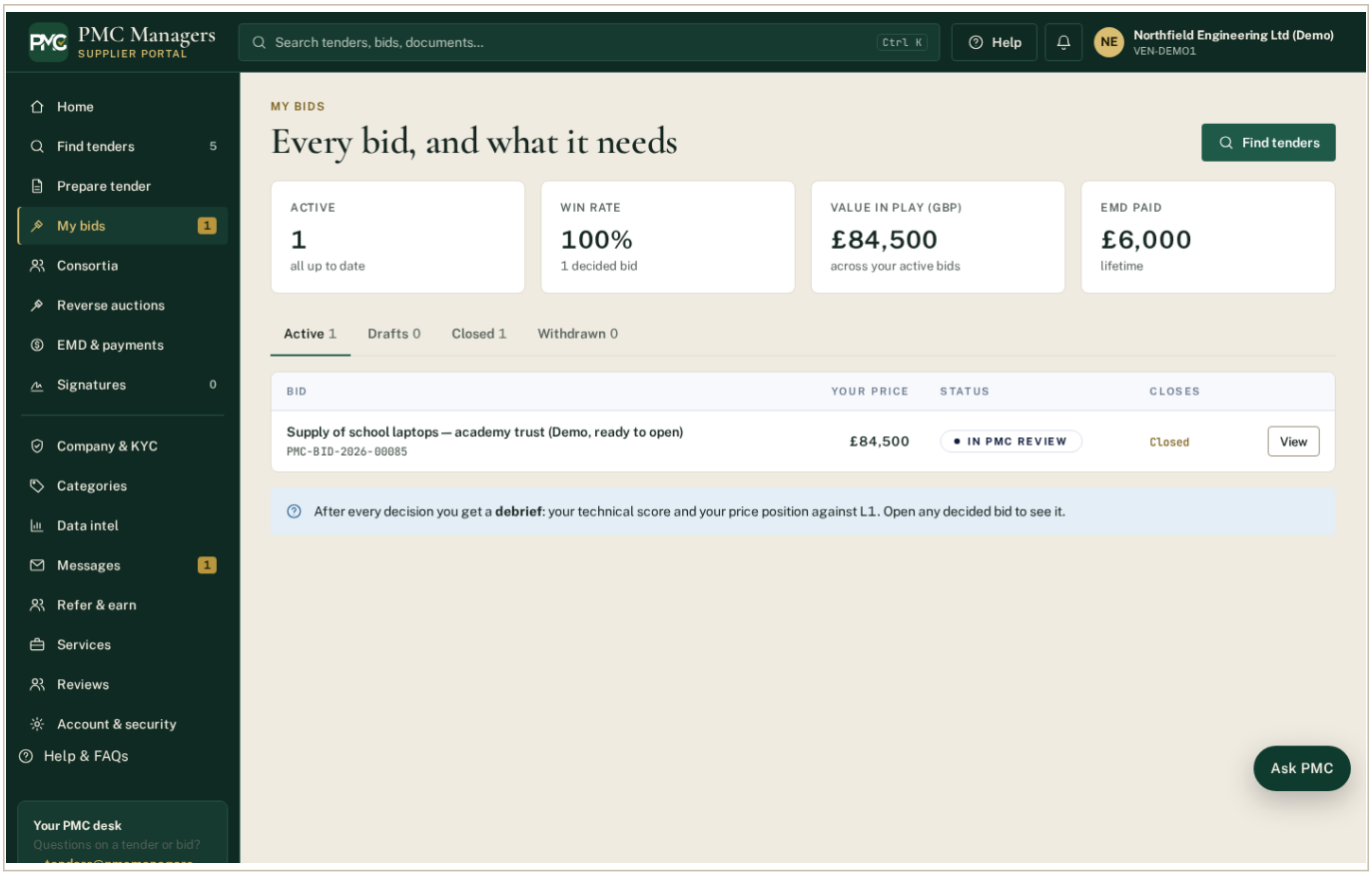
The bid form: technical documents, the Criteria section (each item marked Mandatory or Optional, with the rule for optional criteria), proofs, price and EMD. Everything is sealed when submitted.

Main actions

- Answer every mandatory criterion and attach proofs
- Enter price
- Submit (sealed)

My bids

Screen: `/vendor/mybids`



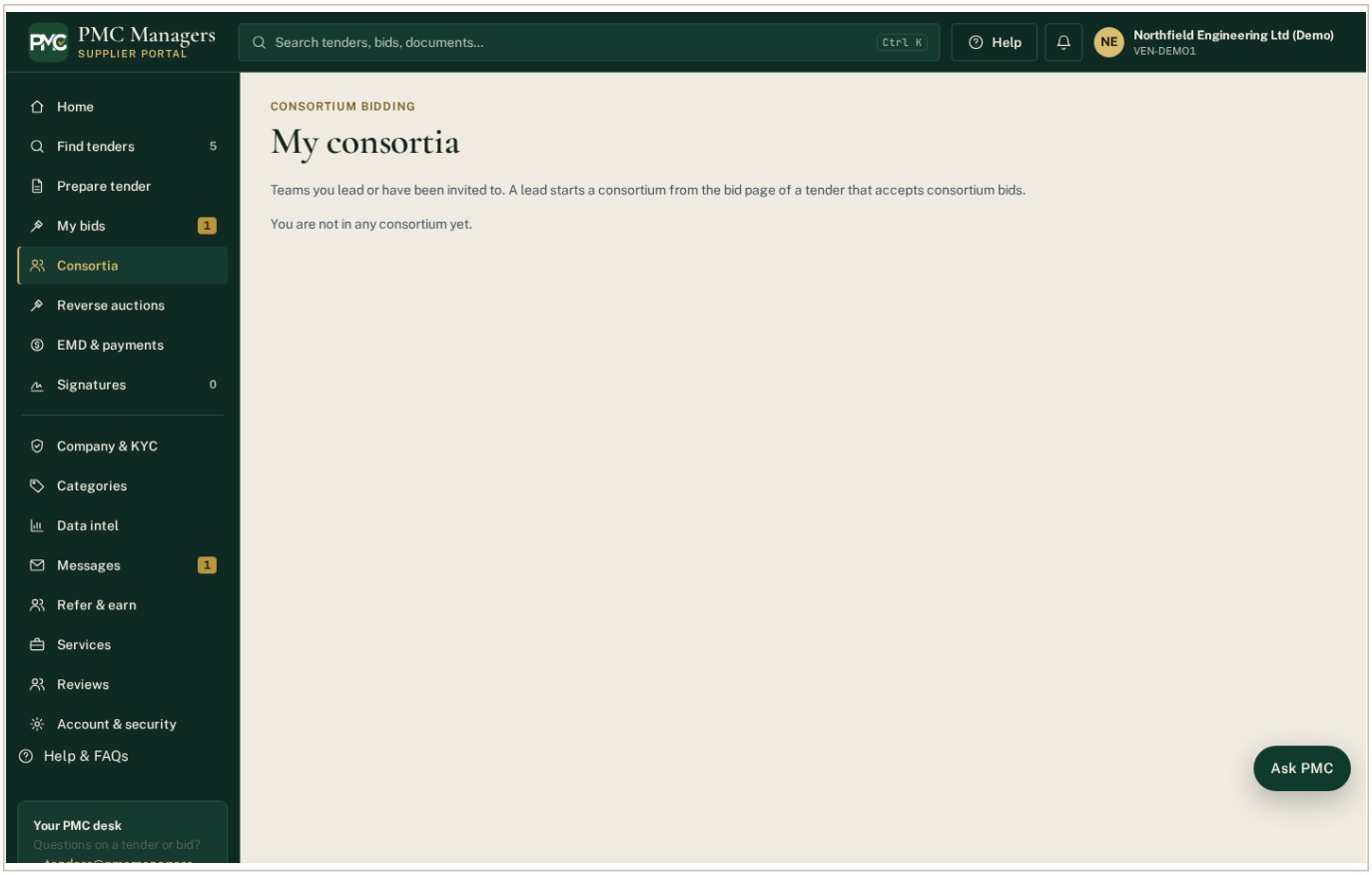
All of the supplier's bids with status, criteria result notices and award documents.

Main actions

- Open a bid workspace
- Read your result notice

Consortia

Screen: `/vendor/consortia`



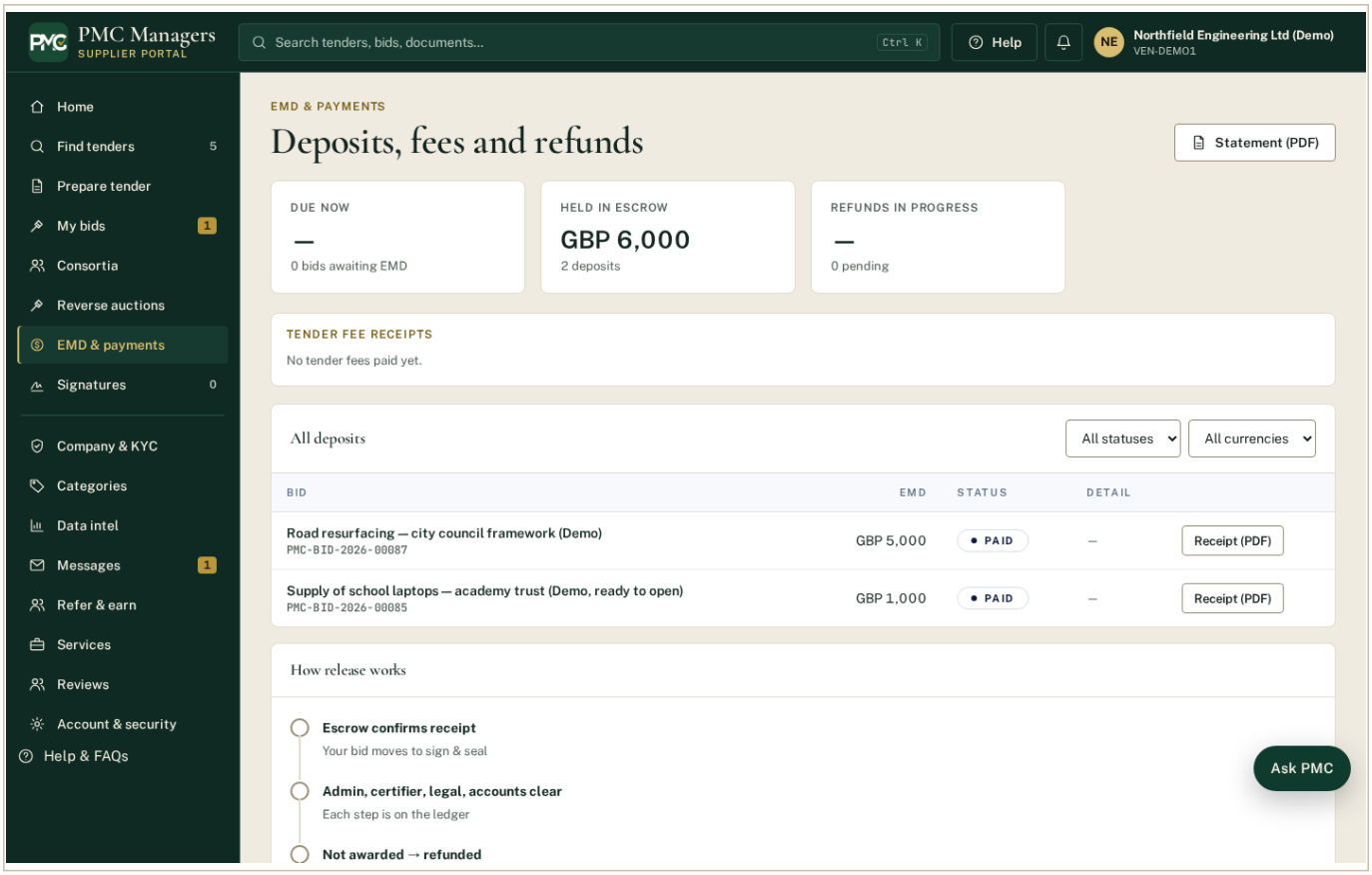
Consortium invitations, teams, shares, agreement signatures and member payouts.

Main actions

- Accept / decline an invitation
- Sign the agreement
- See your payout and bank reference

EMD & payments

Screen: `/vendor/emd`



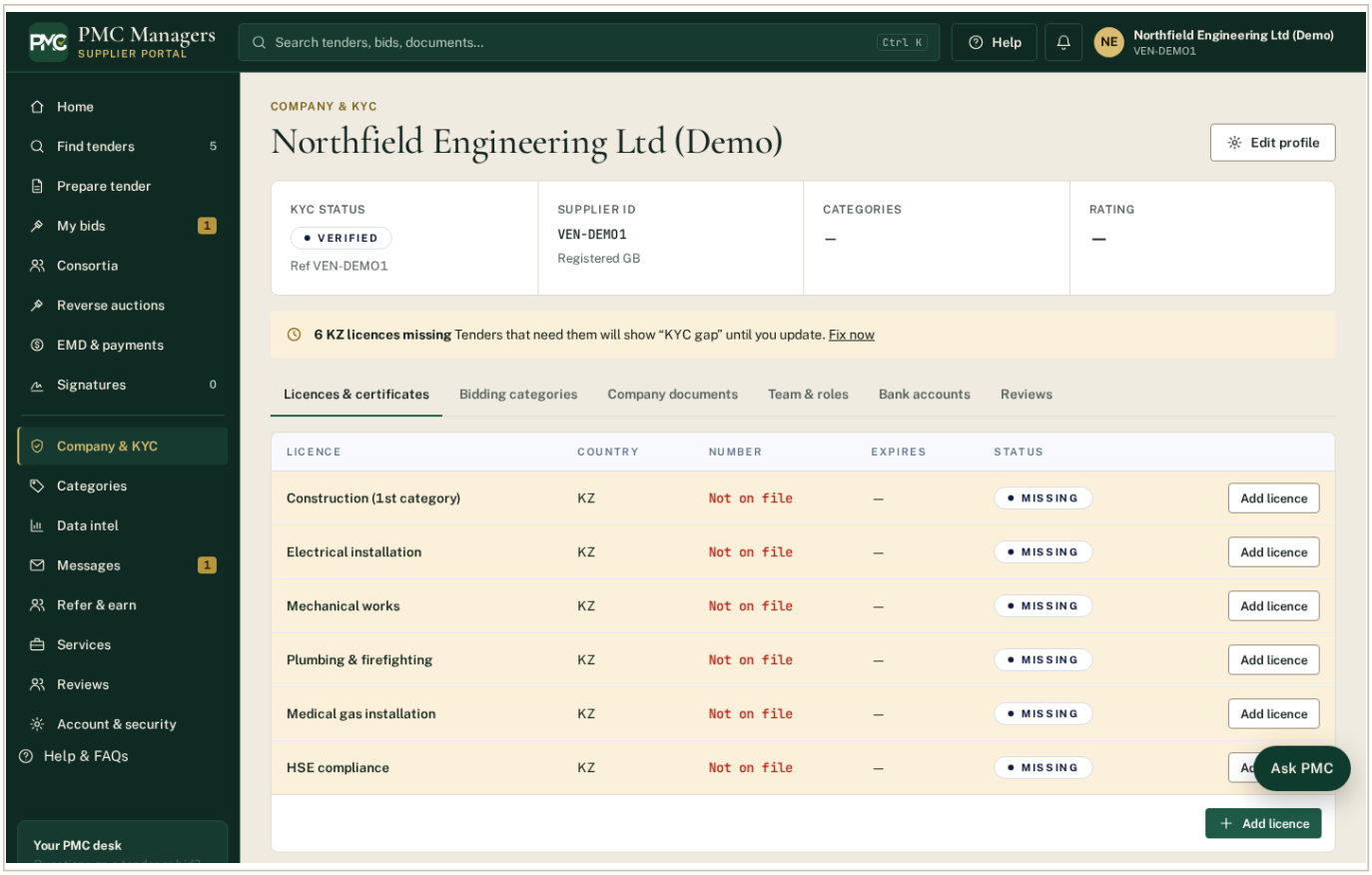
Bid deposits paid into escrow and refunds.

Main actions

- Pay EMD
- Track refunds

Company profile & KYC

Screen: `/vendor/company`



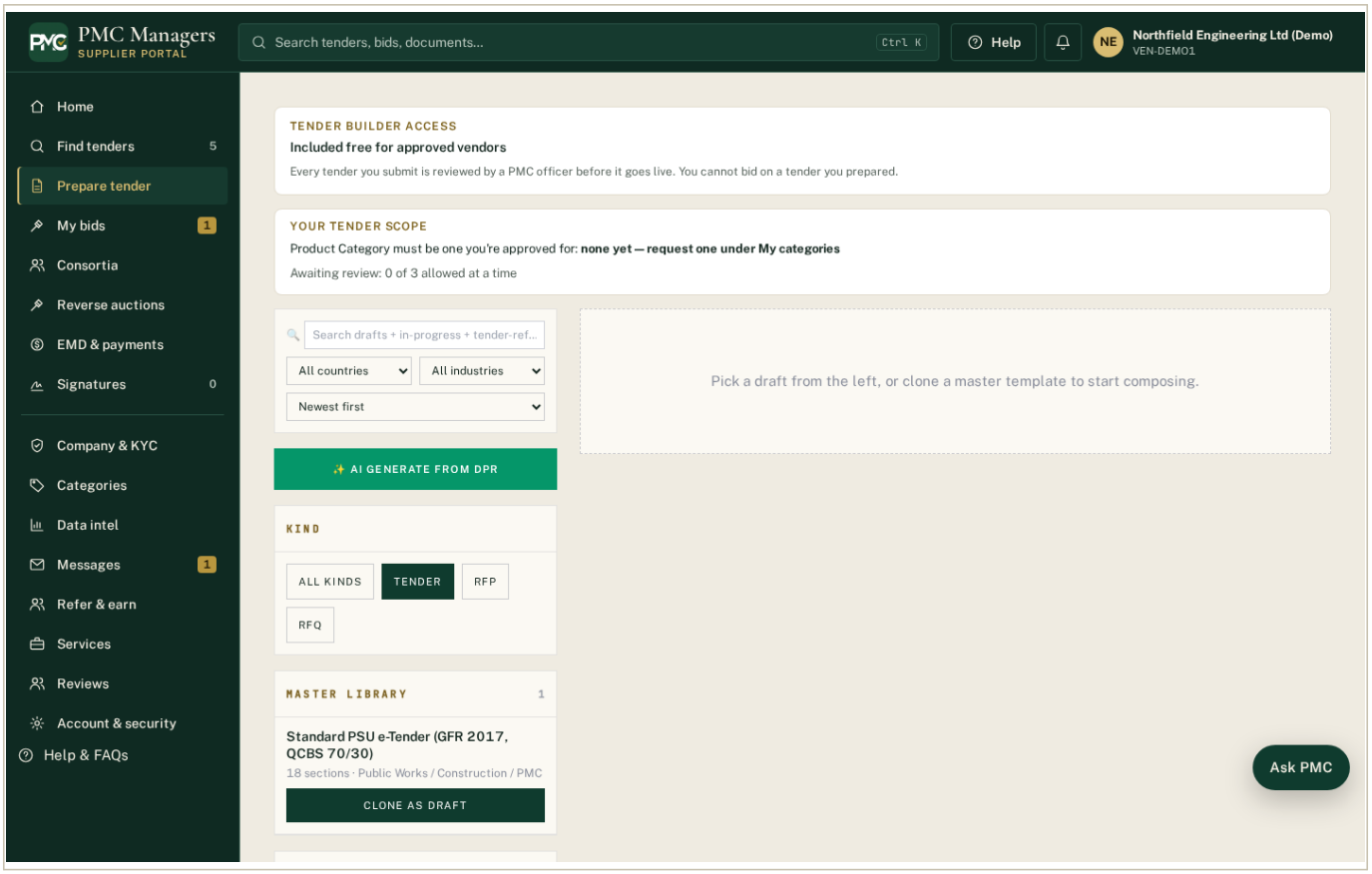
Company details, documents and KYC. Some figures here (like turnover) pre-fill criteria answers.

Main actions

- Update details (changes are reviewed)
- Upload KYC documents

Prepare tender (supplier)

Screen: `/vendor/tender-builder`



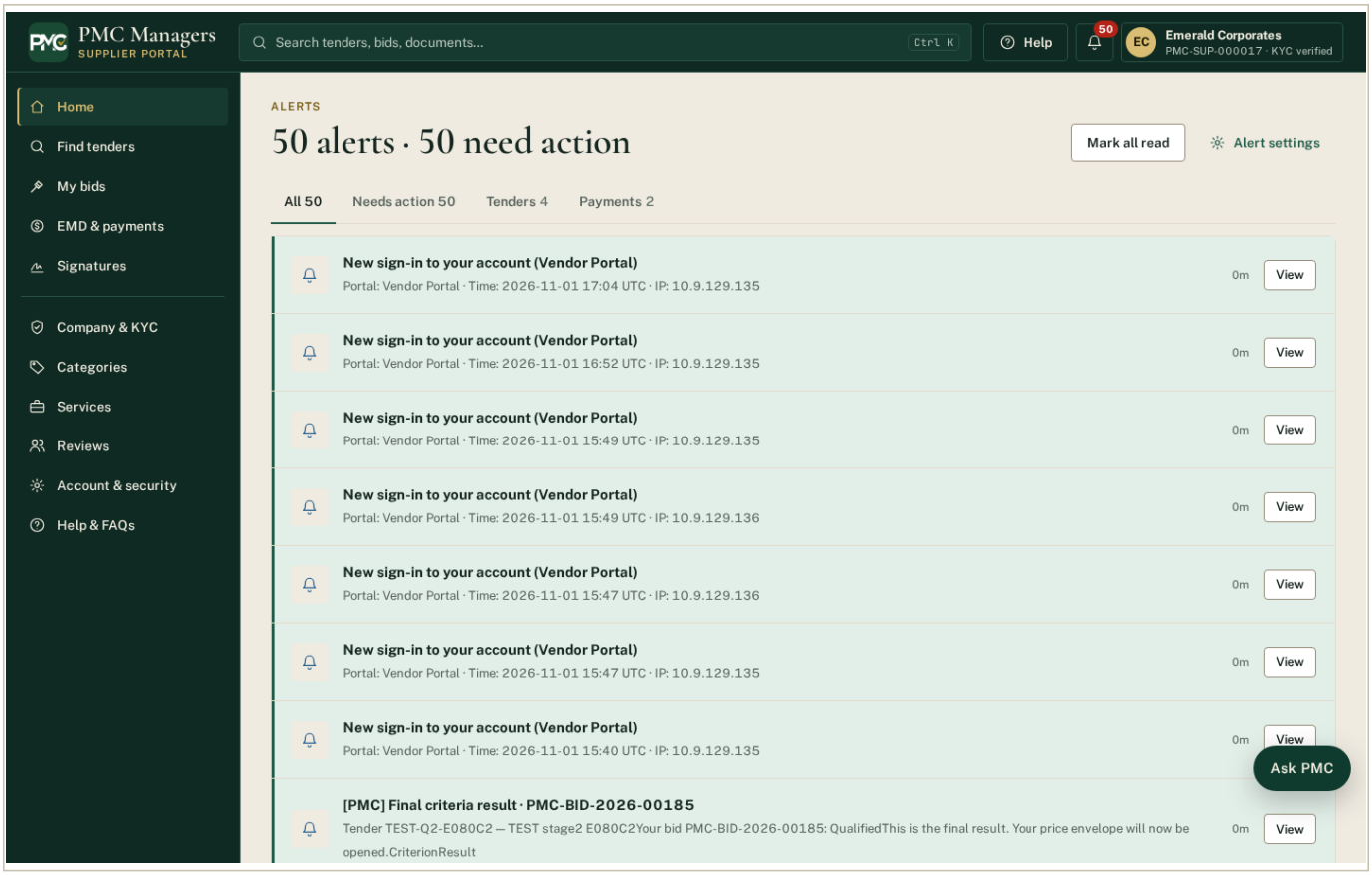
Verified suppliers can prepare tenders for buyers; they go to PMC review before publishing.

Main actions

- Build a tender
- Set criteria
- Submit for review

Alerts

Screen: `/vendor/alerts`



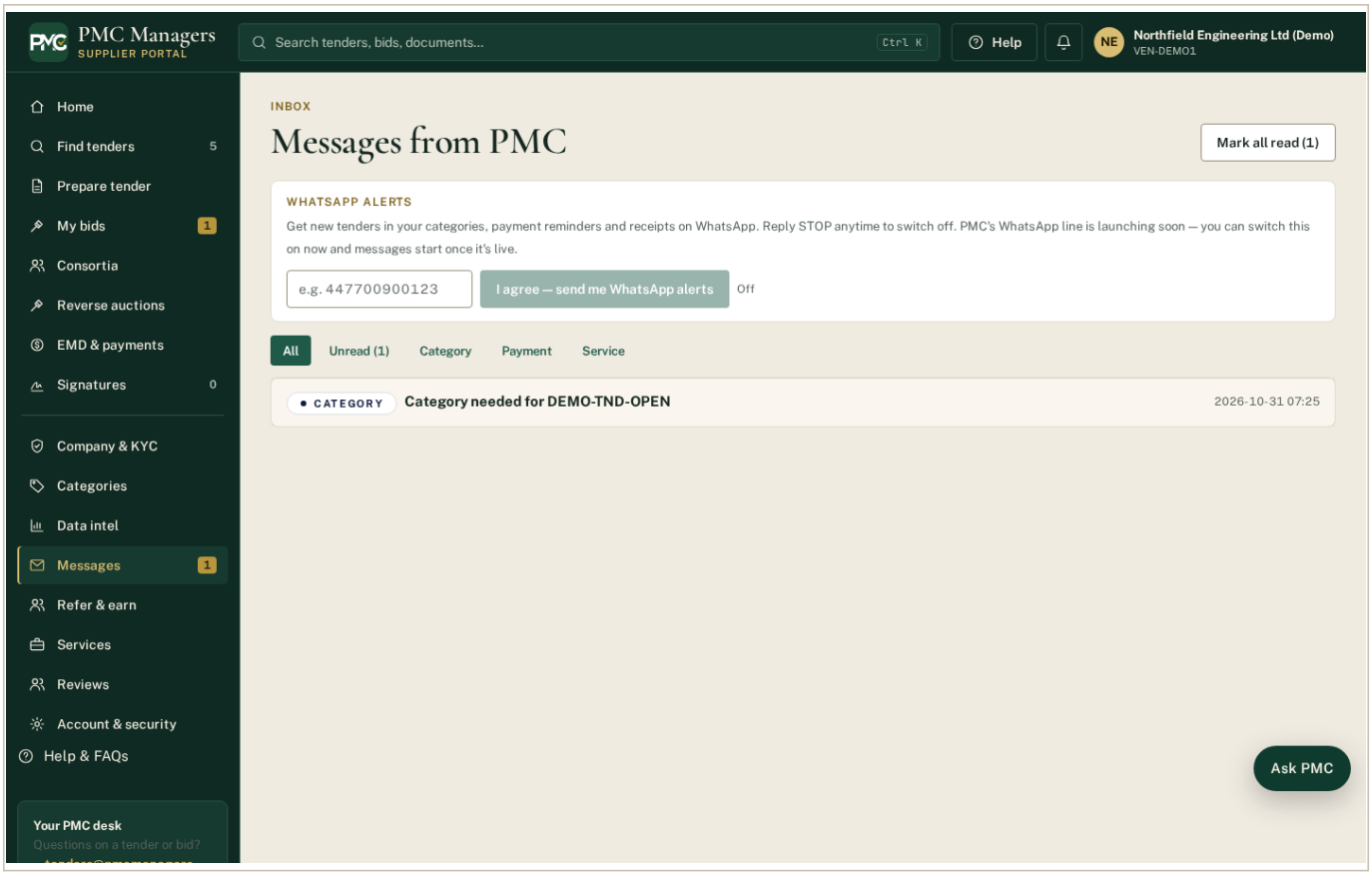
Tender alerts and notifications for the supplier's categories.

Main actions

- Mark as read
- Open the tender

Messages

Screen: `/vendor/messages`



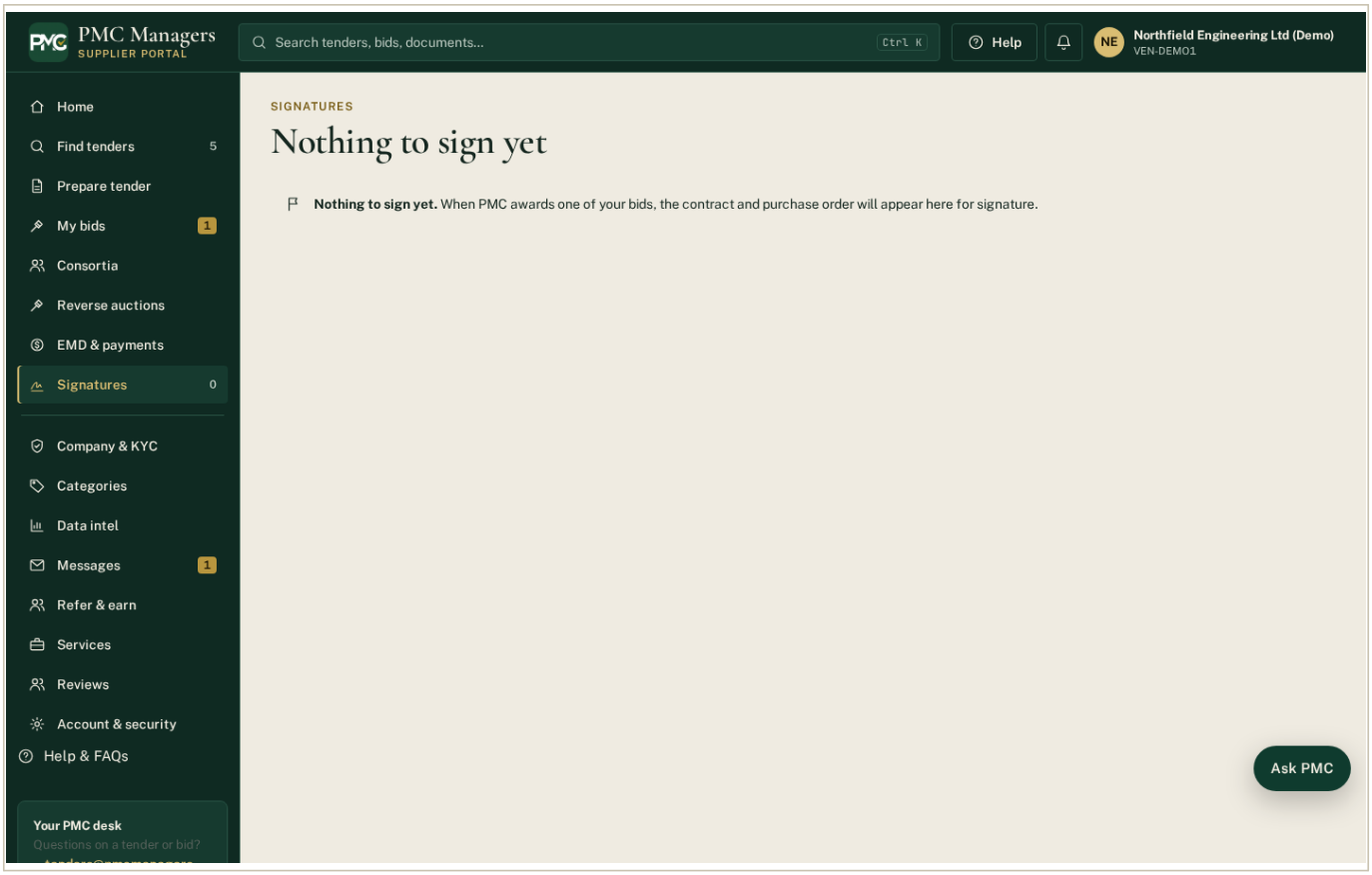
Messages with PMC and buyers, including clarifications.

Main actions

- Reply to a message

Signatures

Screen: `/vendor/signatures`



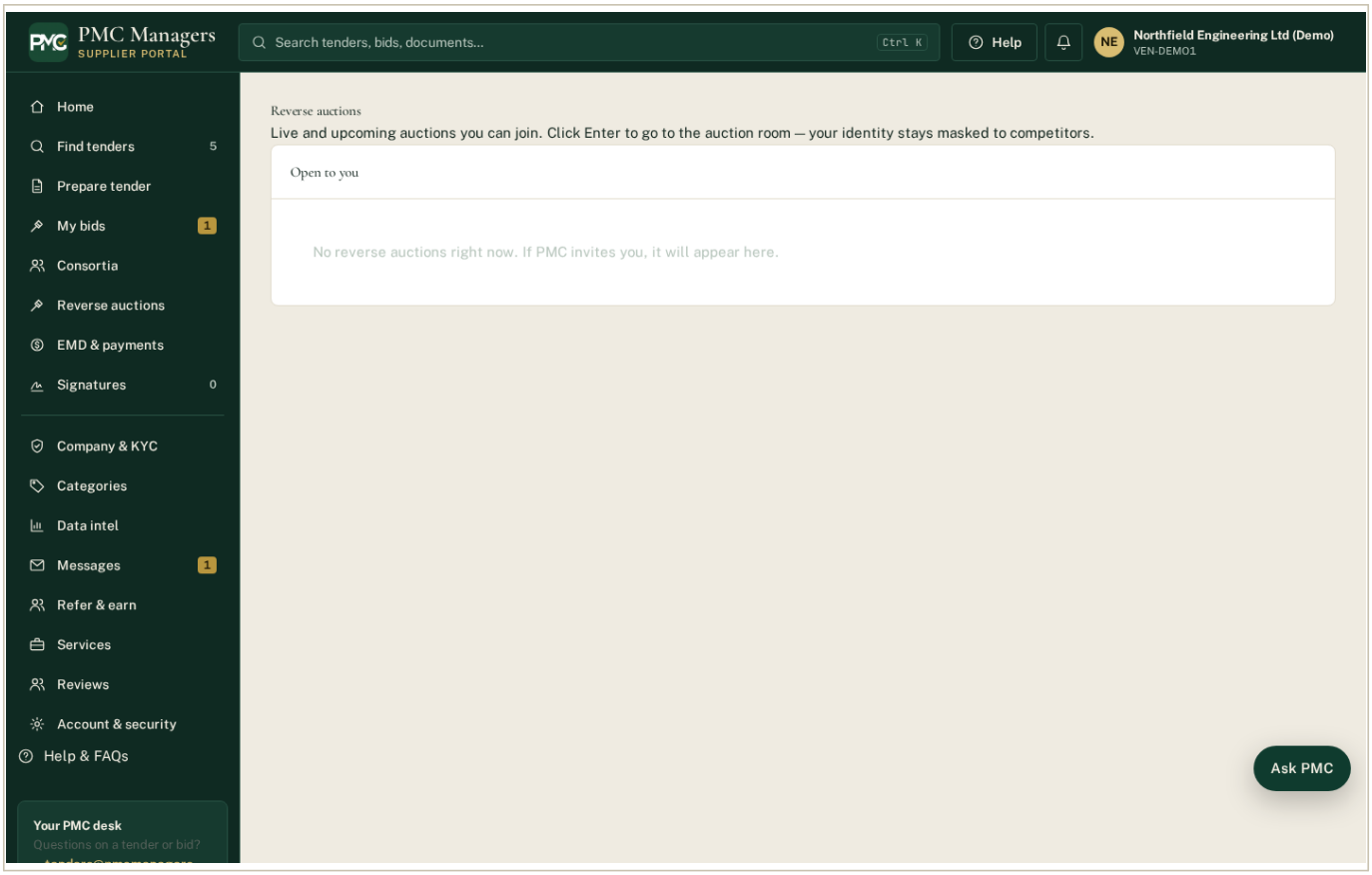
Documents waiting for the supplier's e-signature (agreements, contracts).

Main actions

- Sign a document

Reverse auctions

Screen: `/vendor/auctions`



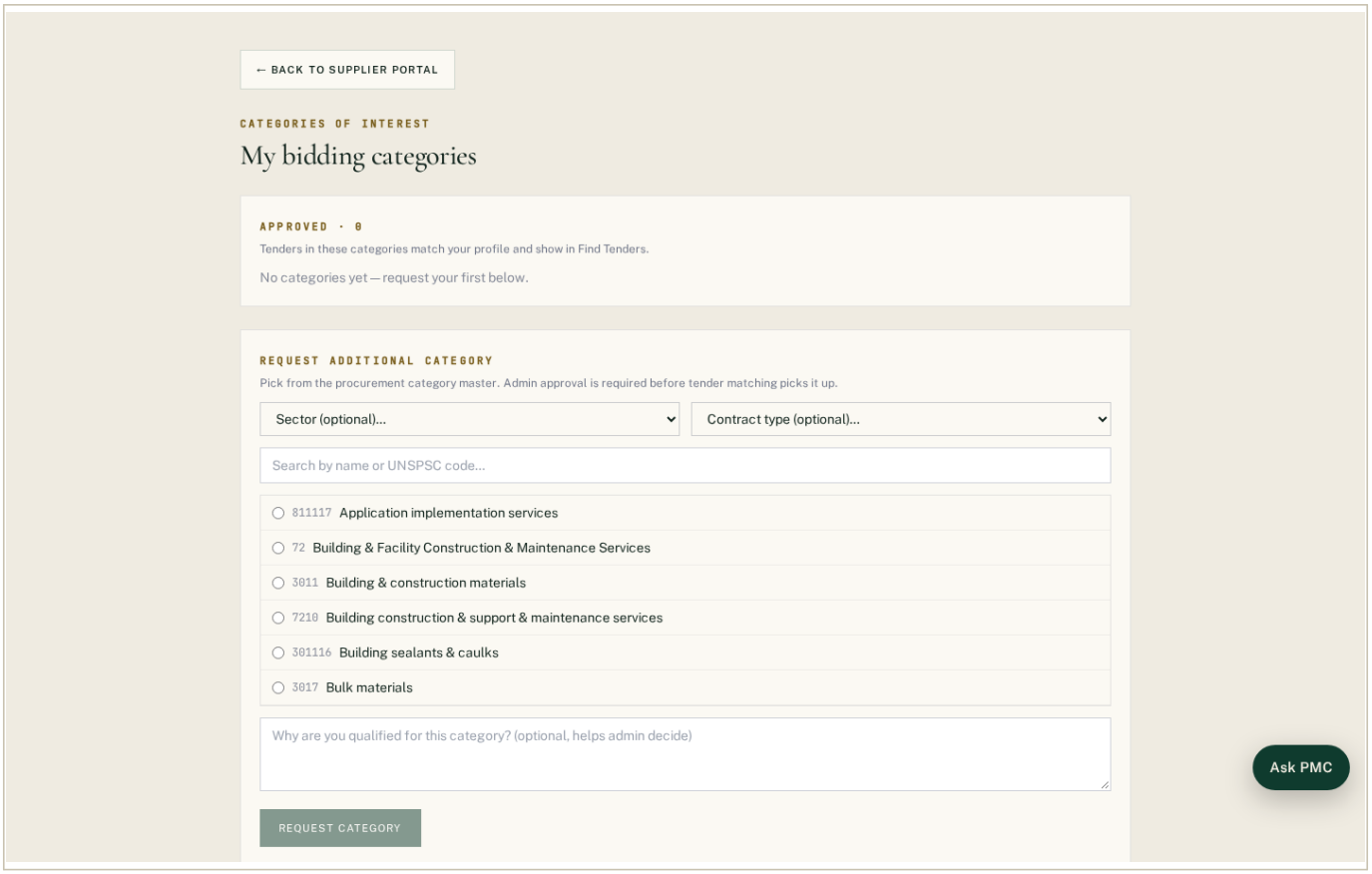
Auctions the supplier is invited to, with live bidding.

Main actions

- Join an auction
- Place a lower bid

Categories

Screen: `/vendor/categories`



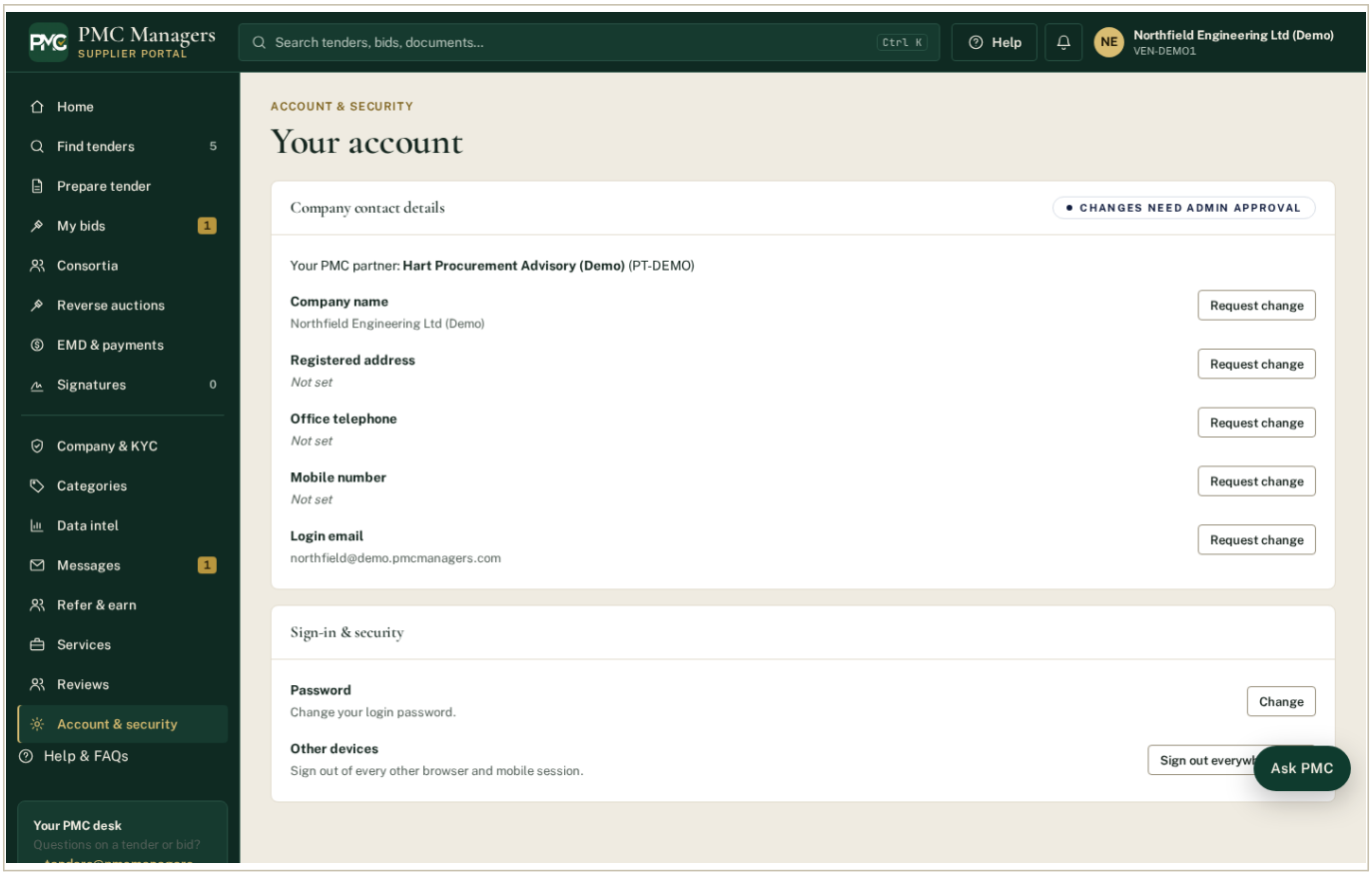
The categories the supplier works in; drives tender matching and alerts.

Main actions

• Request a new category

Account & security

Screen: `/vendor/account`



Login email, password, phone and security settings.

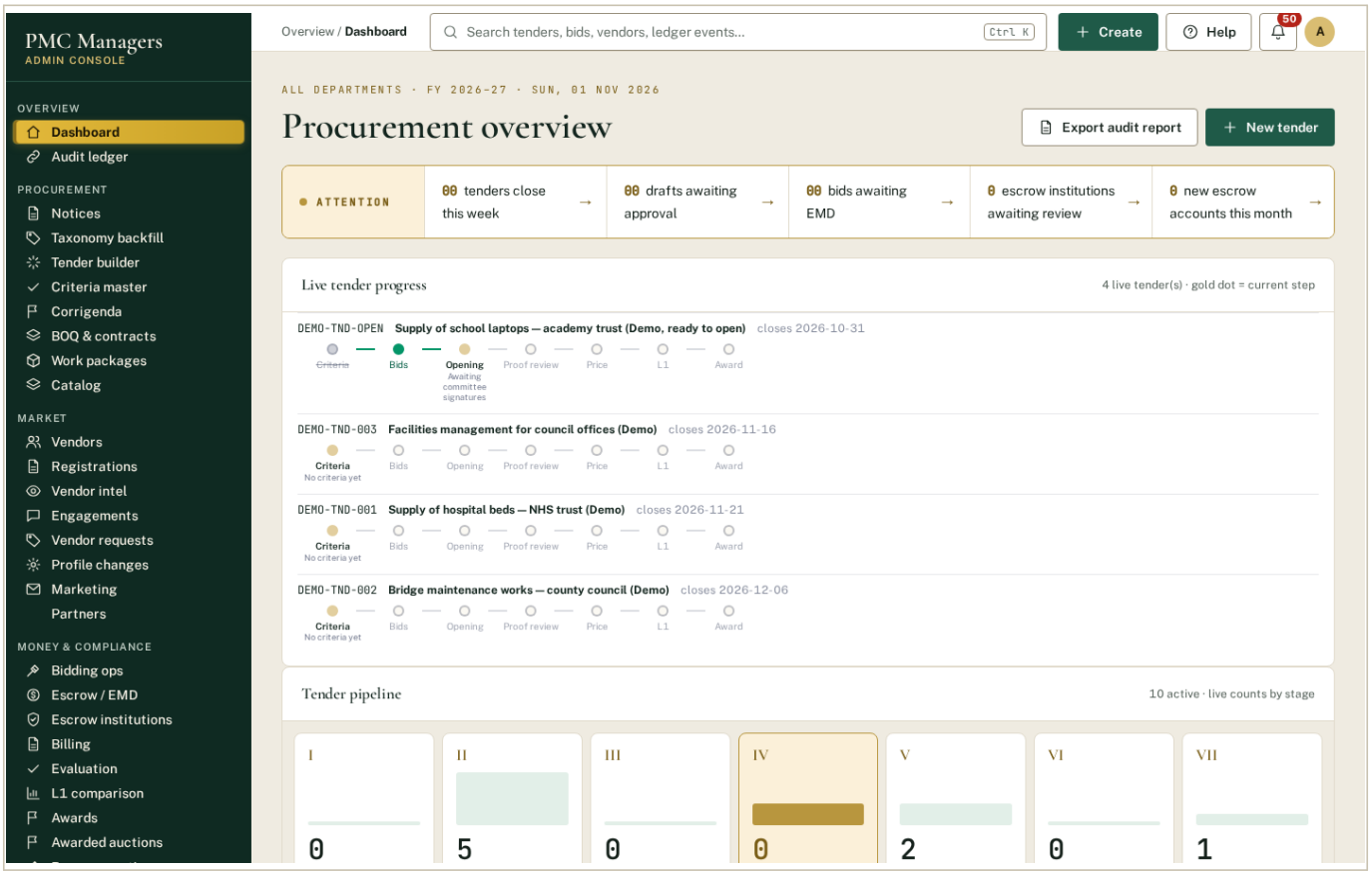
Main actions

- Change password
- Update contact details

6 · Admin console — screen tour

Admin dashboard

Screen: `/admin/e/dashboard`



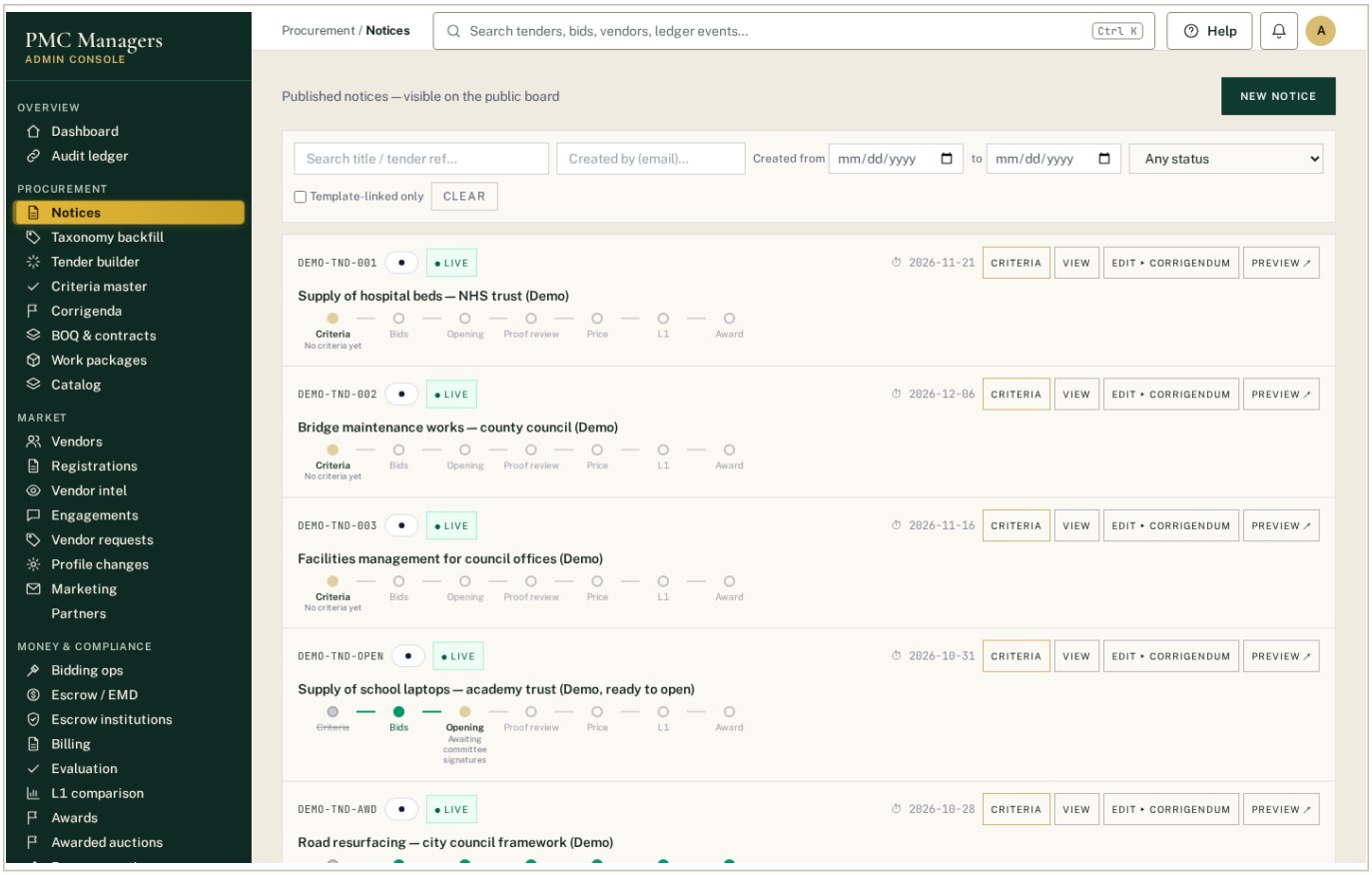
The control room. Attention cards show tenders closing this week, drafts awaiting approval and bids awaiting EMD. 'Live tender progress' shows every live tender's stage line (criteria, bids, opening, proof review, price, L1, award) so stalled tenders stand out.

Main actions

- Click an attention card to jump to the list
- Open a tender from Live tender progress
- Create a new tender

Notices

Screen: `/admin/e/notices`



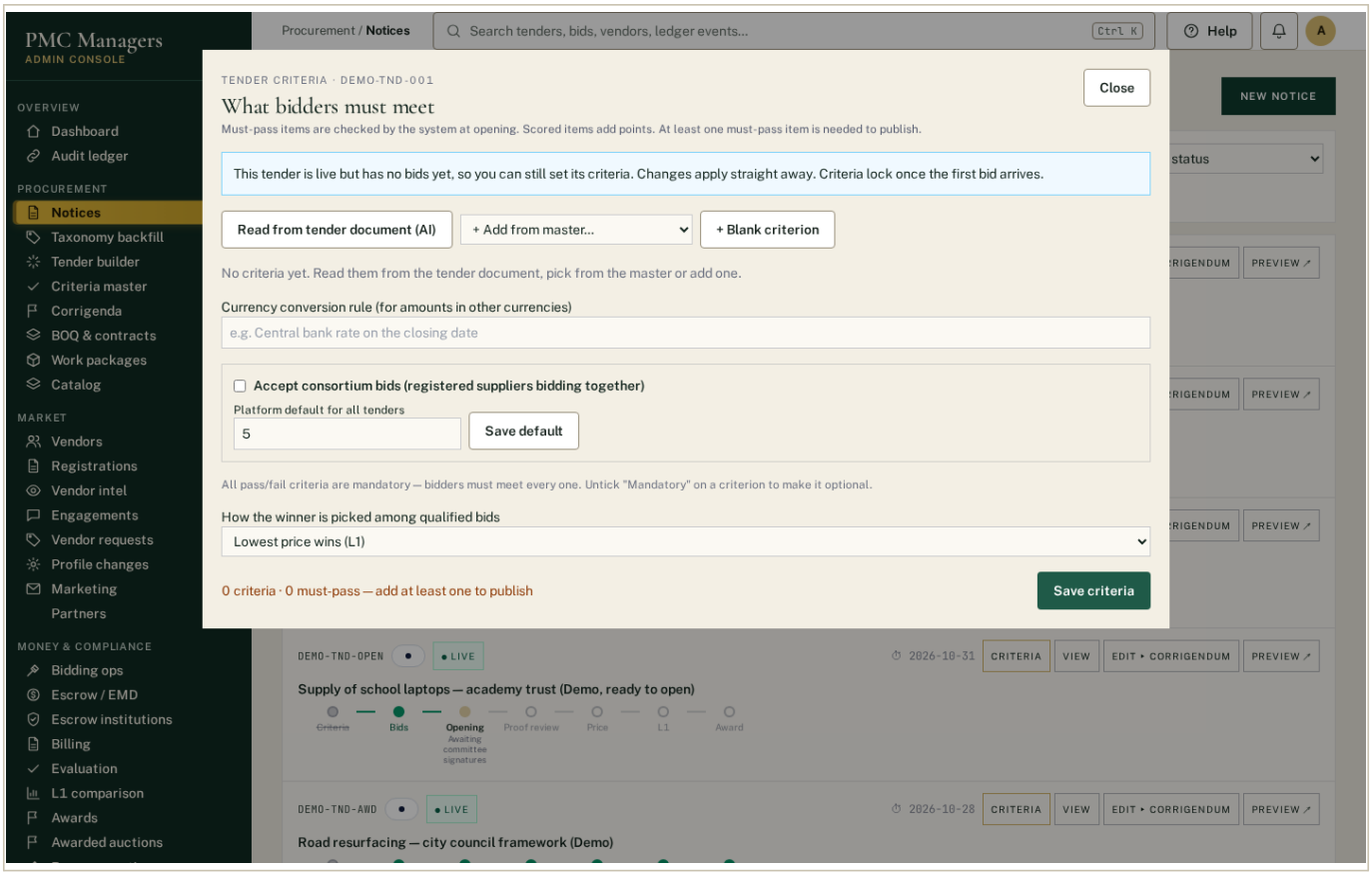
All tenders (draft and live). Each row has the progress tracker, Criteria, View, Edit/Corrigendum and Preview. Draft rows show the 'Ready to publish?' checklist (document, dates, a must-pass criterion) with its own Publish button.

Main actions

- New notice (the Criteria window opens after Create)
- Criteria: set what bidders must meet
- Publish once the checklist is all ticked

Criteria window

Screen: `/admin/e/notices`



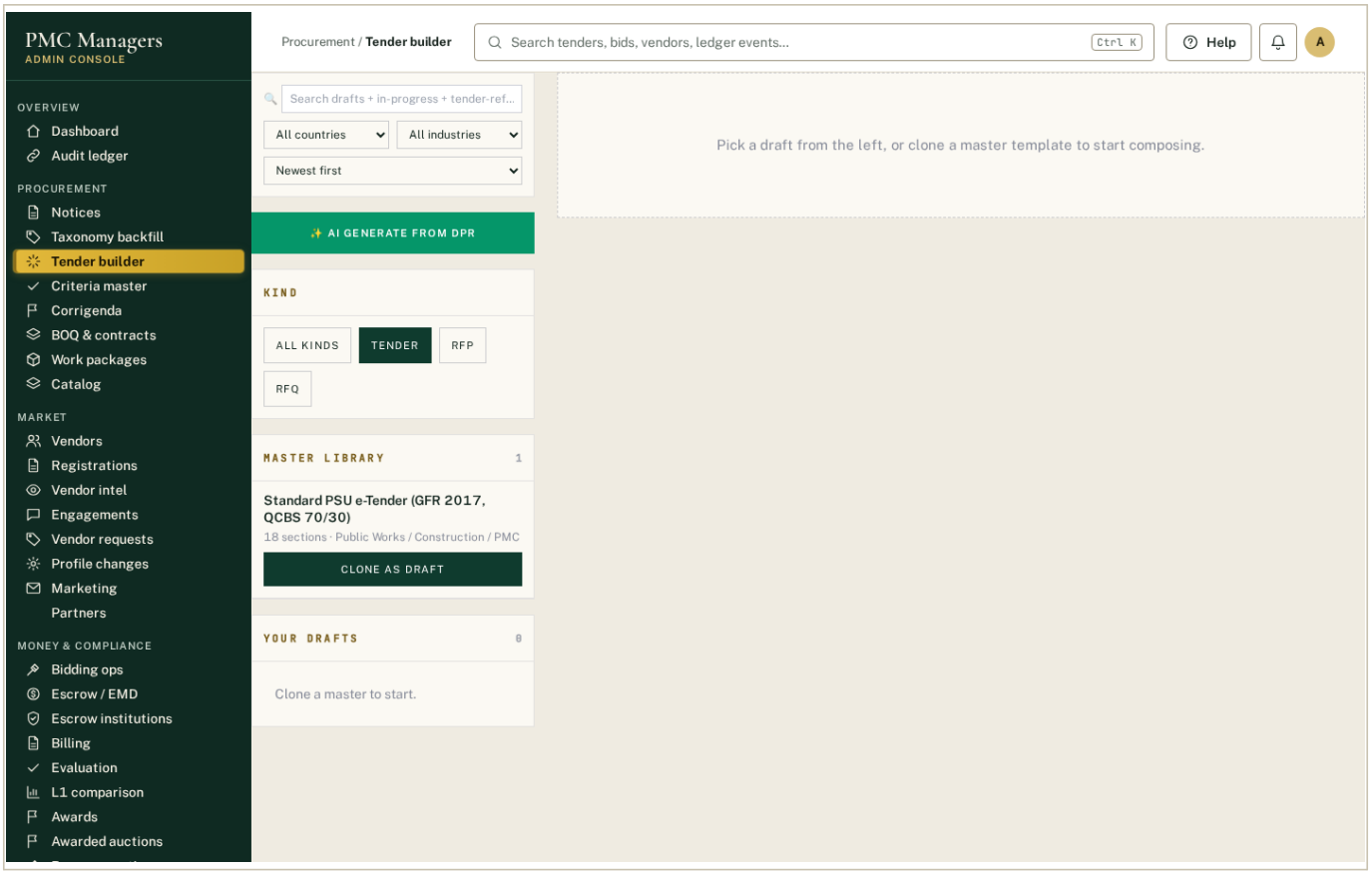
Sets the tender's criteria. Add from the Criteria master or a whole set, read them from the tender document with AI, or add your own. Each criterion is pass/fail or scored, Mandatory or optional, with proof required or not. Also set the minimum optional criteria, consortium rules and how the winner is picked (L1 or weighted).

Main actions

- + Add from master / a criteria set
- Tick Mandatory or leave optional
- Set 'at least N optional criteria'
- Choose L1 or weighted
- Save criteria

Tender builder

Screen: `/admin/e/tender-builder`



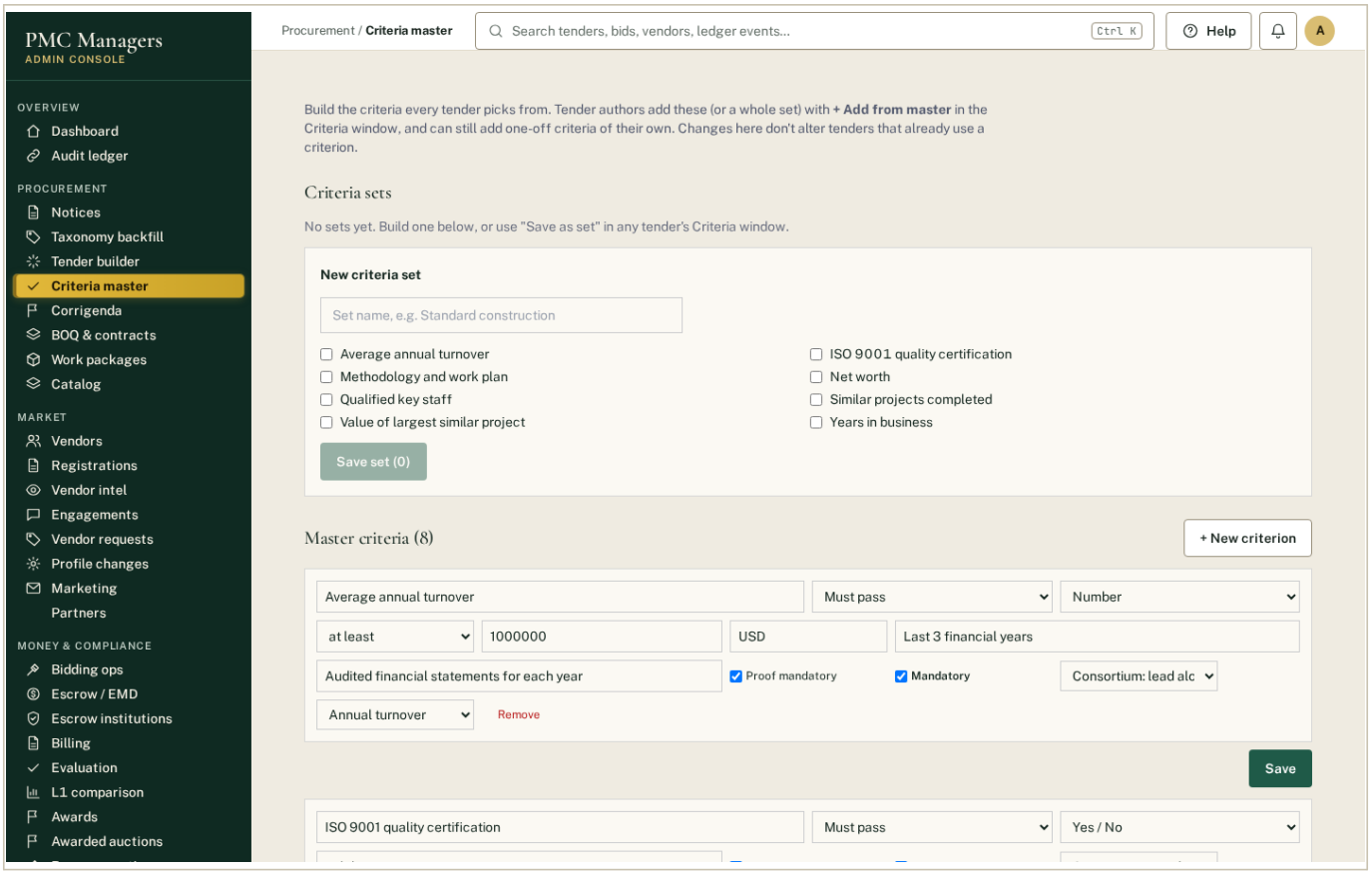
Builds the tender document. Clone a master template or use 'AI generate from DPR' to draft a tender from a project report. Drafts have a Criteria button and 'Create notice' to turn the draft into a notice (criteria come across).

Main actions

- AI generate from DPR
- Clone a master template
- Criteria
- Create notice

Criteria master

Screen: `/admin/e/criteria-master`



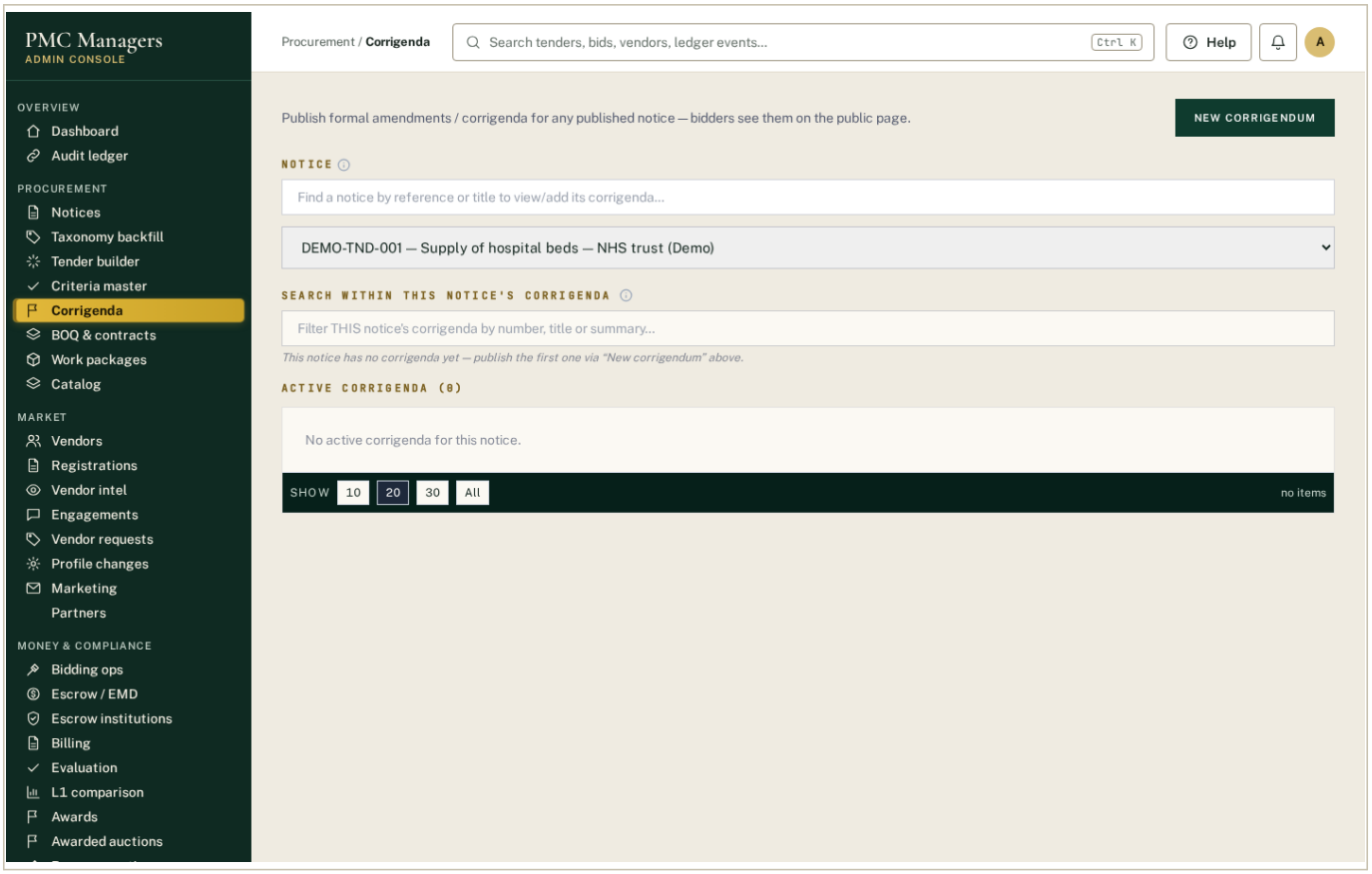
The library every tender picks criteria from. Build master criteria and named sets such as 'Standard construction'. Admins and reviewers can edit; removing archives (nothing is deleted).

Main actions

- + New criterion
- Build a criteria set
- Remove (archive) a criterion or set

Corrigenda

Screen: `/admin/e/corrigenda`



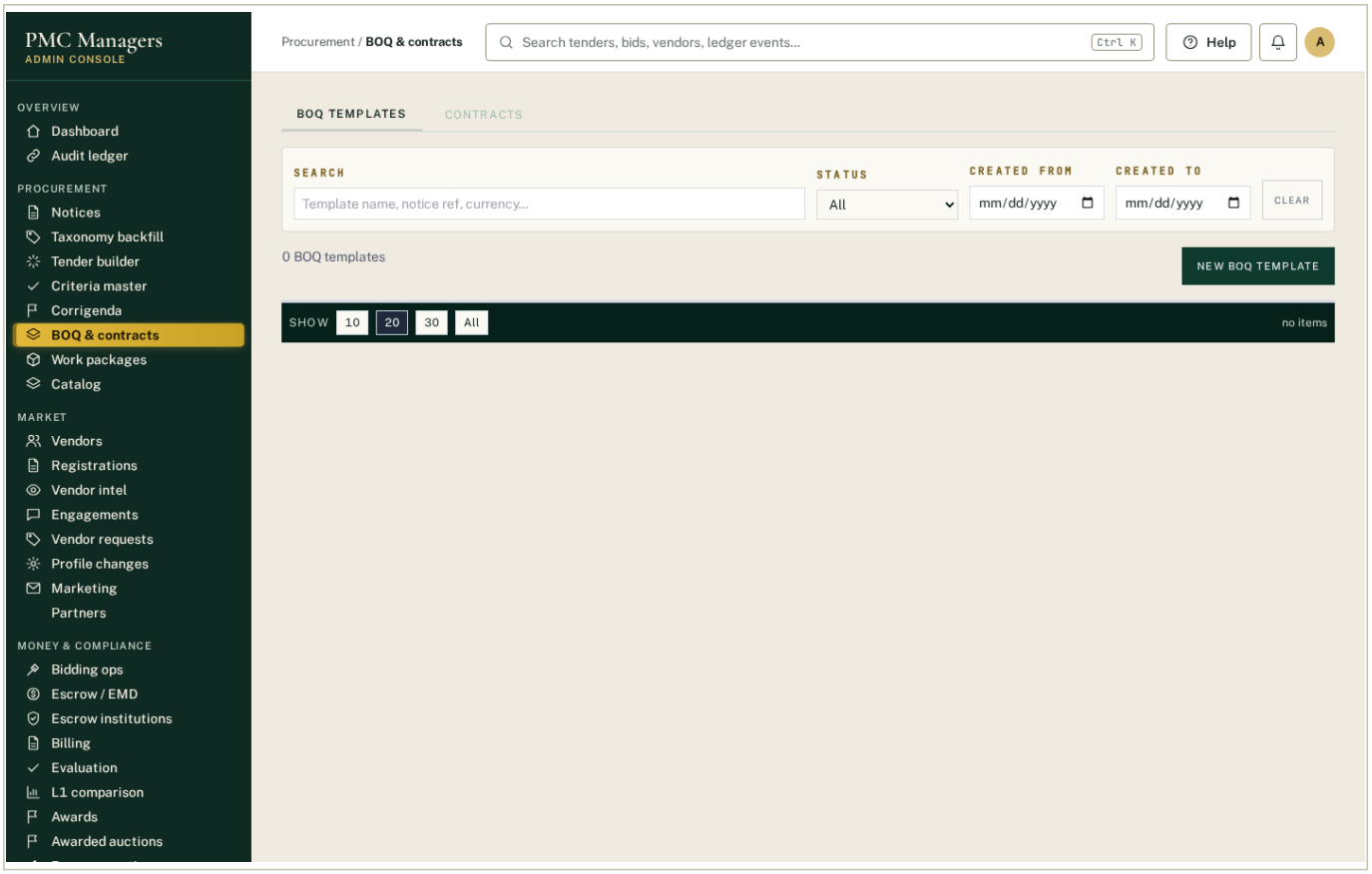
Changes to live tenders. Each corrigendum is dated, described and sent to every bidder and follower.

Main actions

- Issue a corrigendum
- See the history per tender

BOQ & contracts

Screen: `/admin/e/boq`



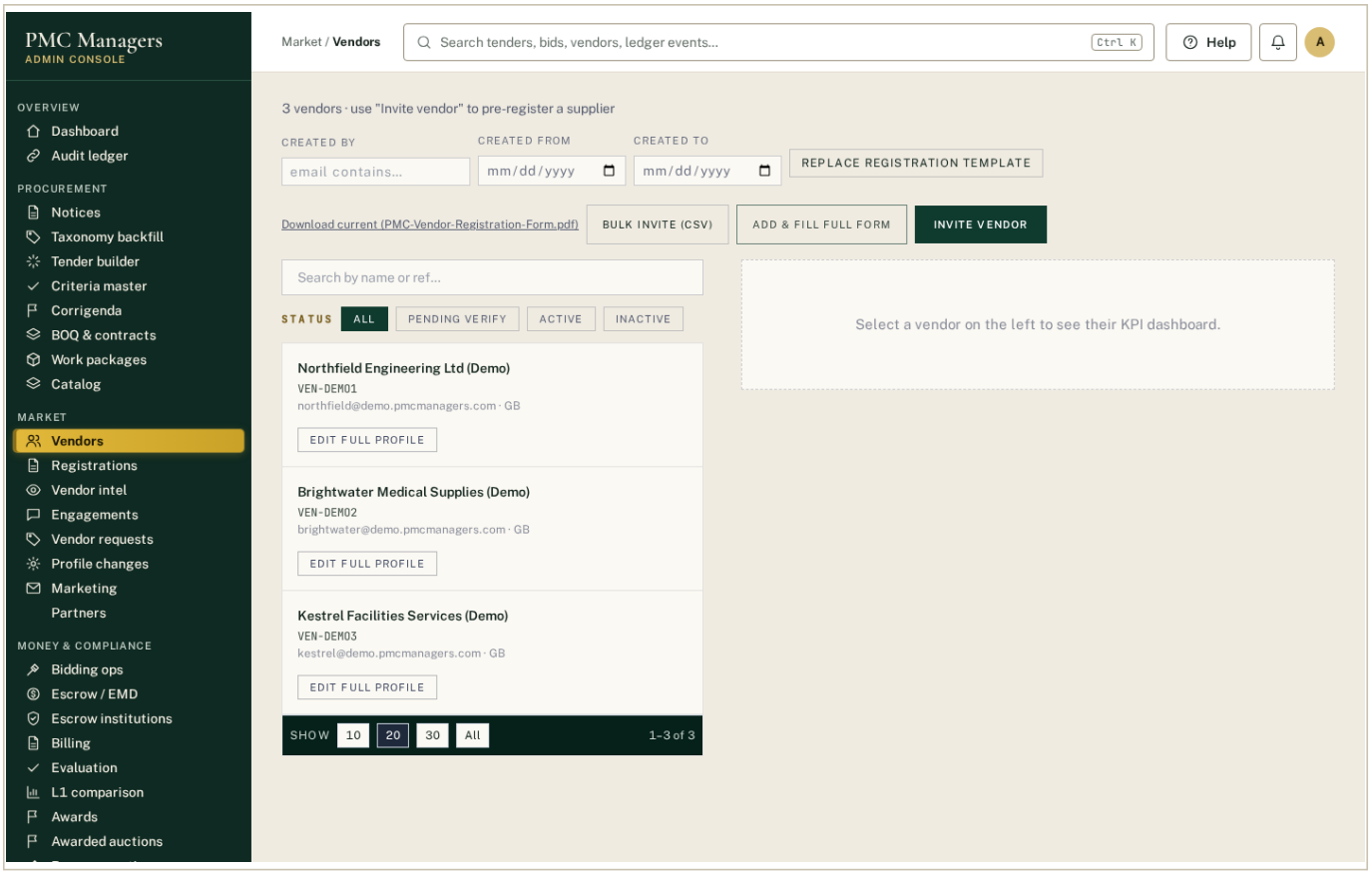
Bills of quantities and contract documents linked to tenders.

Main actions

- Upload or edit a BOQ
- Attach contract documents

Vendors

Screen: `/admin/e/vendors`



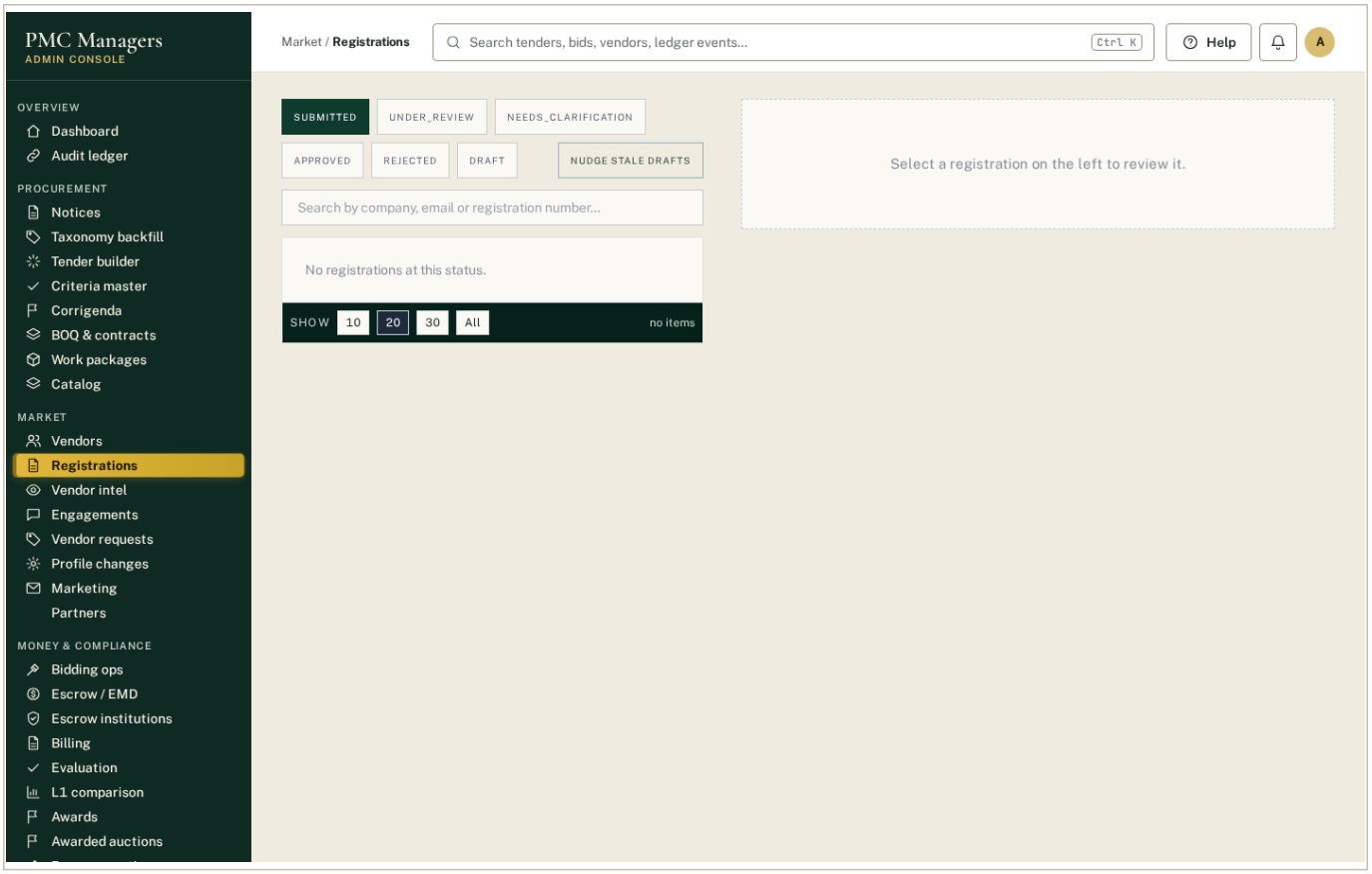
Every registered supplier with KYC status, categories and activity.

Main actions

- Open a supplier profile
- Check KYC status

Registrations

Screen: `/admin/e/registrations`



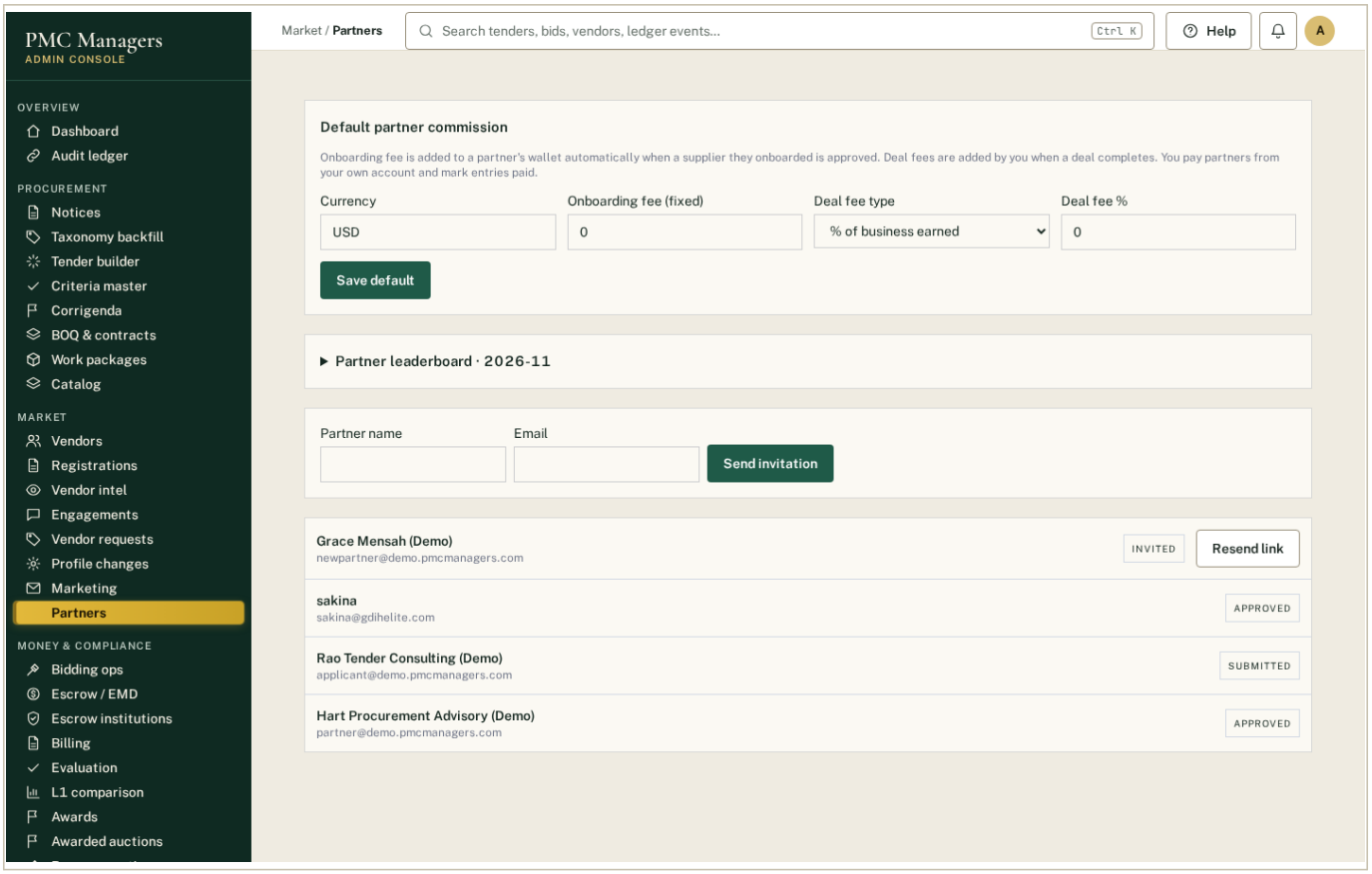
New supplier registrations waiting for KYC review. Approve, ask for clarification or reject with a reason.

Main actions

- Review documents
- Approve / request changes / reject

Partners

Screen: `/admin/e/partners`



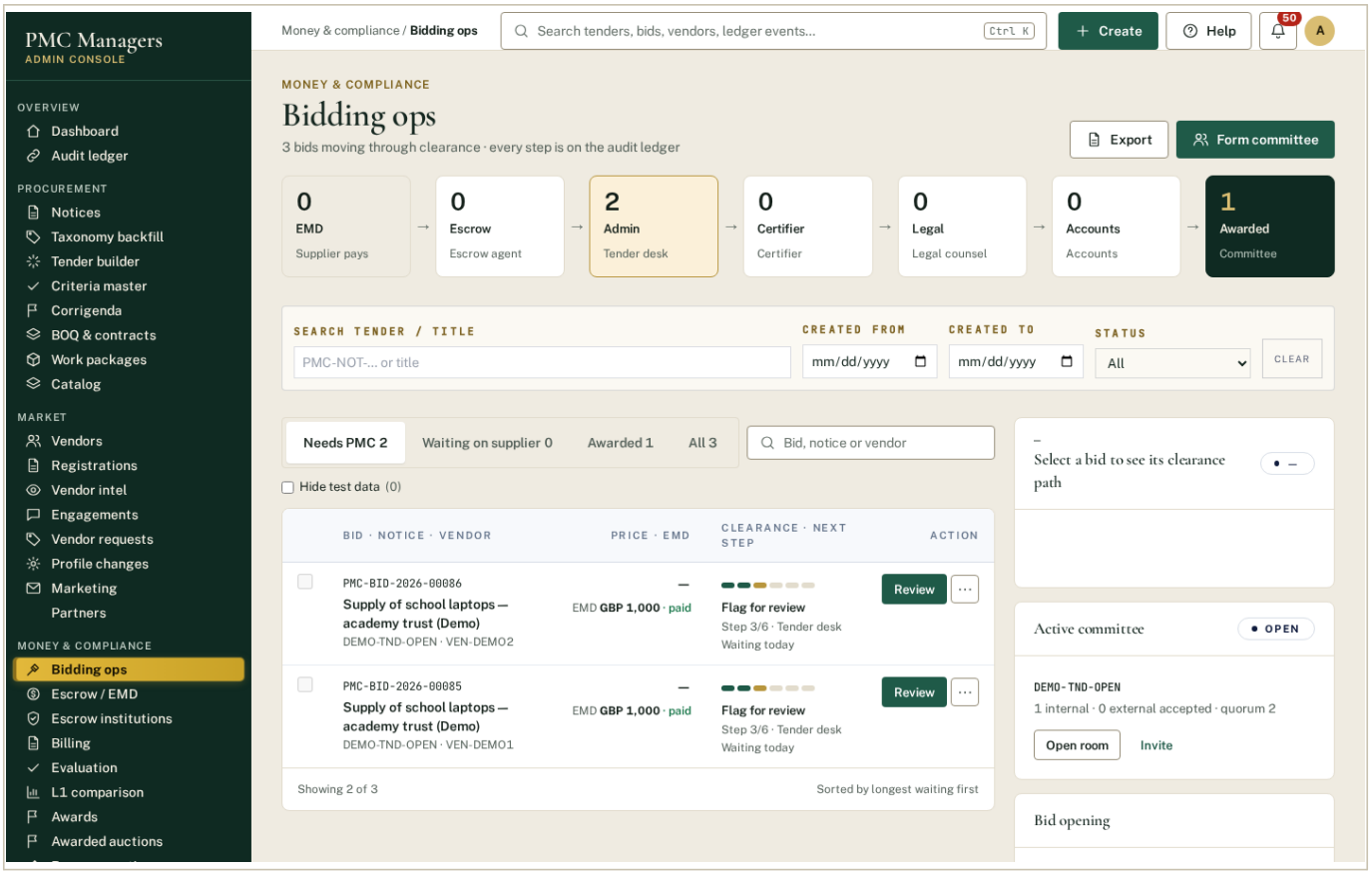
Partners who onboard suppliers and earn commission. Unfinished profiles show 'N of 4 sections complete'. Edit details opens the full 5-section form; resend the invite link; approve.

Main actions

- Invite a partner
- Edit details
- Resend link
- Approve

Bidding ops

Screen: `/admin/e/bidding`



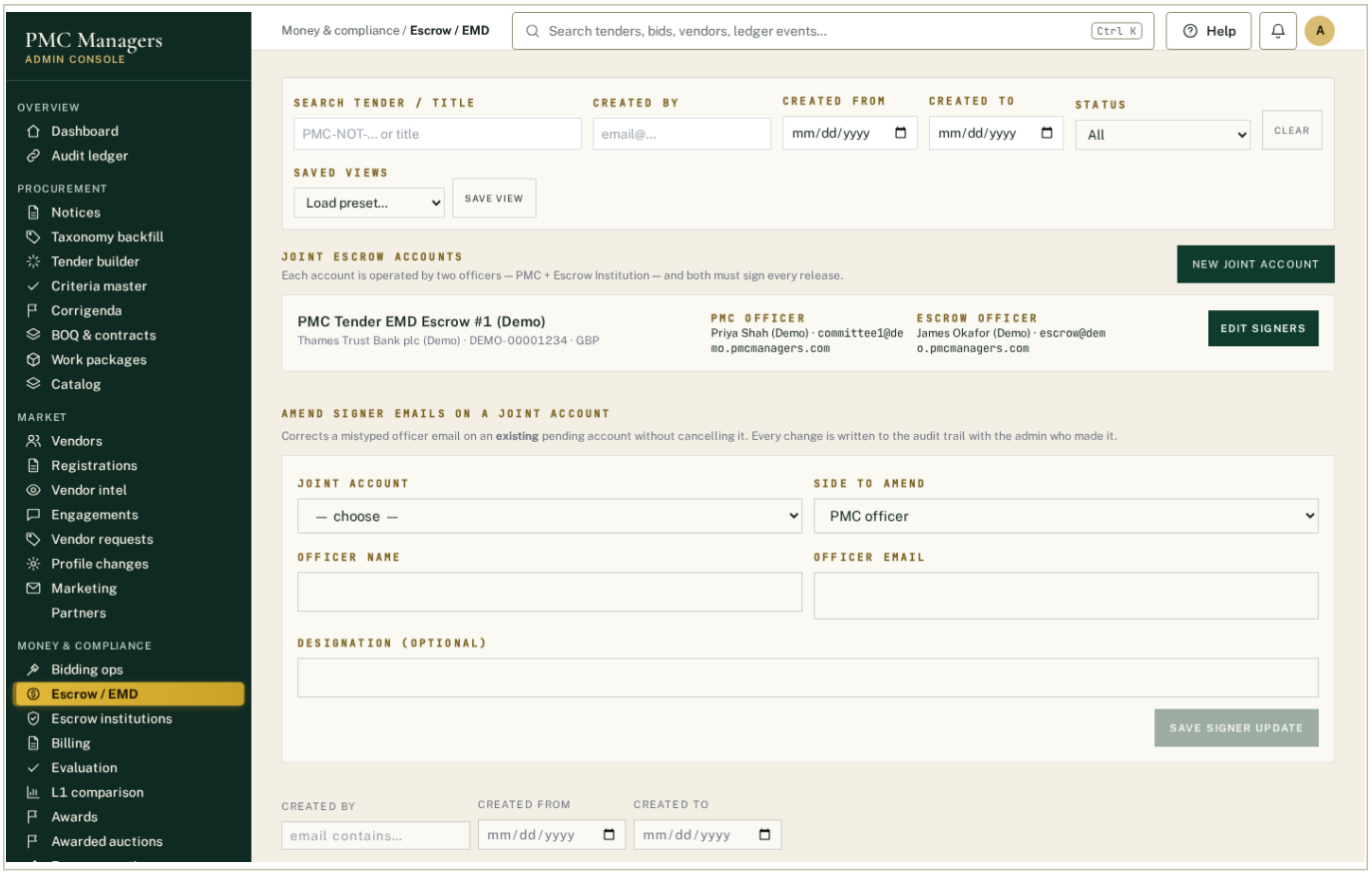
Runs the bid opening. Each tender with a committee shows the opening card: who has signed, blockers, technical opening, the system qualification check with AI proof findings and committee accept/reject, price opening, the automatic L1 ranking and 'Award to L1'.

Main actions

- Committee members approve opening
- Review proofs (accept / reject with comment)
- Raise / resolve a doubt
- Download proof check report
- Award to L1

Escrow / EMD

Screen: `/admin/e/escrow`



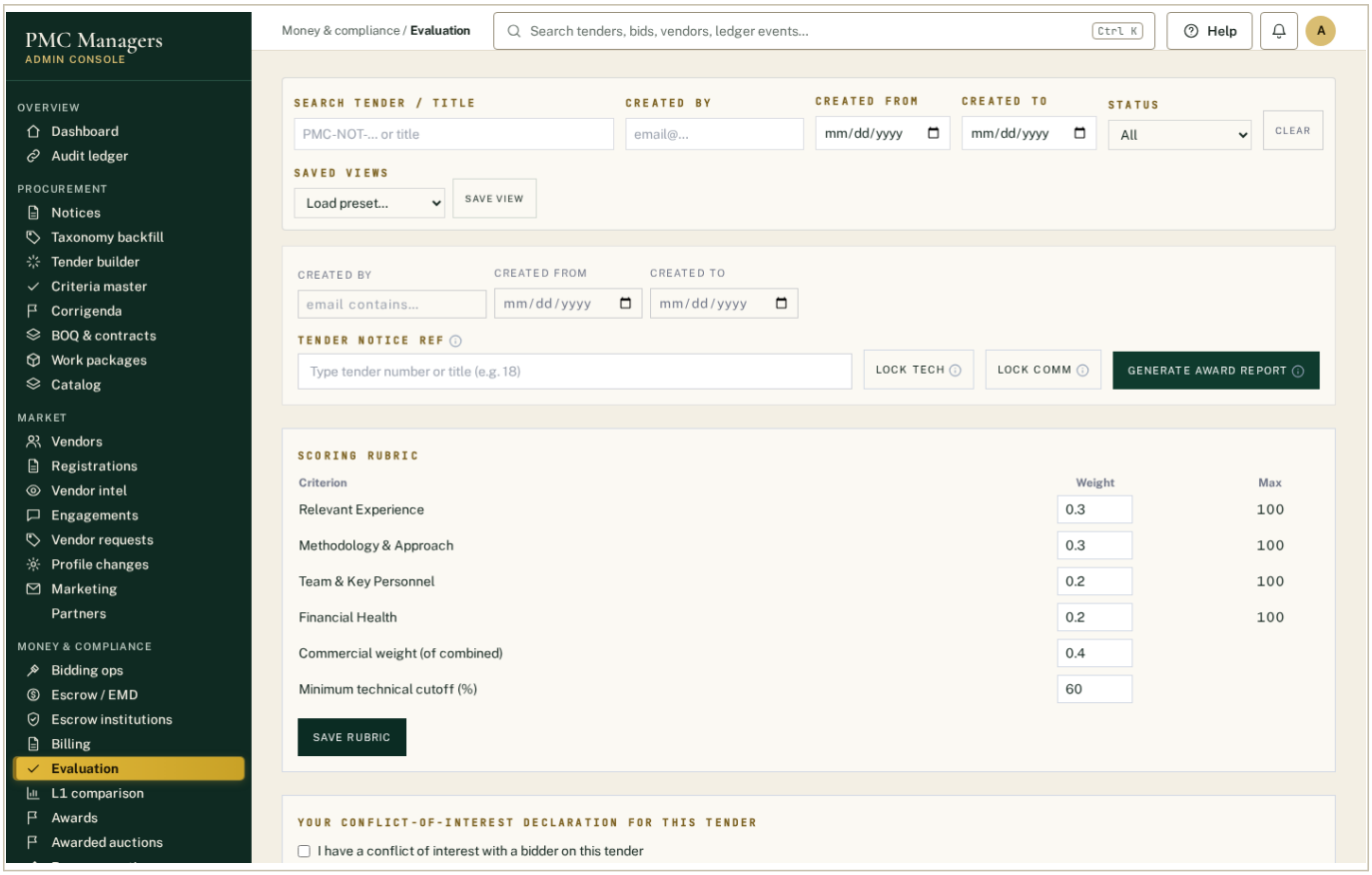
Bid deposits (EMD) and award payments held in escrow, with dual-signed releases and consortium payment instructions.

Main actions

- Confirm EMD received
- Release with two signatures
- Record consortium member payouts and bank references

Evaluation

Screen: `/admin/e/evaluation`



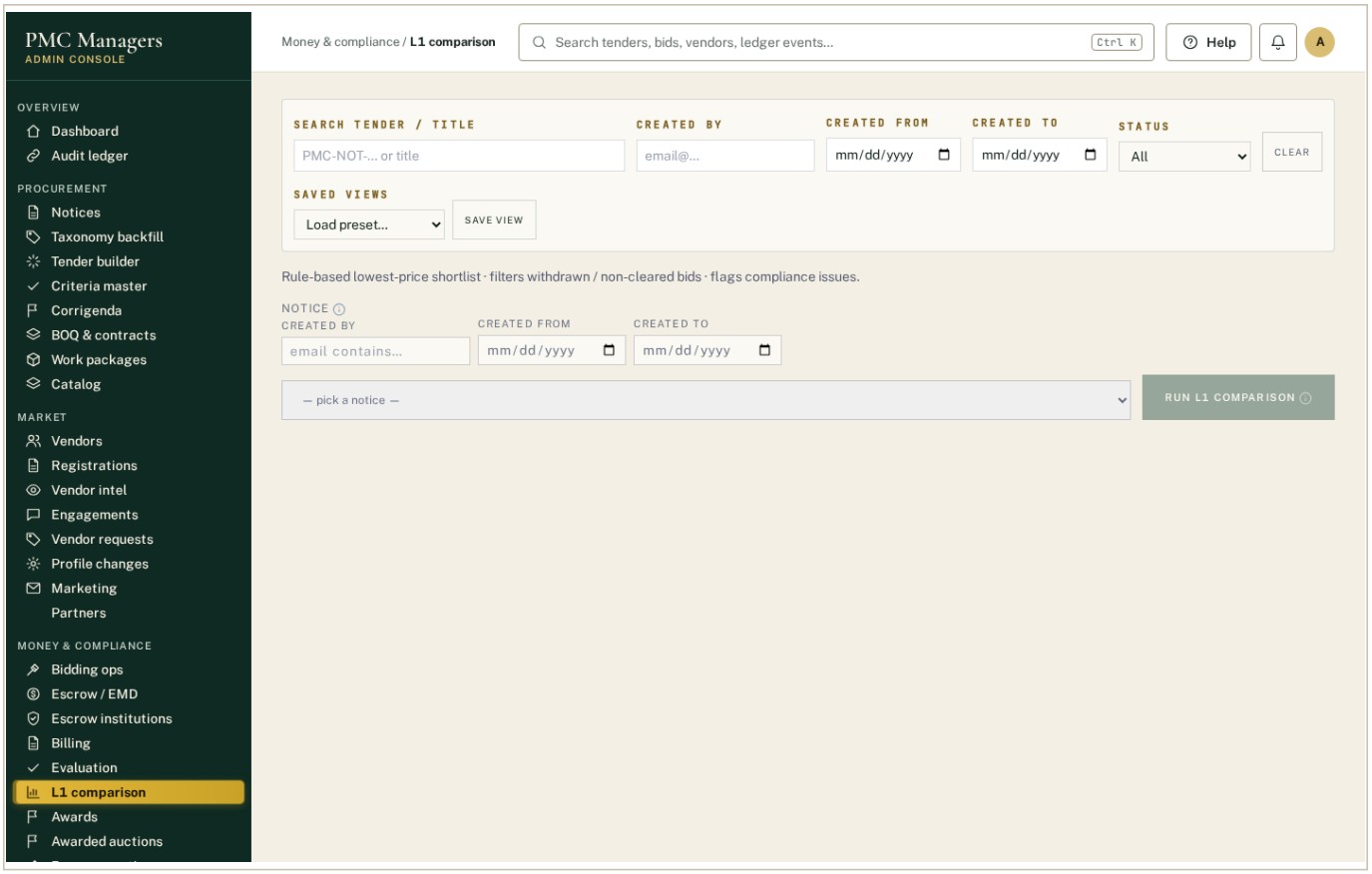
Committee scoring rubric and the Award recommendation report, which follows the tender's rule (L1 or weighted).

Main actions

- Score bids
- Open the award recommendation report

L1 comparison

Screen: `/admin/e/l1-award`



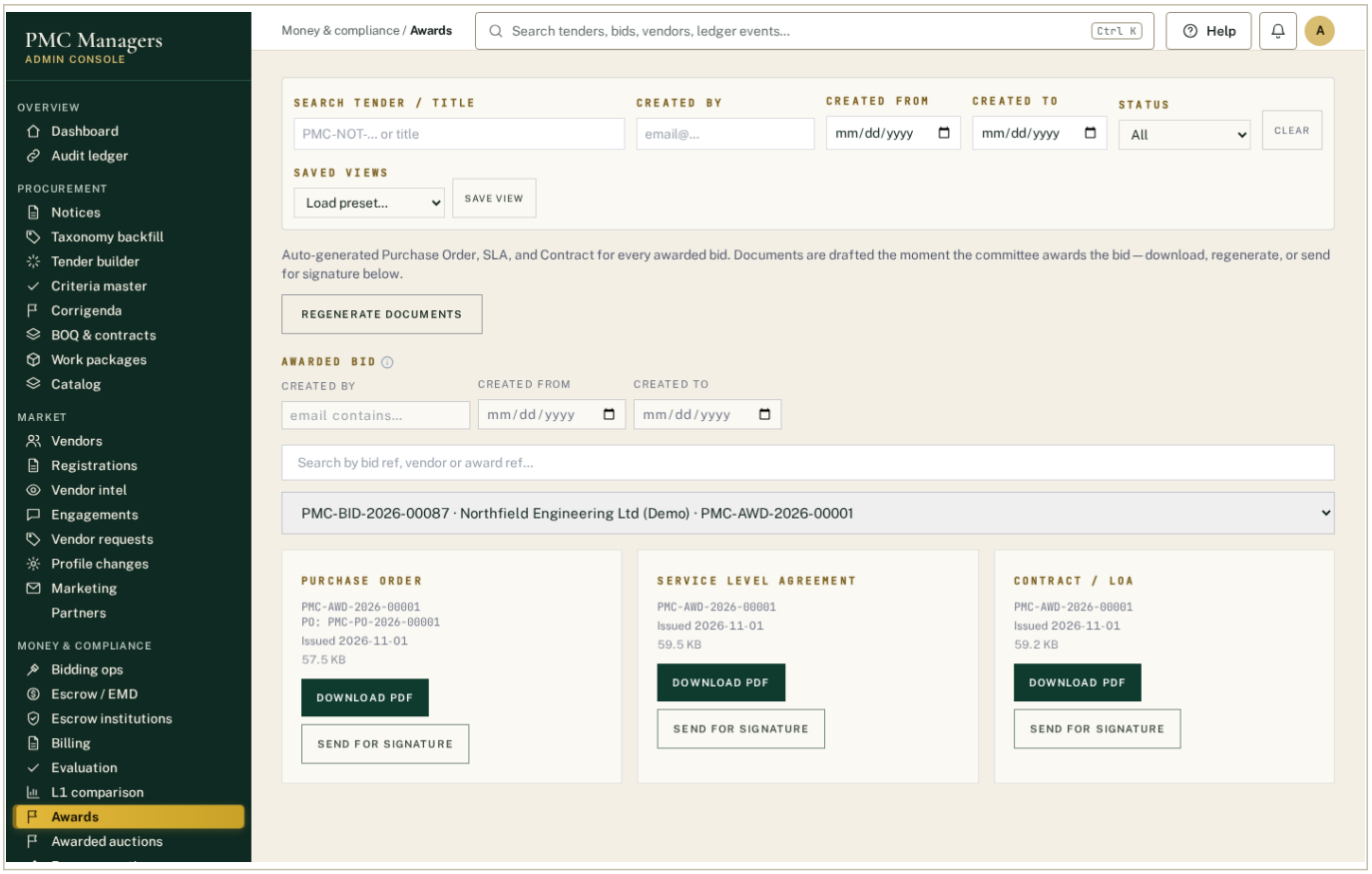
Ranks qualified bids by price (L1, L2, L3) with compliance flags. Runs automatically after price opening and can be re-run here.

Main actions

- Run L1 for a tender
- Check compliance flags

Awards

Screen: `/admin/e/awards`



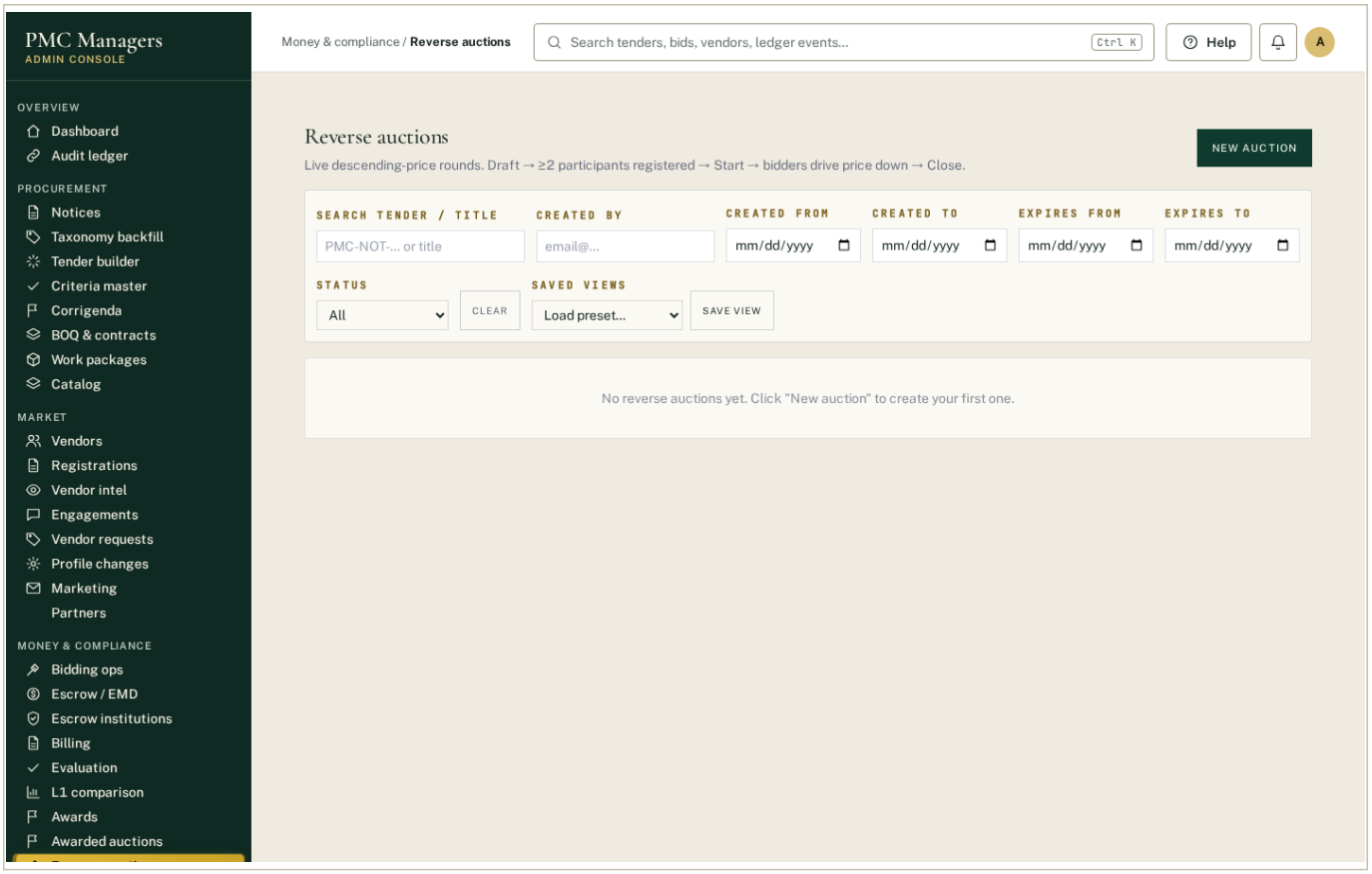
Awarded bids with award letters, contracts and signatures.

Main actions

- Open award letter / contract
- Track signatures

Reverse auctions

Screen: `/admin/e/auctions`



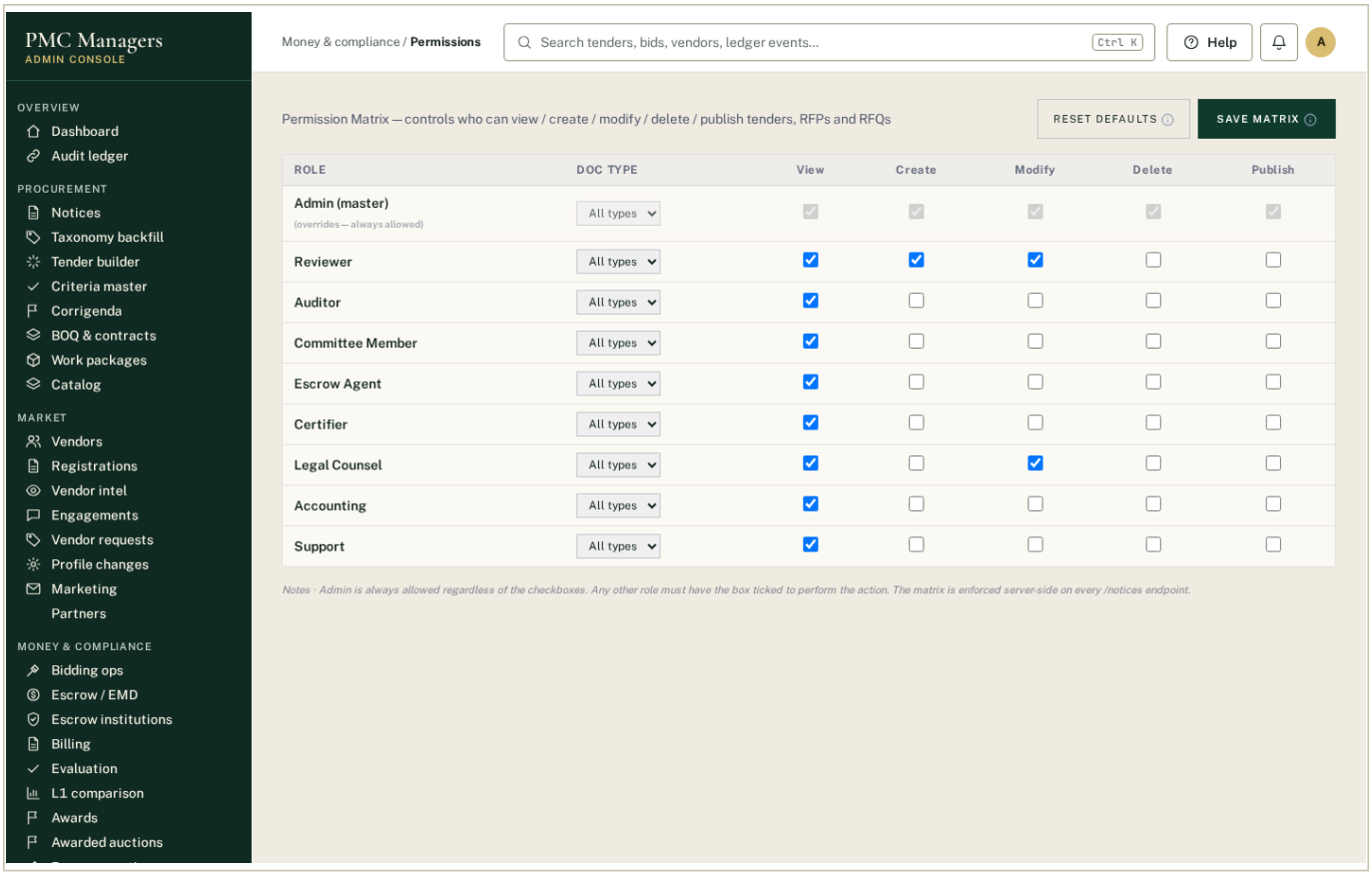
Live reverse auctions where invited suppliers bid prices down within a time window.

Main actions

- Create an auction
- Invite suppliers
- Watch live bids

Permissions

Screen: `/admin/e/permissions`



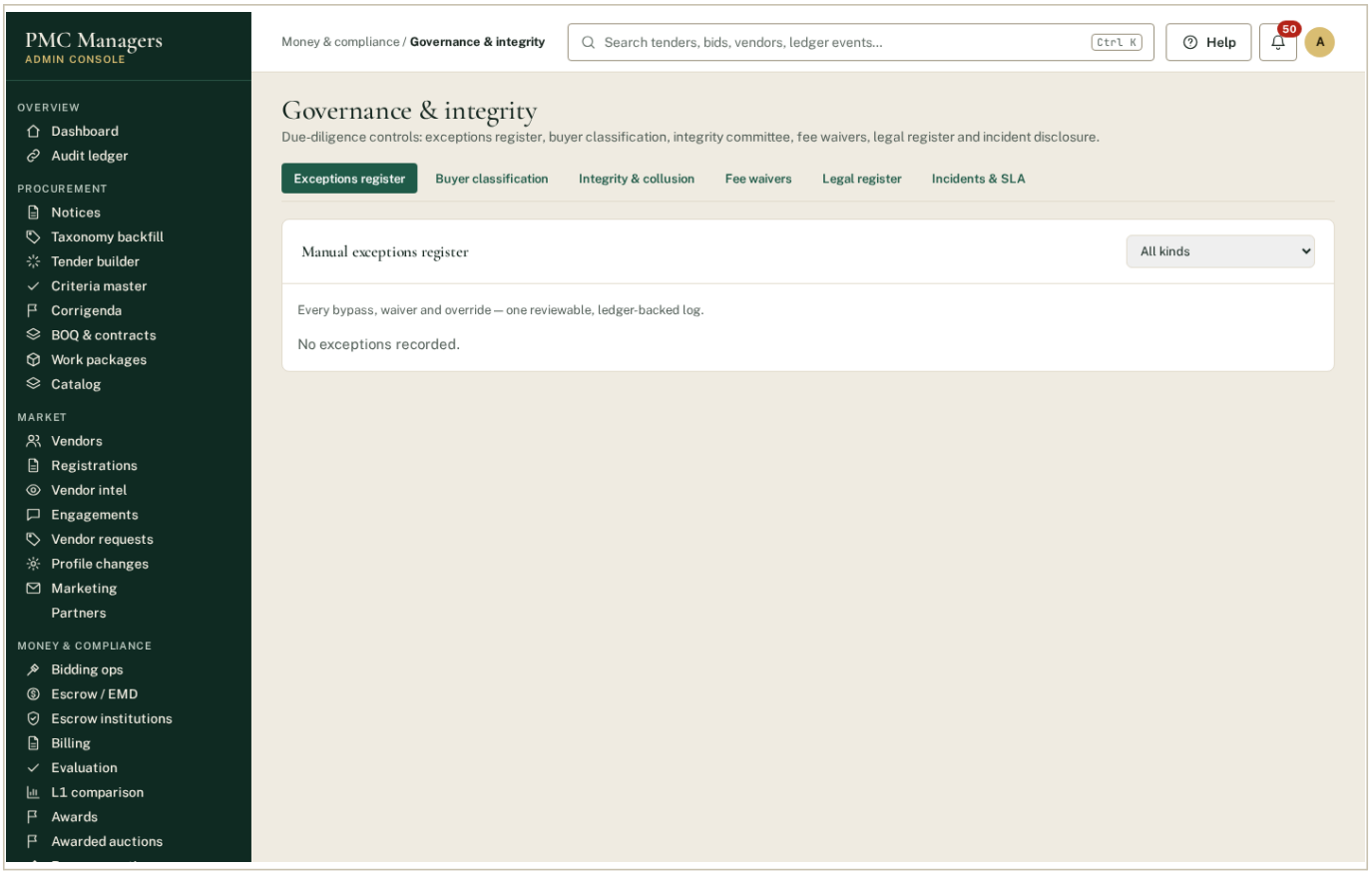
Who can do what. Roles and the approval matrix that decides each bid's sign-off order.

Main actions

- Edit role permissions
- Reset to defaults

Governance & integrity

Screen: `/admin/e/governance`



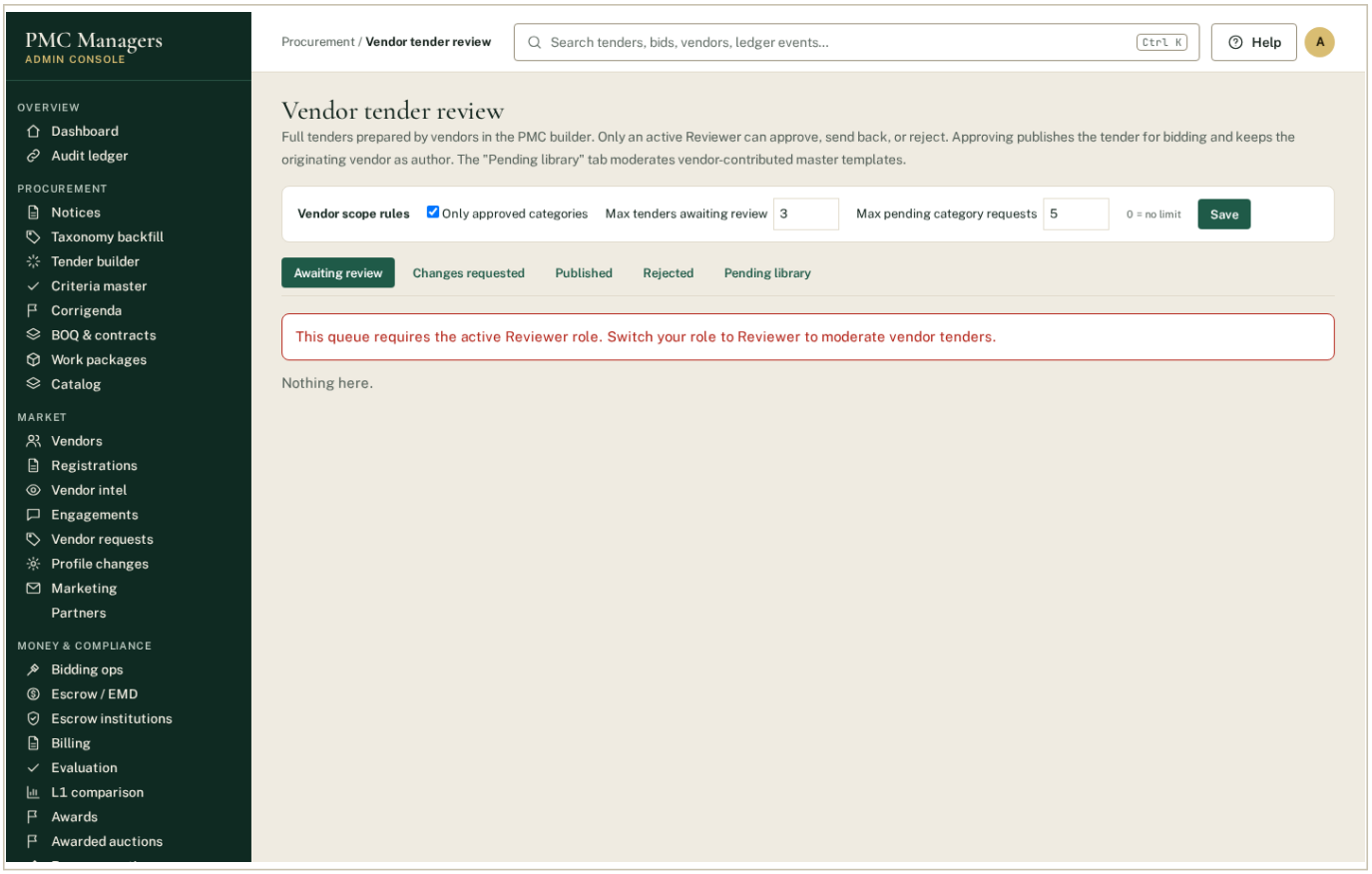
Committees, conflict-of-interest declarations and integrity checks.

Main actions

- Form a committee
- Review declarations

Tender review

Screen: `/admin/e/tender-review`



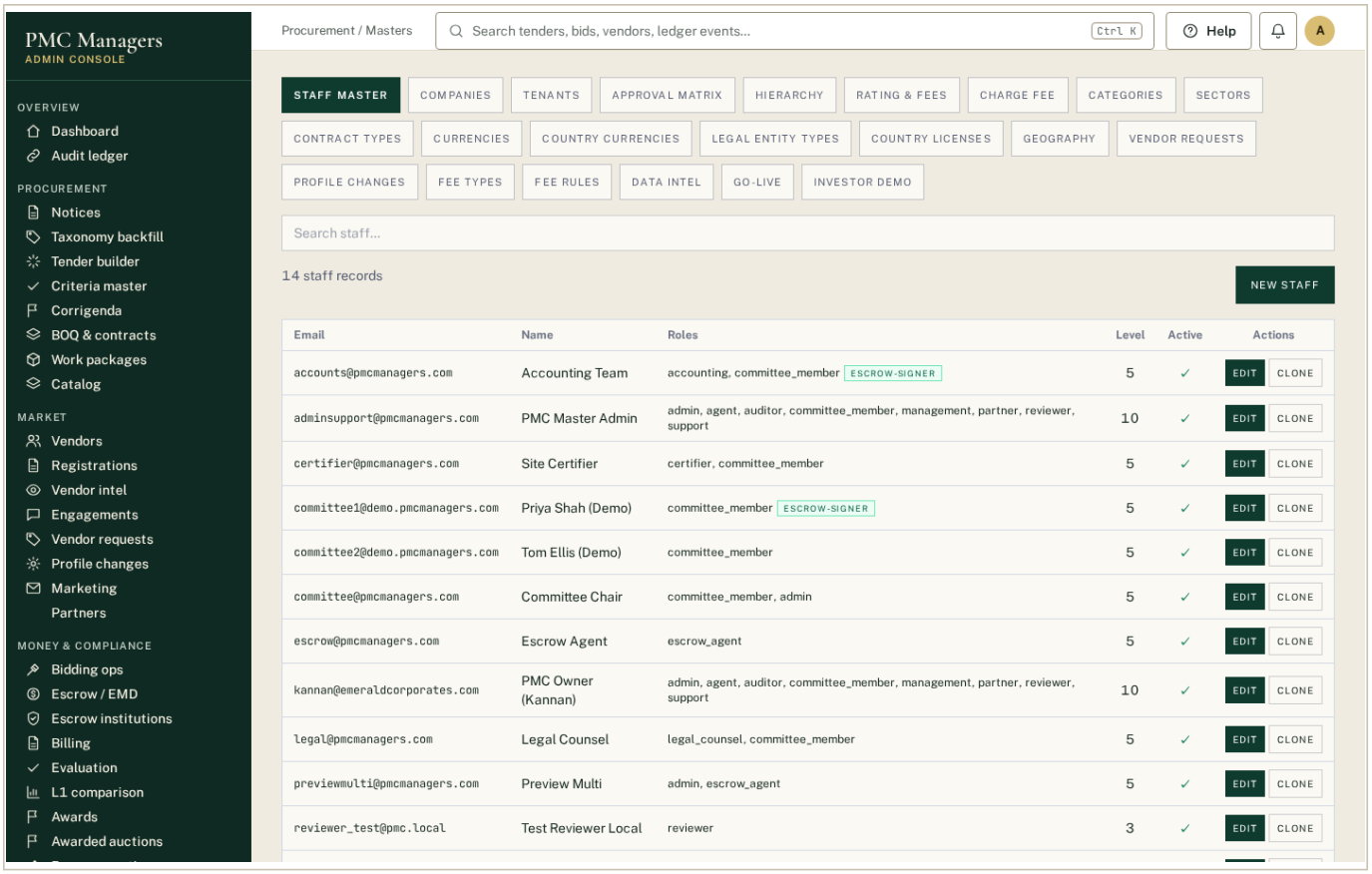
Reviewers approve tenders prepared by suppliers before they can be published.

Main actions

• Approve or send back a supplier-prepared tender

Masters

Screen: `/admin/e/masters`



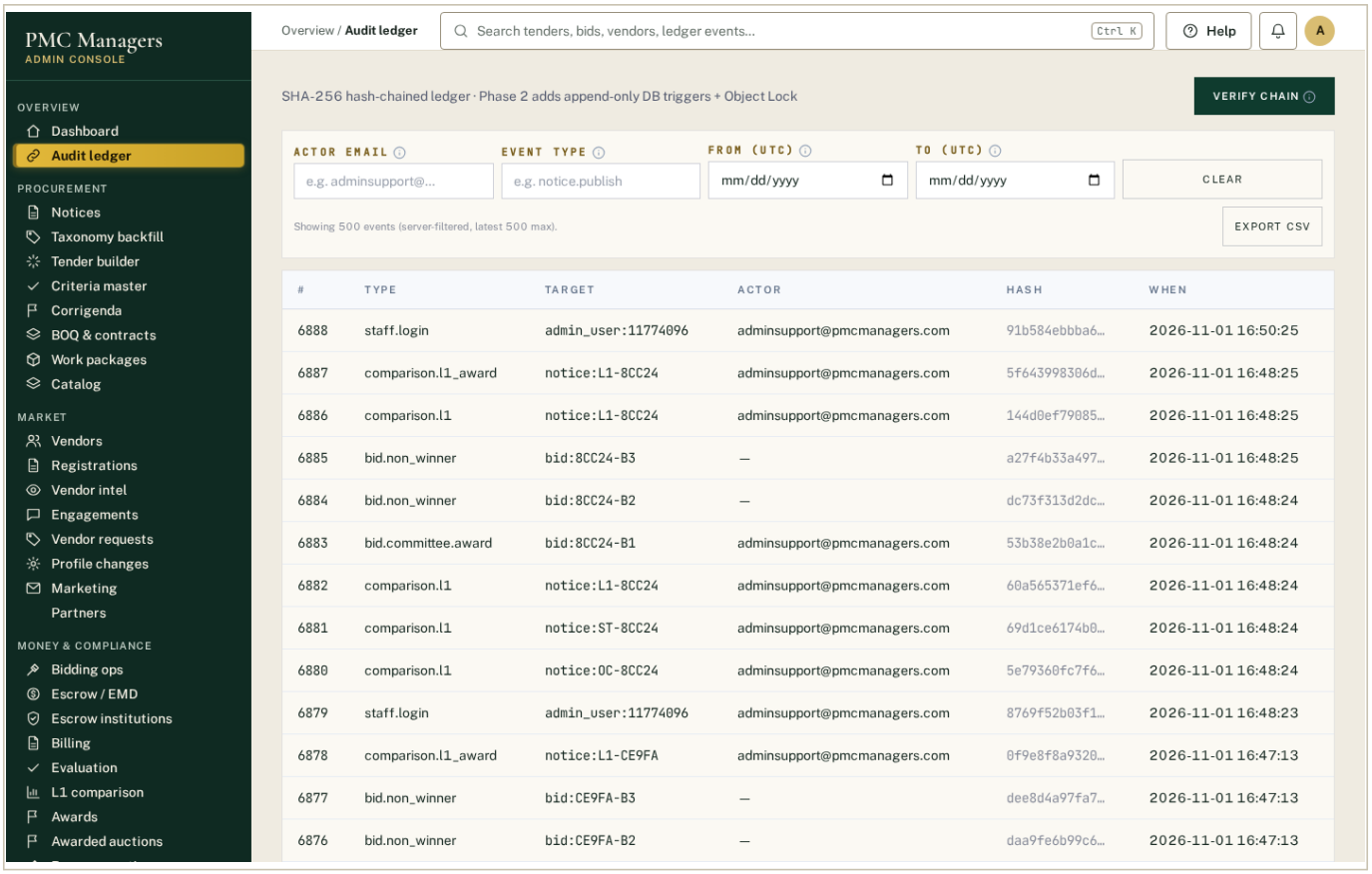
Reference data: staff accounts, categories, countries, currencies and other lists used across the platform.

Main actions

- Add staff
- Edit categories

Audit ledger

Screen: `/admin/e/audit`



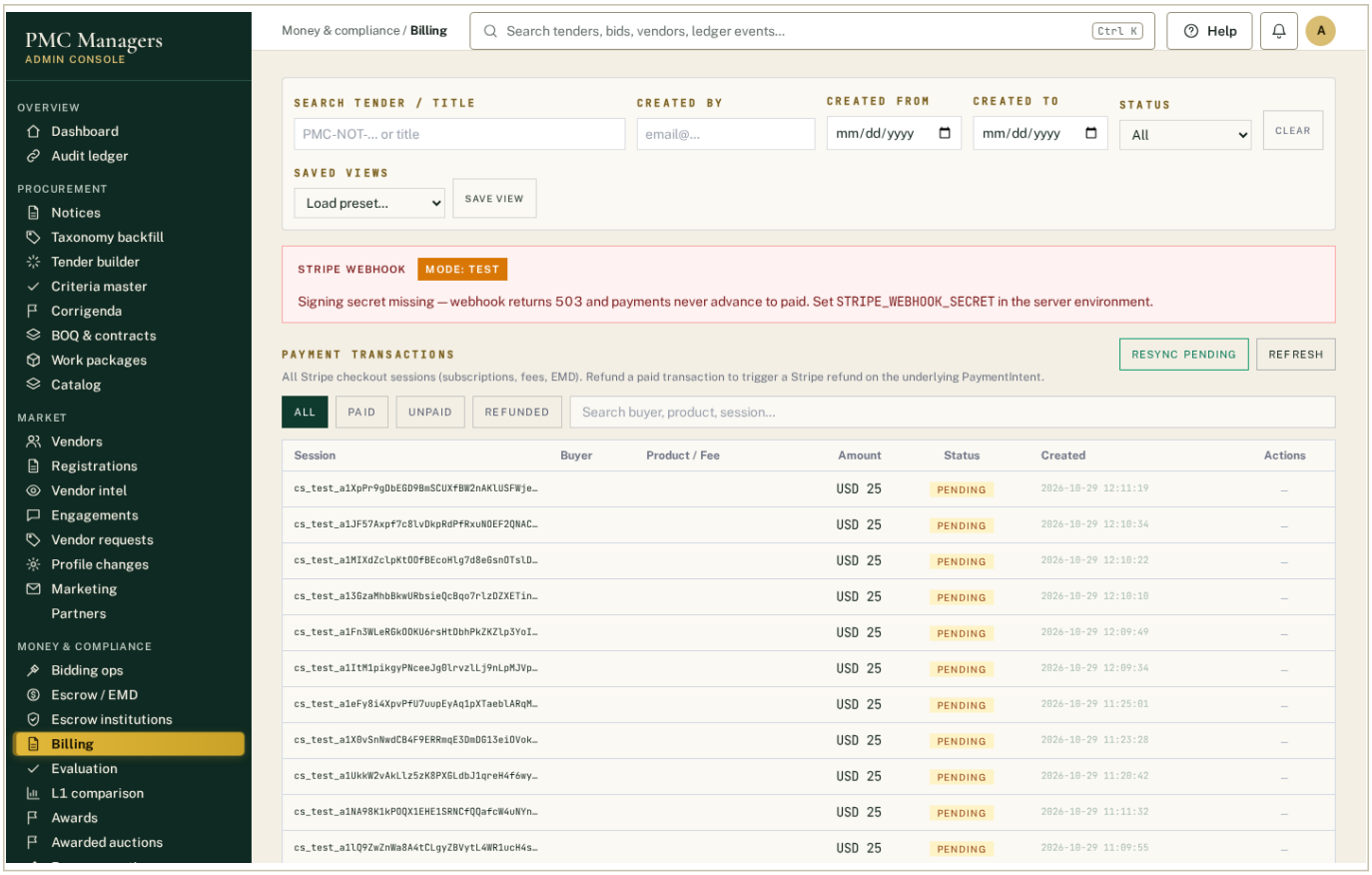
Every action is recorded in a tamper-evident chain. Verify chain re-checks every link.

Main actions

- Search events
- Verify chain
- Export

Billing

Screen: `/admin/e/billing`



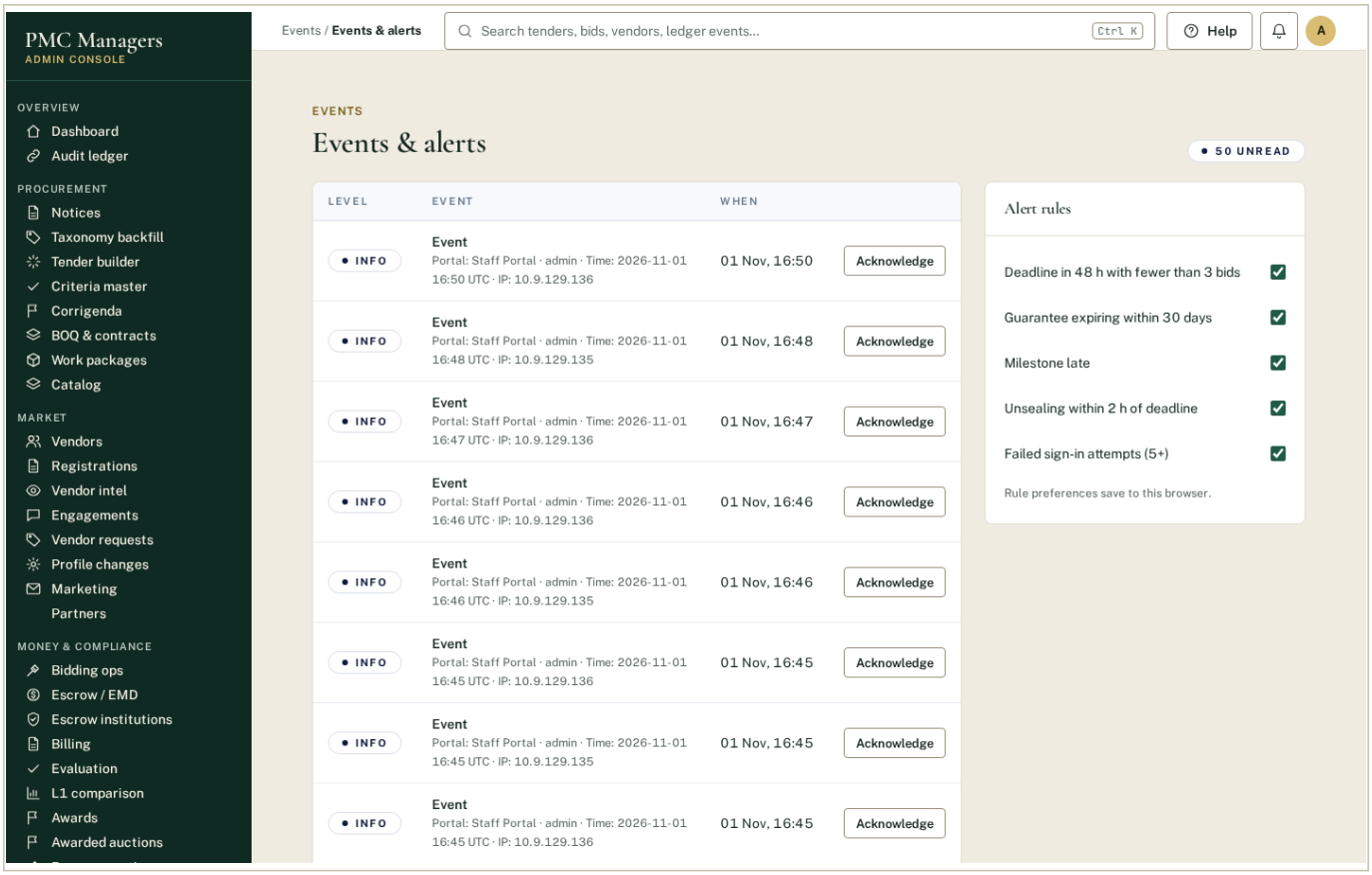
Hosting fees, subscriptions and invoices.

Main actions

- View invoices
- Check payment status

Events & alerts

Screen: `/admin/e/events`



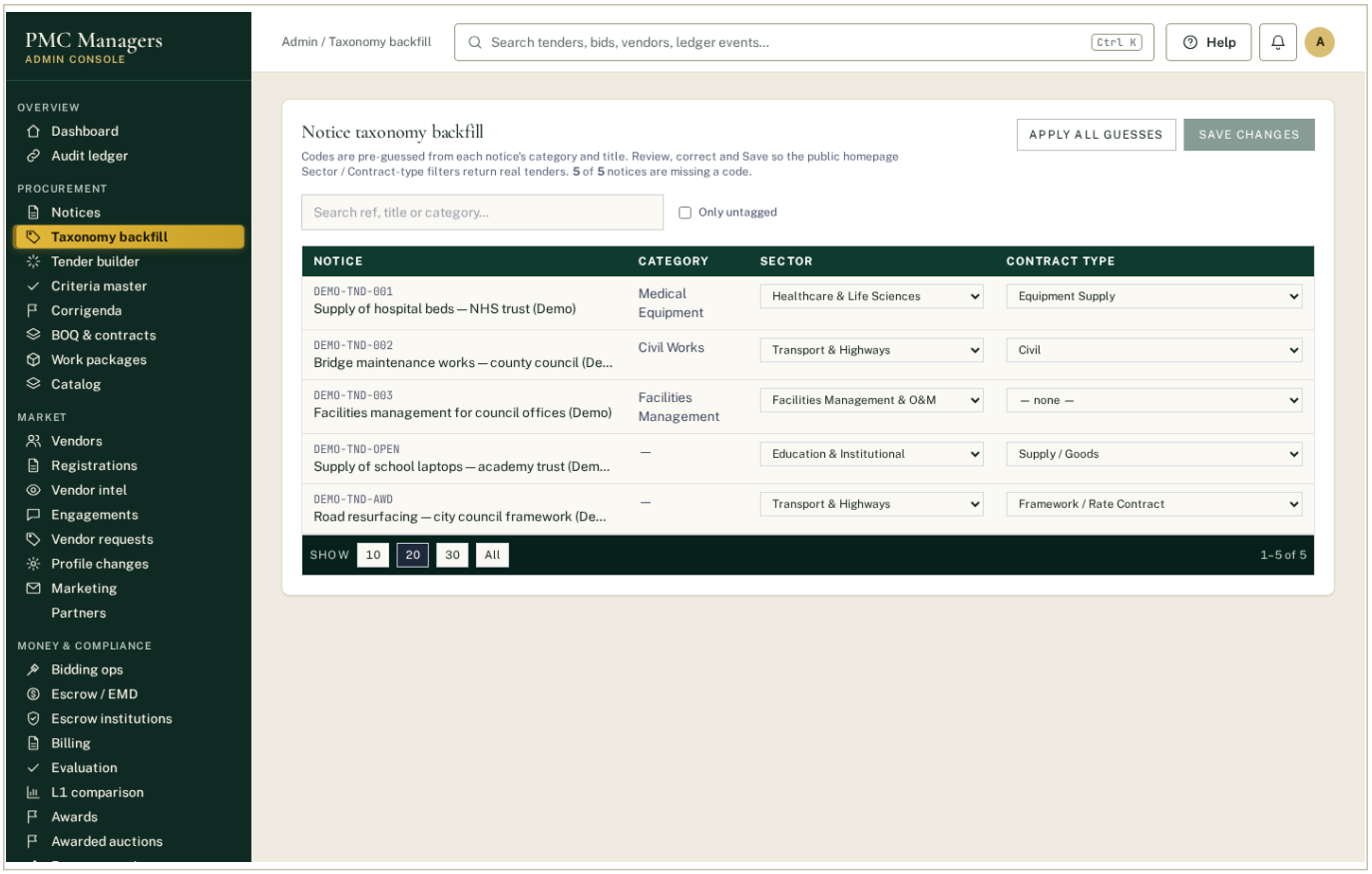
System events and alerts, including scheduled jobs and email delivery.

Main actions

- Review alerts

Taxonomy backfill

Screen: `/admin/e/taxonomy-backfill`



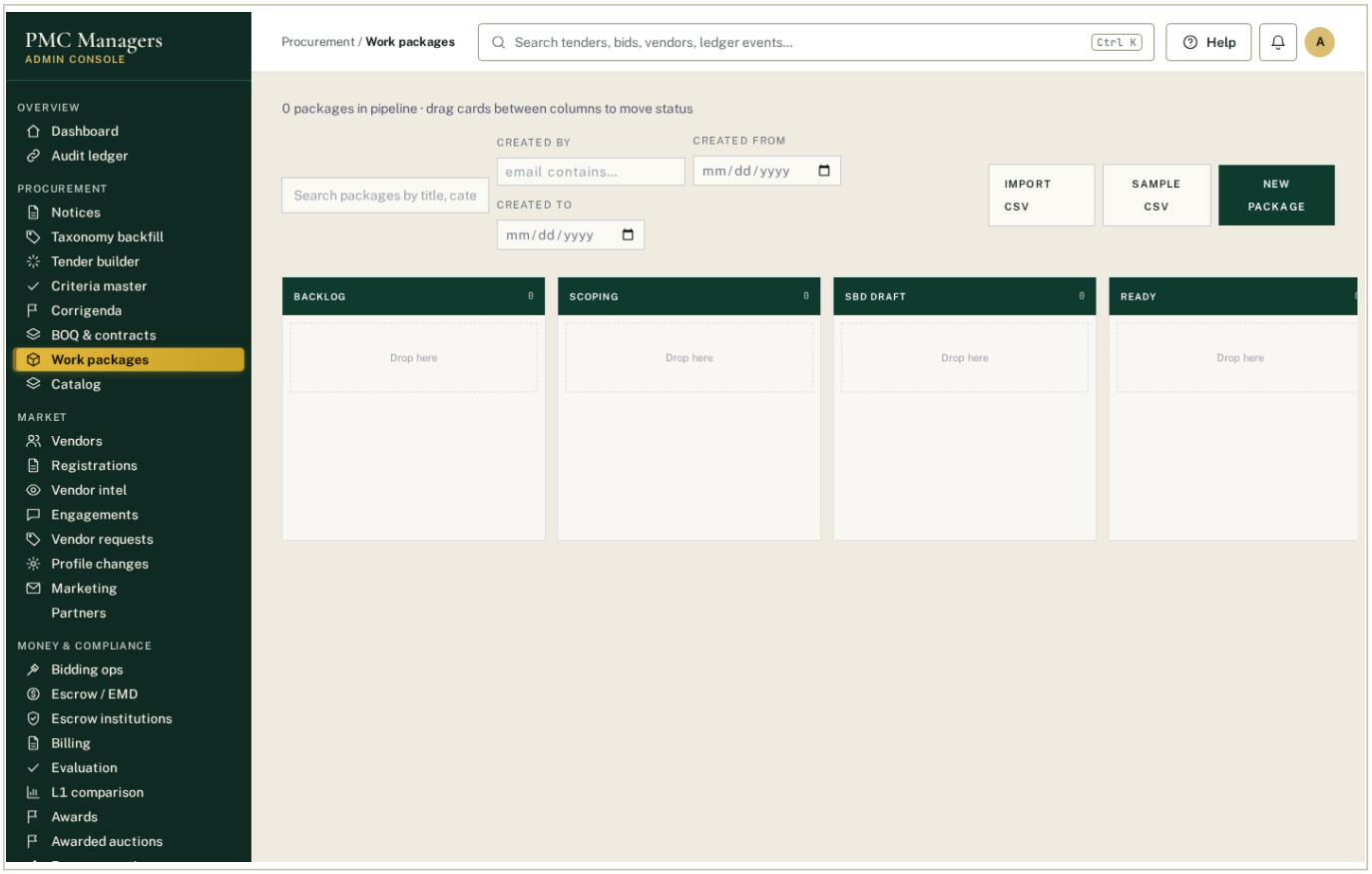
Assigns standard product/service categories (UNSPSC) to older tenders and suppliers so matching and search work everywhere.

Main actions

- Run a backfill
- Review suggested categories

Work packages

Screen: `/admin/e/work-packages`



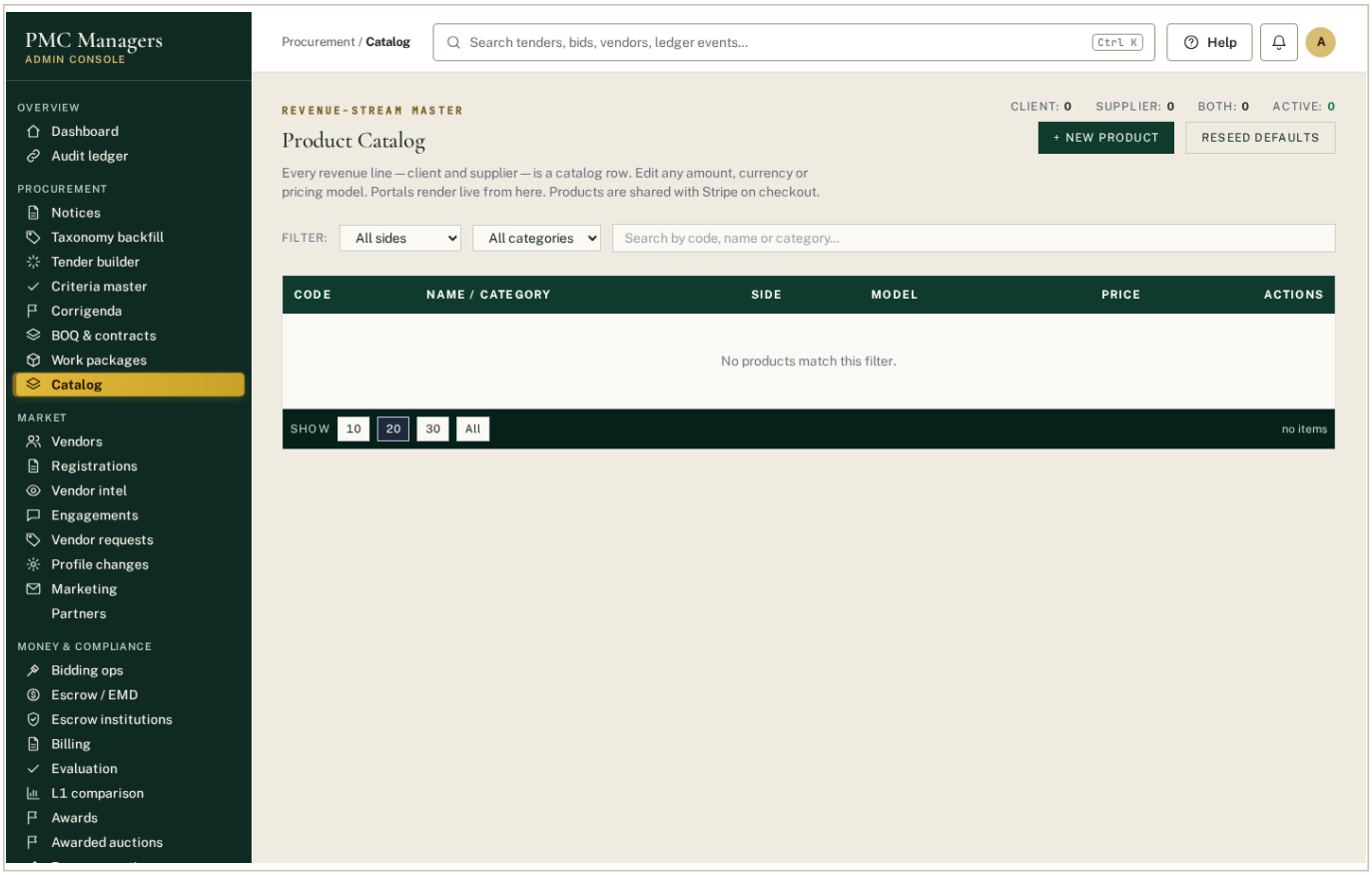
Splits large programmes into packages that can each be tendered separately.

Main actions

- Create a package
- Link it to a tender

Catalog

Screen: `/admin/e/catalog`



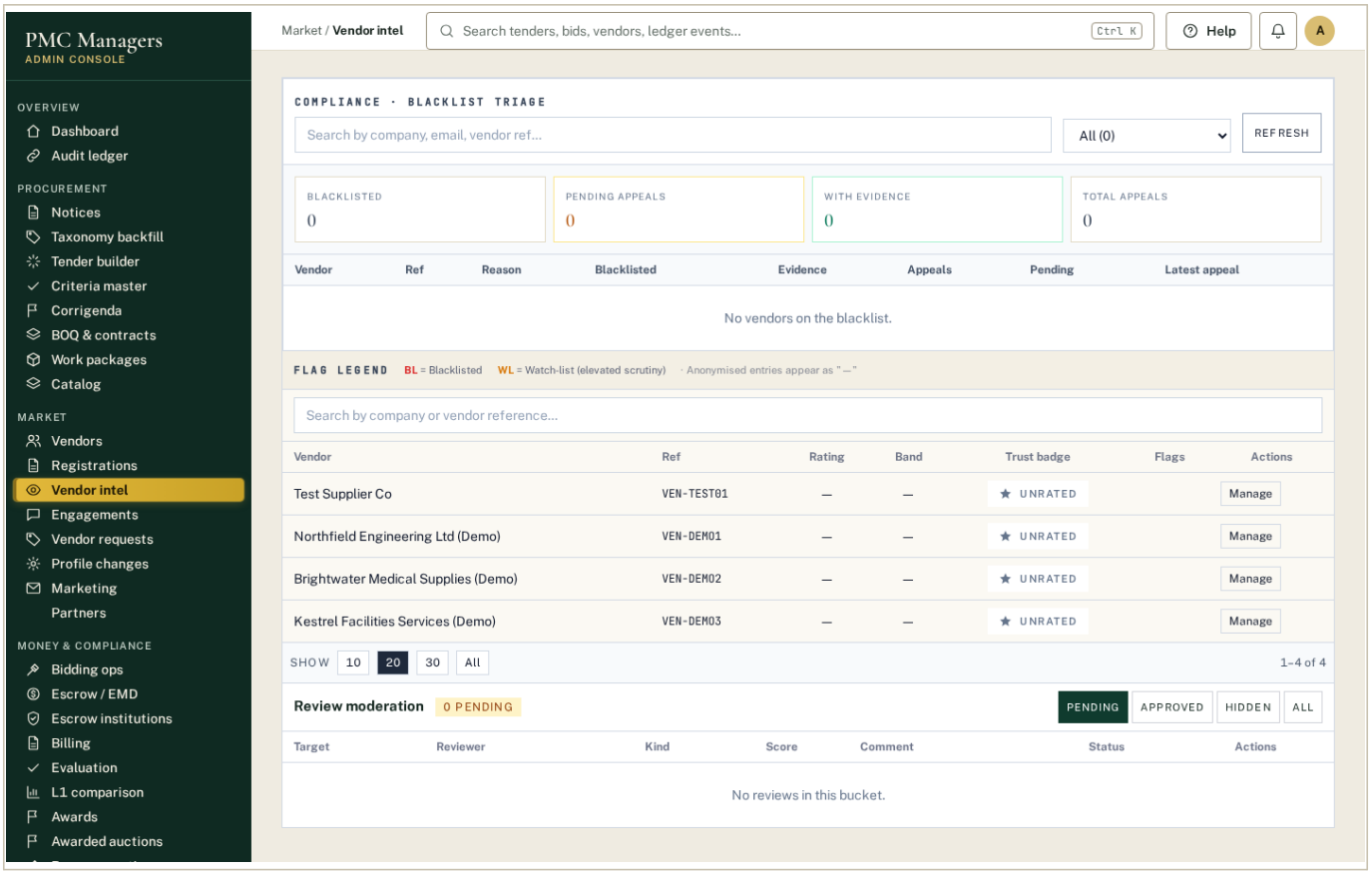
Product and service catalogue used for quick quotes and BOQ lines.

Main actions

- Add catalogue items
- Edit prices

Vendor intel

Screen: `/admin/e/vendor-intel`



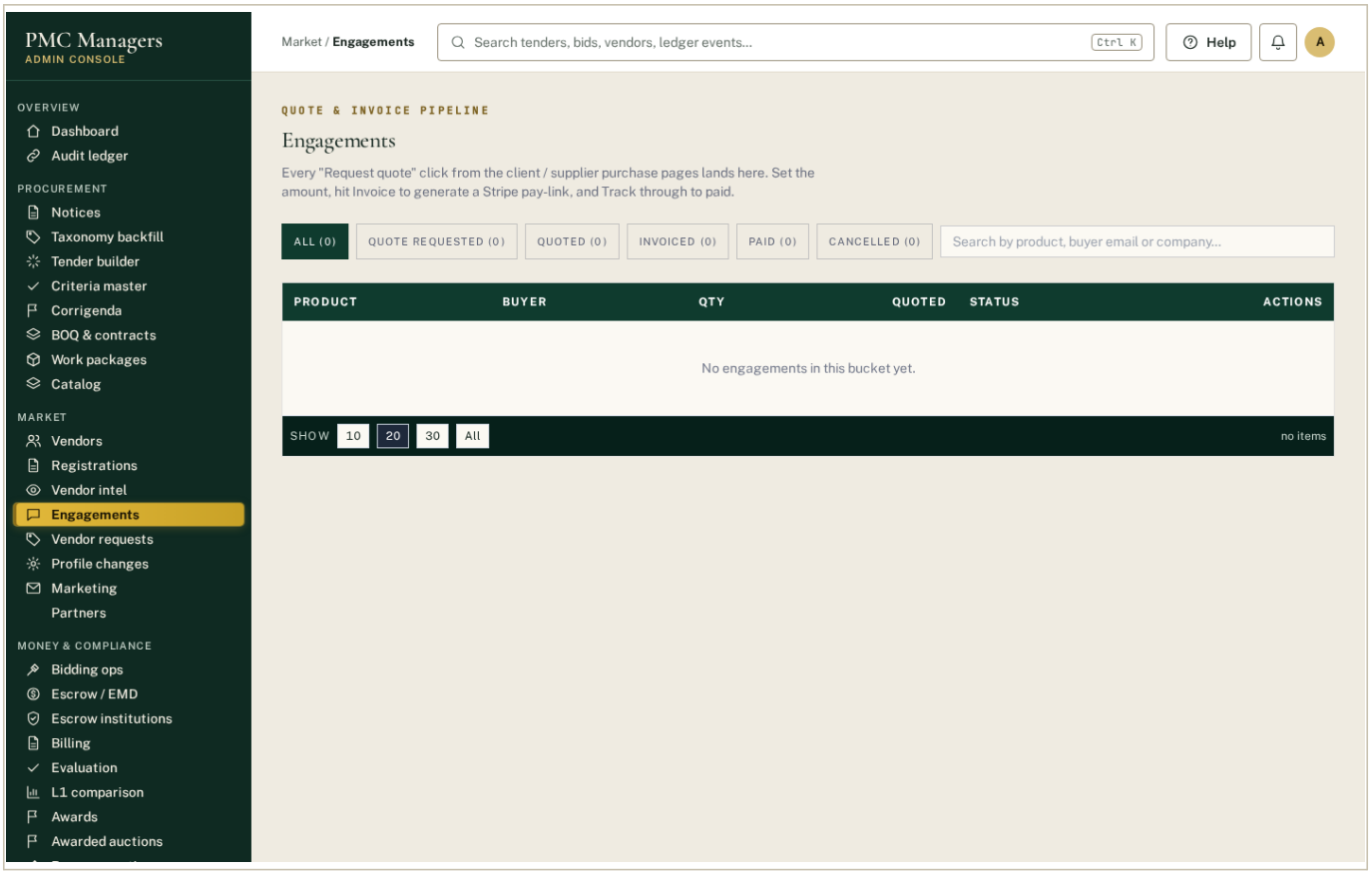
Supplier risk and performance signals: reviews, appeals, debarment checks and history.

Main actions

- Review a supplier's signals
- Handle an appeal

Engagements

Screen: `/admin/e/engagements`



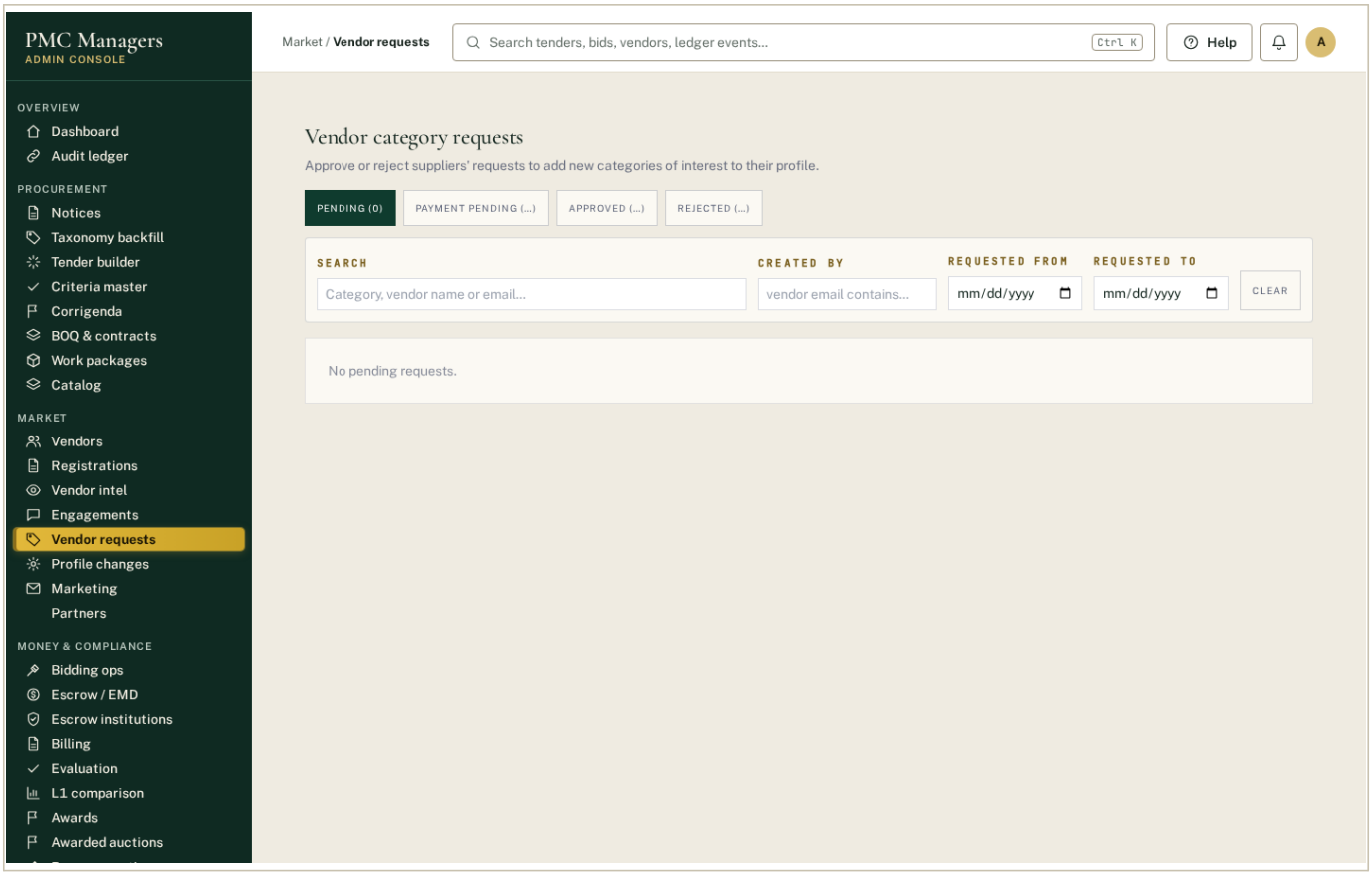
Service engagements and quote requests between buyers and suppliers.

Main actions

- Track an engagement

Vendor requests

Screen: `/admin/e/vendor-requests`



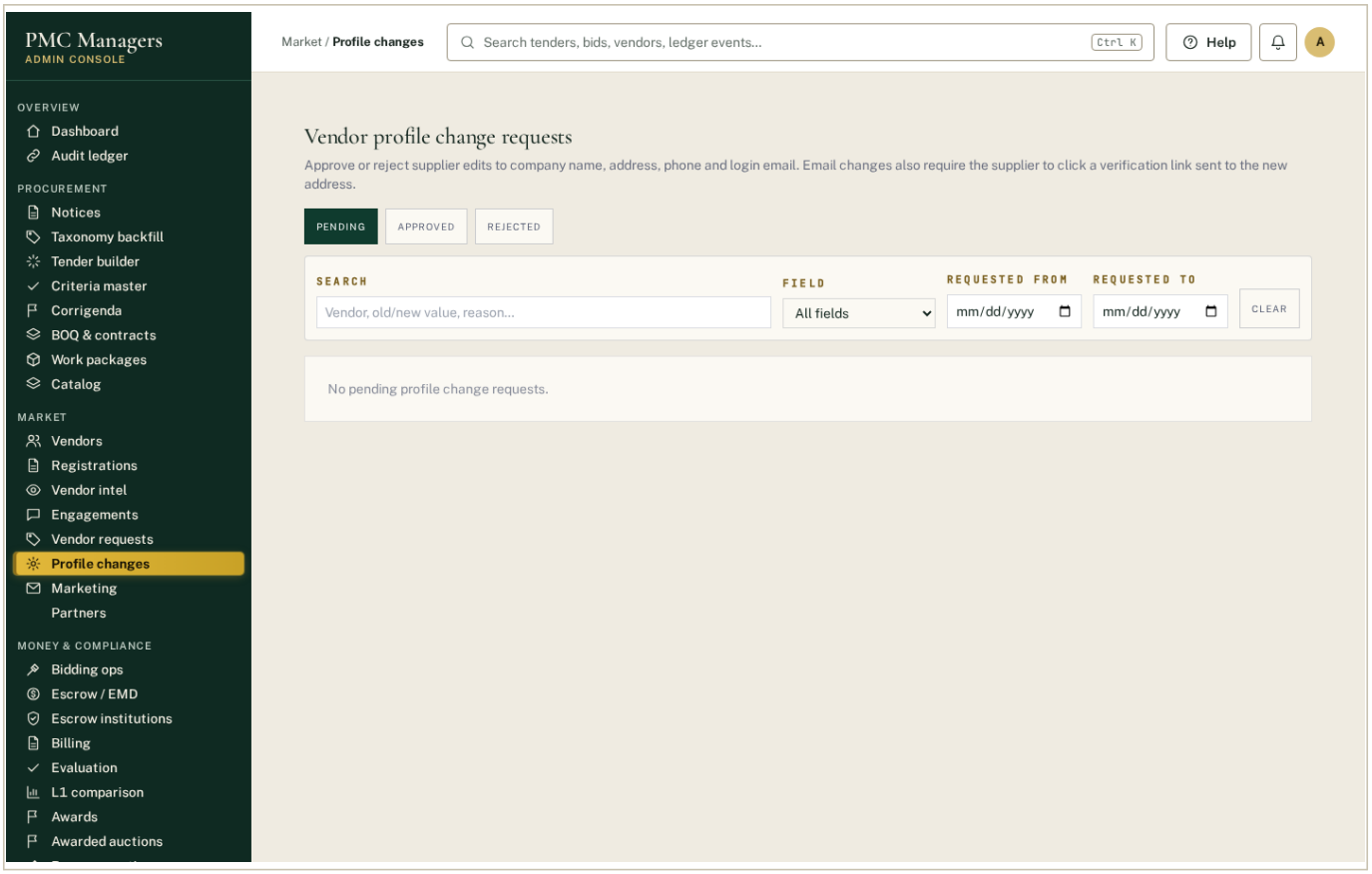
Requests raised by suppliers (category additions, help, corrections) waiting for PMC action.

Main actions

- Respond to a request

Profile changes

Screen: `/admin/e/profile-changes`



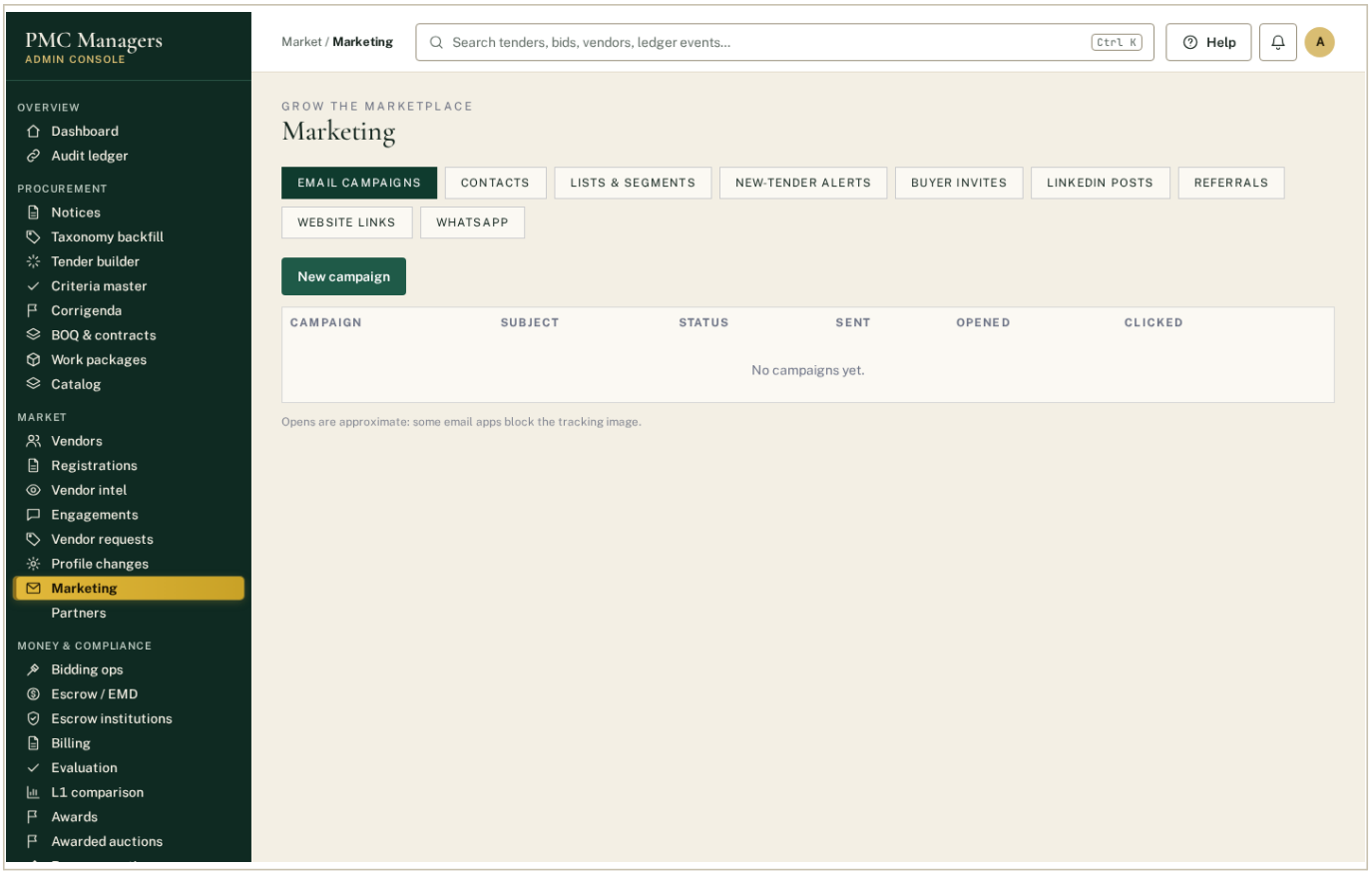
Supplier profile changes (bank, address, directors) that need approval before they take effect.

Main actions

• Approve or reject a change

Marketing

Screen: `/admin/e/marketing`



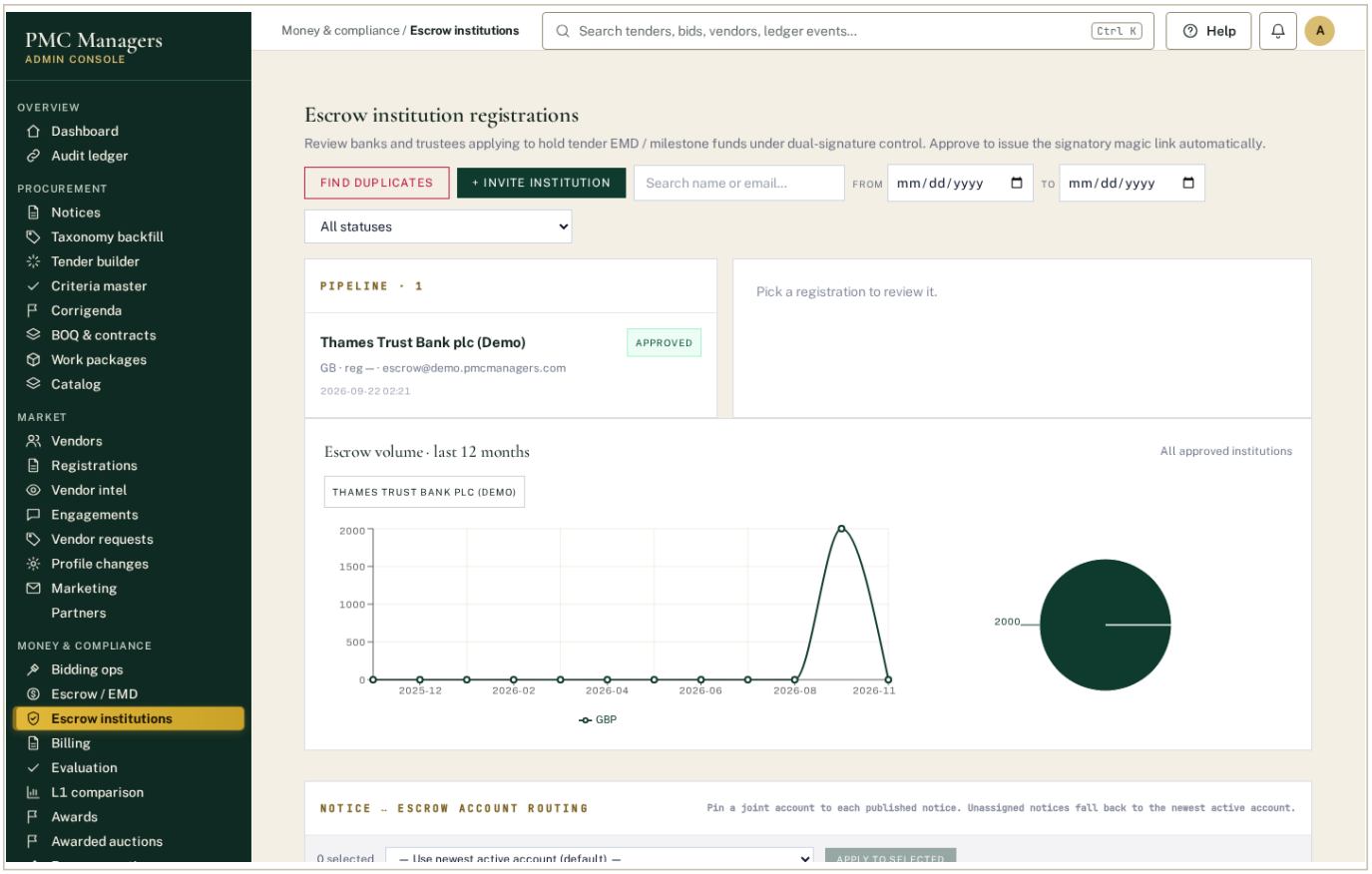
Campaigns, digests and WhatsApp/email outreach to suppliers.

Main actions

- Send a campaign
- View the WhatsApp inbox

Escrow institutions

Screen: `/admin/e/escrow-institutions`



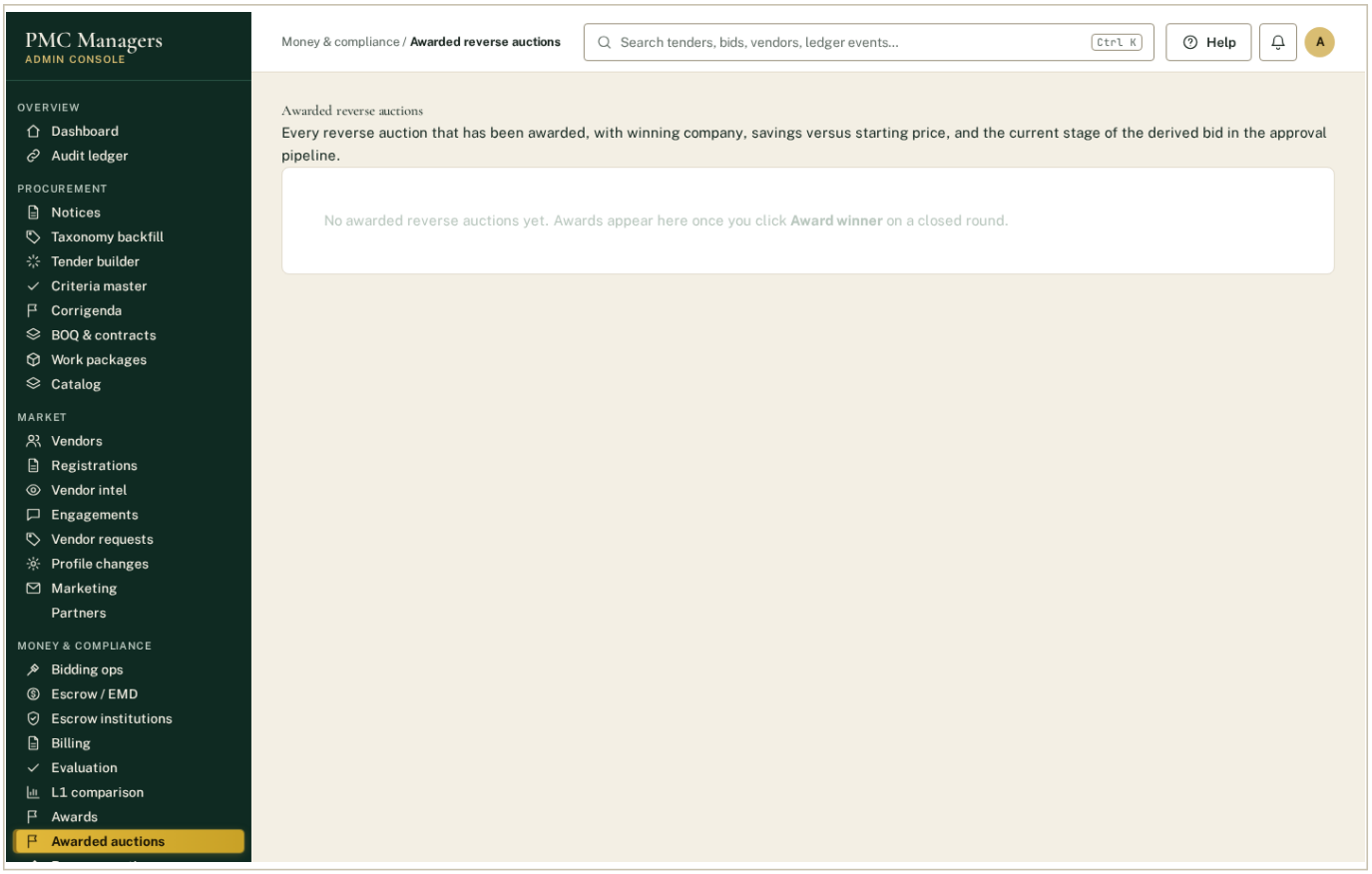
Banks and escrow providers onboarded to hold EMDs and award payments.

Main actions

- Approve an institution
- View accounts

Awarded auctions

Screen: `/admin/e/awarded-auctions`



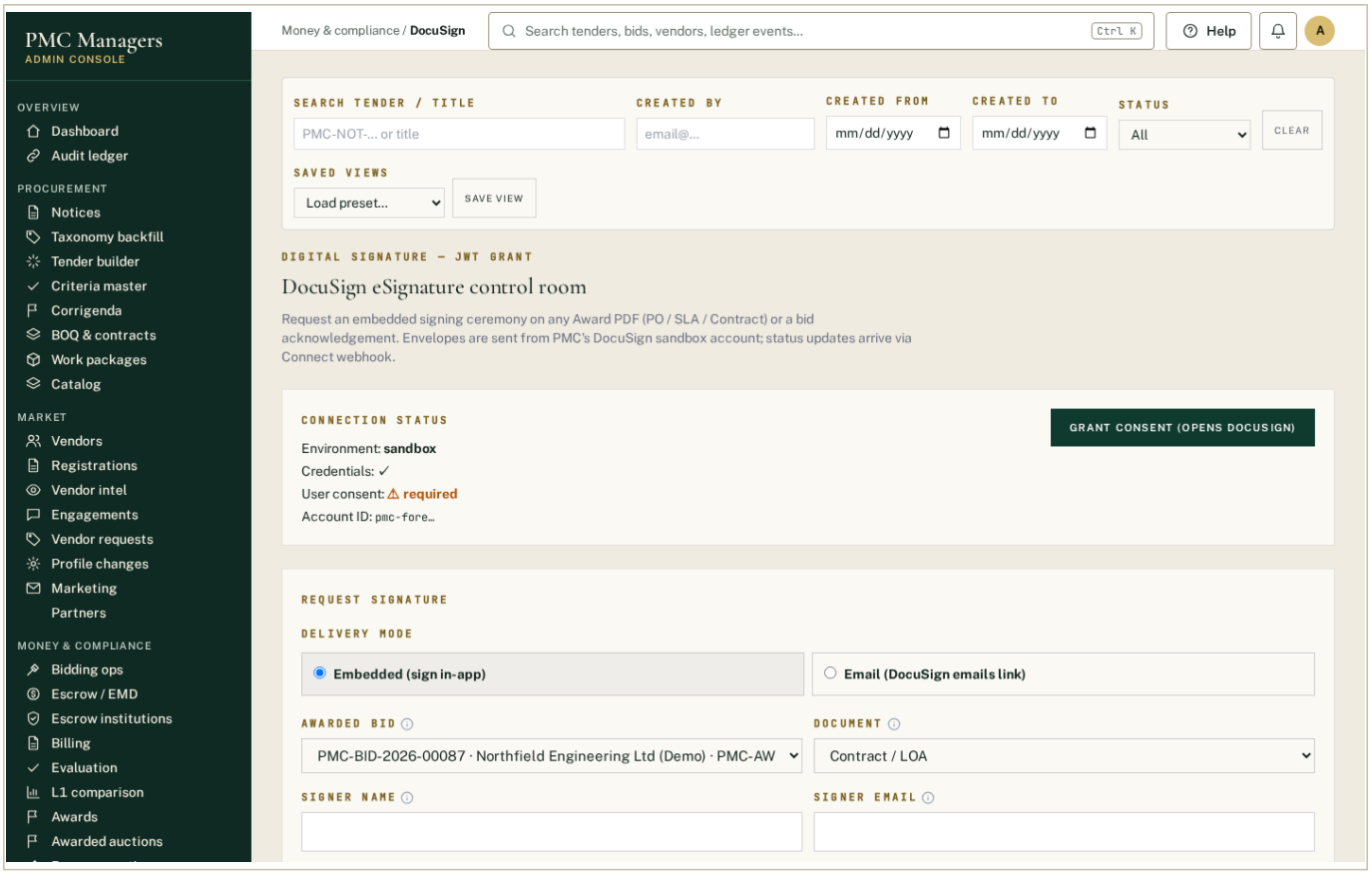
Results of completed reverse auctions and the resulting awards.

Main actions

- Open an awarded auction

DocuSign

Screen: `/admin/e/docusign`



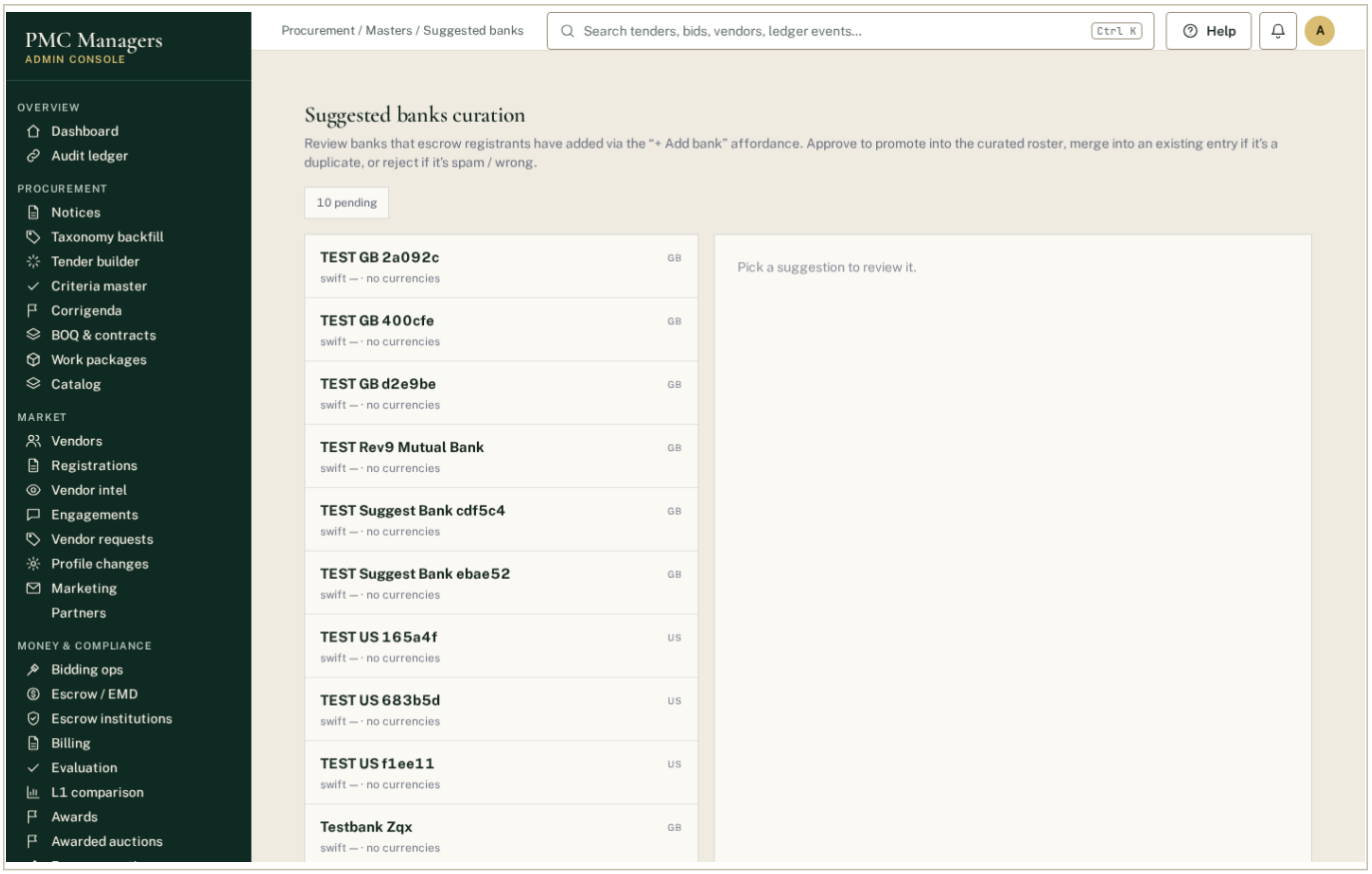
Electronic signature envelopes for award letters and contracts.

Main actions

- Track envelope status

Suggested banks

Screen: `/admin/e/suggested-banks`



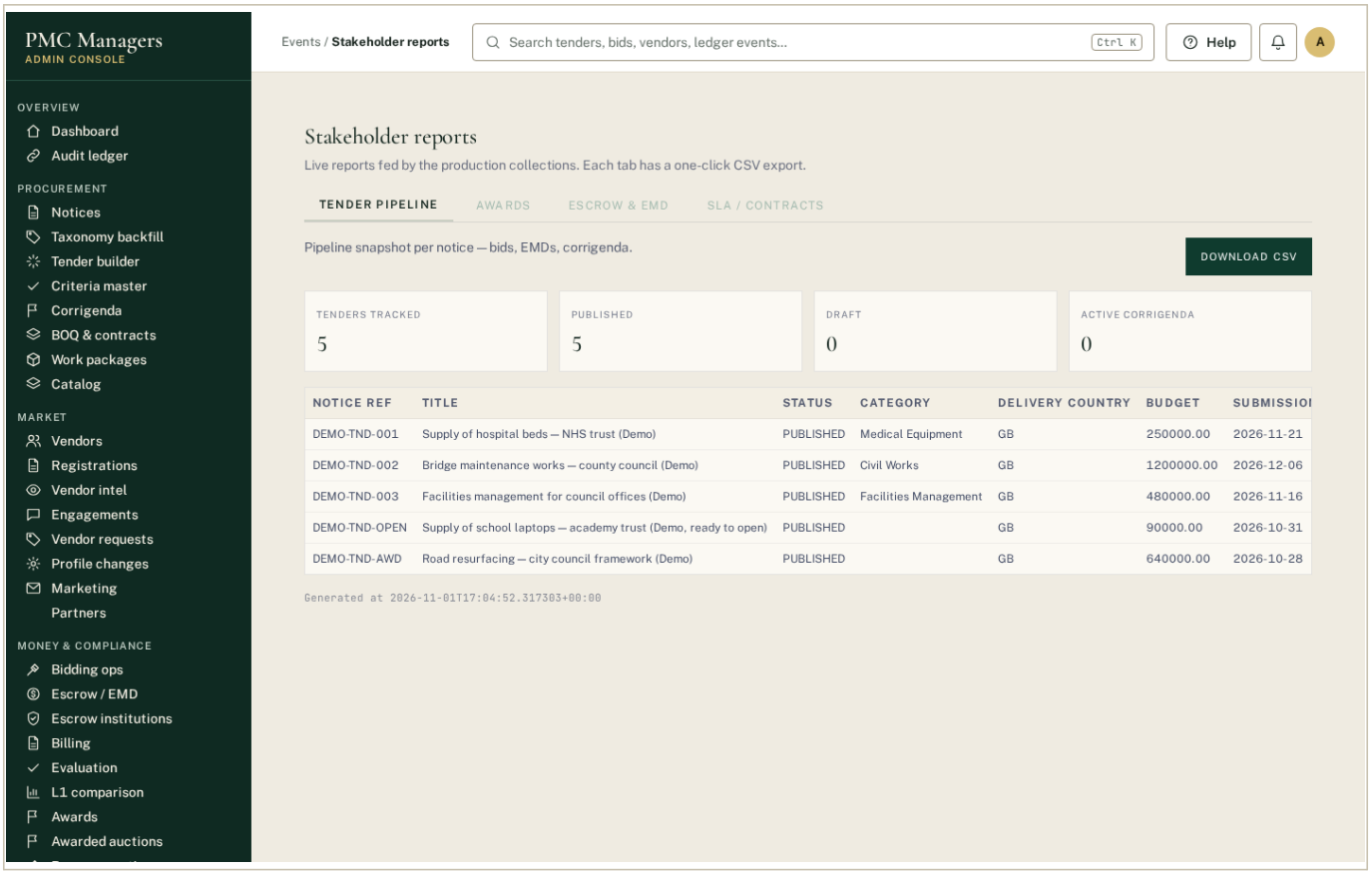
Banks suggested by users to be added as escrow institutions.

Main actions

- Review a suggestion

Stakeholder reports

Screen: `/admin/e/stakeholder-reports`



Board and sponsor reports: tender volumes, savings, timelines and compliance.

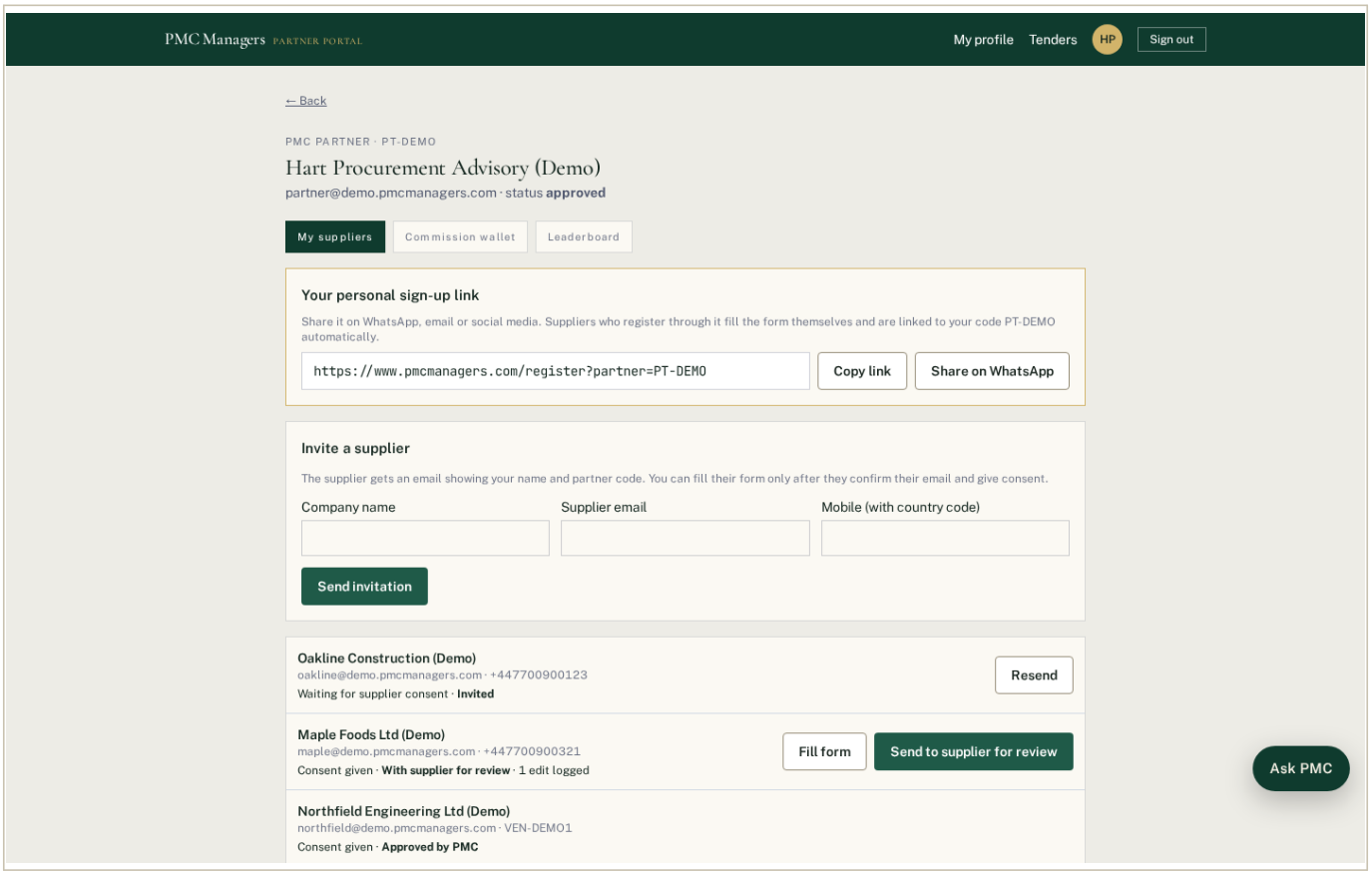
Main actions

- Generate a report
- Download PDF

7 · Partner portal — screen tour

Partner profile

Screen: `/partner/me`



Partners complete four sections (profile, banking, documents, agreement) with a progress bar; the form opens where they left off. After approval they onboard suppliers and see commission.

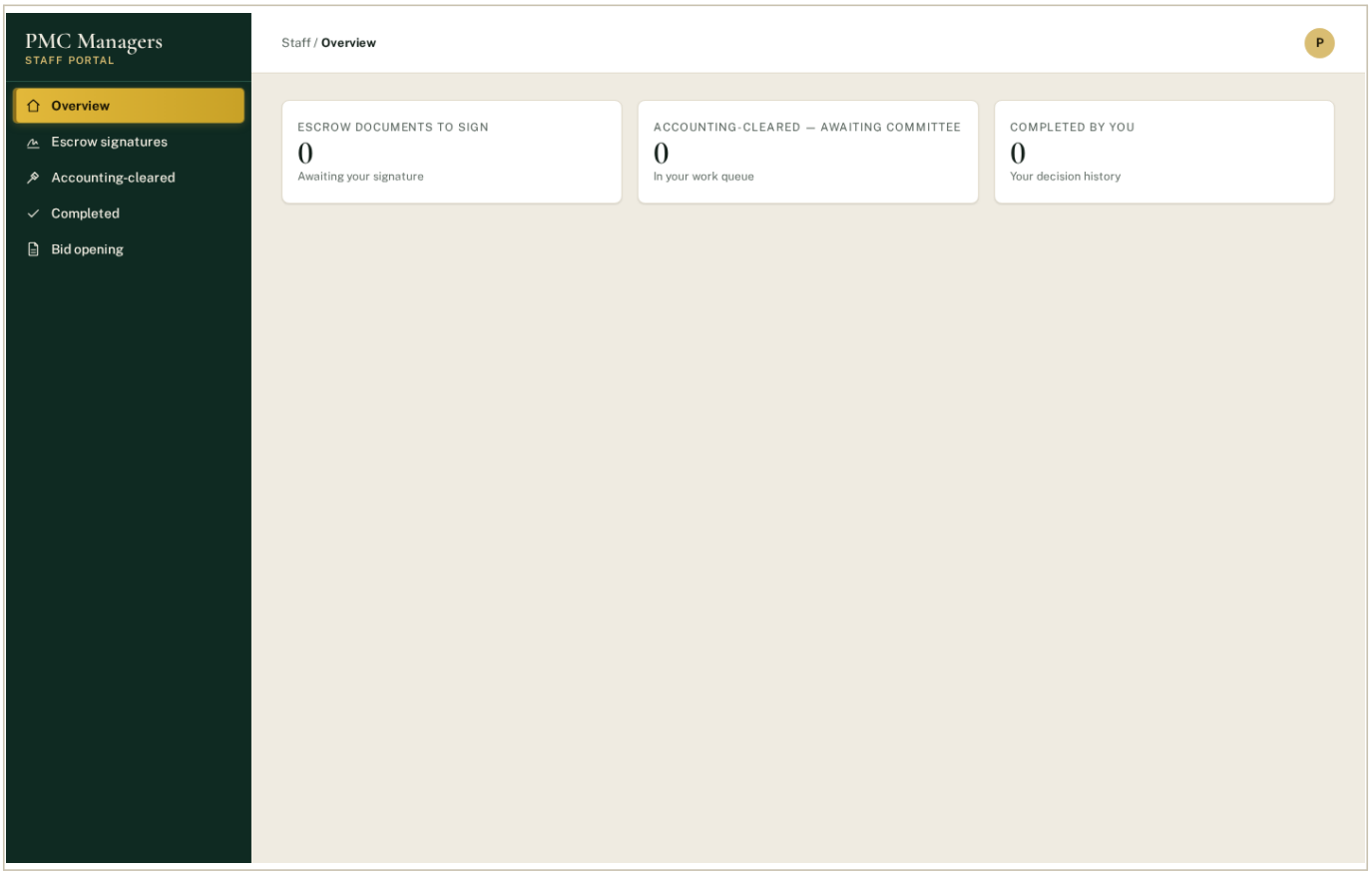
Main actions

- Complete each section
- Sign the agreement
- Submit for approval

8 · Staff portal — screen tour

Staff portal (committee)

Screen: `/staff`



Committee members and other staff see their tasks: tenders to open, proofs to review, bids to sign off and award.

Main actions

- Approve an opening
- Accept / reject proofs
- Award

9 · Deep-dive: Tender builder & AI DPR

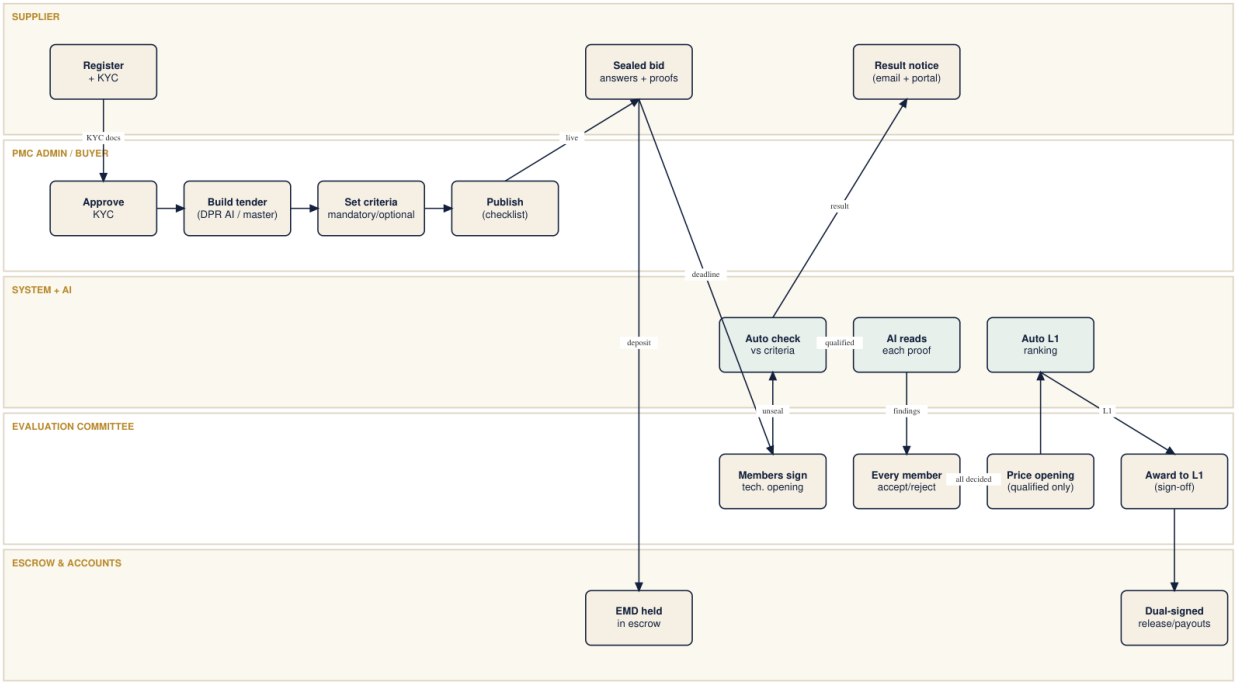
1. Tender builder › AI generate from DPR: pick country, a master template (or 'build a brand-new master'), upload up to 3 DPRs (PDF/DOCX/TXT, max 100 MB each).
2. Analyze runs in the background; each file shows progress, extracted headings and missing categories.
3. Create AI-drafted tenders, review every section, then use Criteria and Create notice.

If upload fails with 'status code 413' on AWS, the backend bundle was deployed without the .platform/nginx upload-size setting — redeploy the full backend ZIP (see chapter 13).

10 · Deep-dive: Criteria, sealed bids, opening & AI proof review

1. Criteria come from the Criteria master or saved sets, AI-read from the tender document, or one-off. Each is pass/fail or scored, Mandatory or optional, with proof required or not.
2. Rule: a bid qualifies if it meets every mandatory criterion and at least N of the optional ones (blank = all).
3. Publish needs: main document, future deadline, at least one must-pass criterion (checklist on the draft row). Live tenders without bids can still change criteria.
4. Suppliers must answer mandatory items with proofs; everything is sealed on submit.
5. After the deadline every committee member signs the technical opening; the system checks every bid and emails result notices.
6. AI reads each must-pass proof of qualified bids: Matches / Does not match / Unclear + figure found.
7. Every member accepts or rejects each proof (comment to reject). Mandatory rejection disqualifies; optional rejection disqualifies only below the minimum.
8. Doubts can be raised and resolved with notes. Download the proof check report (PDF) for the file.

PMC tender lifecycle — process flow



• Lanes show who acts. Green boxes are automatic (system or AI). Bids stay sealed until the committee signs each opening.

• A bid qualifies if it meets every mandatory criterion and at least the minimum number of optional criteria; the AI only flags proofs, the committee decides (all must accept).

• Price opening is blocked until every proof is decided; L1 runs automatically; award needs certifier, legal and accounting clearance.

PMC Managers · PMC tender lifecycle — process flow

Page 1

11 · Deep-dive: Price opening, L1, award & escrow

1. Price opening is blocked until every proof is decided; only qualified bids' prices open.
2. L1 ranking runs automatically and shows on the opening card.
3. Award to L1 (committee member, one click + note) requires certifier, legal and accounting clearance on the L1 bid. Weighted tenders use the Award recommendation report.
4. On award: award letter and contract are generated; the winner is emailed 'Congratulations — your bid is awarded'; every other bidder is emailed that the tender went to another supplier, why (criteria failed, disqualified with the committee's note, or their L-rank and the awarded price) and their EMD refund date.
5. Escrow releases need two signatures; consortium awards create per-member payment instructions with bank references and a downloadable payout report.

12 · Partners, reminders & tracking

1. Admin invites a partner; partner completes Profile, Banking, Documents, Agreement (progress bar 'N of 4').
2. Reminder emails go 3 and 7 days after joining if unfinished (daily 09:00 London).
3. Every tender shows a progress line (Criteria → Bids → Opening → Proof review → Price → L1 → Award) on Notices and on the dashboard.

13 · Troubleshooting playbook

Symptom	Likely cause	Fix
Upload fails: status code 413	Web server body limit on AWS	Redeploy full backend ZIP with .platform
AWS health 'Degraded'	Failing health checks or 5xx	EB › Health › causes; check /health and logs
Old screens after deploy	CloudFront cache	Invalidate /*
Emails not arriving	Email key missing/invalid	Update the email secret and redeploy
Price opening blocked	Proof review or doubt pending	Decide every proof / resolve doubts
Award to L1 refused	L1 bid not cleared	Complete certifier, legal, accounting clearances
Supplier can't submit	Mandatory criterion or proof missing	Answer all mandatory items

14 · Sample workflow — one tender end to end

1. Admin drafts 'Hospital beds supply' from a DPR and adds 3 mandatory + 2 optional criteria (at least 1 optional), L1.
2. Checklist all ticked → Publish.
3. Three suppliers bid; one misses a mandatory proof and cannot submit until fixed.
4. Deadline passes; committee signs; 2 bids qualify, 1 fails (turnover below 500,000) and is notified.
5. AI flags a mismatch on one proof; one member rejects with a comment → that bid is disqualified.
6. Price opening; L1 = remaining bid; clearances done; Award to L1; letters and emails go out; EMDs of others scheduled for refund.

15 · Procurement policy: criteria & qualification

Purpose. Make sure every tender is judged by clear, published criteria applied the same way to every bidder.

Rule	What it means
Published criteria only	Bids are judged only on the criteria shown in the tender. Criteria come from the Criteria master or are added by the tender author and saved before publishing.
Mandatory vs optional	The tender author marks each pass/fail criterion Mandatory (must be met) or optional and sets the minimum number of optional criteria a bidder must meet (blank = all).
At least one must-pass	A tender cannot be published without at least one must-pass criterion (publish checklist).
Changing criteria	Allowed on a live tender only while it has no bids; once a bid arrives criteria lock. Any other change is a corrigendum sent to all bidders.
System decides pass/fail	At technical opening the system compares every answer with the rule. Nobody can override a pass/fail directly; the committee can only raise a logged doubt and decide it.
Consortium rules	Each criterion says whether the lead, the combined members or every member must meet it.

16 · Proof review policy (AI + committee)

Purpose. Check that the documents bidders attach actually support what they declared.

Rule	What it means
Sealed until opening	Proof files are encrypted on upload and cannot be opened by anyone before the committee signs the technical opening.
AI reads, people decide	For qualified bids the AI reads each must-pass proof and records Matches / Does not match / Unclear with the figure found. The AI never passes or fails a bid.
Unanimous acceptance	Every committee member must accept a proof for it to stand. One rejection (with a written comment) fails that proof.
Effect of a rejection	Mandatory proof rejected → bid disqualified. Optional proof rejected → disqualified only if the bid falls below the minimum optional criteria.
Unreadable files	Word/Excel or unreadable scans are marked 'check by hand'; the committee must still open and decide them.
Price opening gate	Price envelopes cannot be opened until every proof on every qualified bid is decided and every doubt resolved.
Record	The proof check report (PDF) is downloaded and kept on the tender file.

17 · Evaluation & award policy (L1 / weighted)

Purpose. Award fairly and transparently to the right bidder.

Rule	What it means
Method set in advance	Each tender states before publishing whether the winner is the lowest compliant price (L1) or weighted technical + price marks.
Only qualified bids ranked	Only bids that passed criteria and proof review have prices opened and are ranked.
Automatic L1	L1 ranking runs automatically at price opening; compliance flags (e.g. suspiciously low, above budget) are shown for the committee.
Clearances before award	The winning bid must have certifier, legal and accounting clearance before award.
Award to L1	A committee member awards with one click and a note; the action is recorded in the audit ledger.
Notices to bidders	The winner is congratulated; every other bidder is told why they were not selected (criteria failed, disqualified with the committee's note, or their L-rank and the awarded price) and their EMD refund date.

18 · Code of ethics & conflict of interest

Purpose. Protect the integrity of every tender.

Rule	What it means
Declare conflicts	Committee members declare any interest in a bidder before signing an opening; a conflicted member steps aside.
No contact during evaluation	Committee members do not discuss a live tender with bidders; clarifications go through the platform's messages.
Gifts	No gifts or hospitality from bidders during a tender.
Confidentiality	Bid contents, scores and committee comments are confidential until the award notice.
Reporting	Concerns are raised to the PMC integrity officer; retaliation is prohibited.

19 · Data protection, retention & deletion

Purpose. Handle personal and commercial data lawfully and securely.

Rule	What it means
Minimum data	Collect only what tendering, KYC and payments need.
Encryption	Bid answers, prices and bid files are encrypted at rest; access is by role.
Soft deletion	Records are archived, not erased, to keep the audit trail. Narrow, explicit deletion only on a verified request.
AI processing	Only proof files of qualified bids are sent to the AI, after technical opening, to read the figures.
Secrets	API keys and passwords live only in the server's secret settings — never in documents, chat, email or Git. If one leaks, revoke and replace it immediately.
Retention	Tender records and audit ledger kept for the period required by the buyer's regulations (typically 7 years).

20 · Incident response

Purpose. Act quickly and consistently when something goes wrong.

Step	Owner	Action
1 Detect	Anyone	Report via the help desk or integrity email; note time and screen.
2 Contain	PMC admin	Suspend affected accounts or tender; revoke leaked keys at the provider and replace them in AWS.
3 Assess	PMC admin + IT	Use the audit ledger to see what happened and who was affected.
4 Notify	PMC lead	Tell affected buyers/suppliers; regulators where required (e.g. 72 hours for personal data breaches).
5 Recover	IT	Redeploy clean bundles, verify chain, re-open the tender if needed.
6 Learn	PMC lead	Write a short review and update this manual.

21 · Complaints, appeals & escalation

Purpose. Give bidders a clear route to question a decision.

Stage	Who	Time
Clarification	Bidder asks via messages; PMC replies	3 working days
Complaint	Bidder writes to PMC within 5 days of the result notice	Acknowledged in 2 days
Review	PMC officer not involved in the tender reviews the record (proof check report, audit ledger)	10 working days
Appeal	Buyer's appeal body or vendor-intel appeal process	As per buyer rules

22 · RACI matrix

Purpose. Who does what in each tender step.

Activity	Responsible / Accountable	Consulted / Informed
Build tender & criteria	Admin (R), Buyer (A)	Reviewer (C)
Publish	Admin (R/A)	Suppliers (I)
Technical opening	Committee (R), Chair (A)	Suppliers (I)
Proof review	Every committee member (R), Chair (A)	AI (C)
Price opening & L1	Committee (R/A)	Accounting (I)
Clearances	Certifier, Legal, Accounting (R)	Committee (I)
Award	Committee member (R), Chair (A)	All bidders (I)
Escrow release	Two escrow signatories (R/A)	Accounts (I)

23 · Templates

Committee minutes — technical opening

```
Tender: _____ Date/time: _____ Chair: _____
Members present and conflict declarations: _____
Bids received: __ Qualified by system: __ Not qualified: __
Proof review decisions (attach proof check report): _____
Doubts raised and resolution: _____
Signatures: _____
```

Proof rejection comment

```
Criterion: _____ Bid: _____
What the document shows: _____ What was declared: _____
Reason for rejection: _____
```

Award notice (L1)

```
Tender _____ has been awarded to _____ at _____ (lowest compliant price).
Ranking of qualified bids: L1 _____, L2 _____, L3 _____
Bids not qualified and reasons: _____
EMD refunds due by: _____
```

Corrigendum

```
Tender: _____ Corrigendum no.: _____ Date: _____
What changes: _____ New deadline (if any): _____
Reason: _____
```

Clarification reply

```
Question received: _____ From: (kept anonymous)
Answer (shared with all bidders): _____
```

24 · Service levels

Purpose. Target response times.

Item	Target
Supplier KYC review	2 working days
Tender review (supplier-prepared)	3 working days
Clarification answer	3 working days
Proof review after technical opening	5 working days
Award after price opening	10 working days
EMD refund to losing bidders	14 days after award
Partner approval	3 working days

25 · Glossary

Term	Meaning
DPR	Detailed project report used to draft a tender
EMD	Earnest money deposit held in escrow with a bid
L1	Lowest compliant price among qualified bids
Mandatory criterion	Must be met by every bidder
Optional criterion	Counts toward the minimum number the tender sets
Proof review	AI finding + unanimous committee decision on each proof
Corrigendum	Formal change to a live tender sent to every bidder
Consortium	Registered suppliers bidding together
Sealed bid	Encrypted until the committee signs the opening